GS MAINS · PAPERS I–III · EVERY NUMBER SOURCED

Data & Facts

GS Mains · Papers I–III. Each fact sheet carries verified numbers with their data window and their source — rankings, budgets, schemes, indices. Quote a figure, a year and a source name in one line, and your answer stands out.

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HOW TO USE THIS BOOK

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How to quote in the exam. Give the number, the period, and the source name — one line. Example: *India ranked 9th on the Climate Risk Index for 1995–2024 (Germanwatch).*

How to move around. Tap any fact-sheet title in the contents. Every subject page also lists its own cards. The floating INDEX button follows you on every page.

Print. A4, portrait, background graphics ON — one sheet prints as one page.

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GS PAPER I

Indian Heritage, History and Geography of the World and Society

Paper I — Indian Heritage and Culture, History, Geography of the World and Society.

> **One dated number can lift a GS-1 answer above the rest.**

SUBJECTS IN THIS PAPER — TAP TO OPEN

History Society

GS PAPER I

History

FACT SHEETS IN THIS SUBJECT — TAP ANY TITLE TO JUMP TO IT

PRE-COLONIAL PERIOD & CHRONOLOGY
BRITISH COLONIAL ECONOMY
COLONIAL POLICIES & DEVELOPMENT
FREEDOM STRUGGLE & MOVEMENTS
POST INDEPENDENCE

GS PAPER I · SECTION

Modern History

Colonial rule and impact

PRE-COLONIAL PERIOD & CHRONOLOGY

DATA: Historical (1498-1792) & 2024 (Antiquities)

CULTURE: ARTEFACTS SMUGGLING

- The US returned 1,400 looted artifacts, valued at nearly $**10 million**, to India (Nov 2024)
- India reclaimed 297 antiquities during PM Modi's recent US visit, raising the total recoveries since 2014 to 640 (Sep 2024).

ECONOMY DURING MUGHAL PERIOD

- GDP in the **16th century** (1600 AD) -> ~**22.5–25.1%** of the world economy - **2nd largest** in the world (Angus Maddison, The World Economy: Historical Statistics).
- Annual revenue of Akbar's treasury in 1600 AD at £**17.5 million** (in contrast to the entire treasury of Great Britain two hundred years later in 1800 AD, which totalled £**16 million**).
- India experienced unprecedented prosperity in history.

ADVENT OF EUROPEANS

- the Portuguese, the first Europeans to come to India (1498), were also the last to leave this land (1961).
- **Third Anglo-Mysore War**: Tipu Sultan had to pay Rs.3 Crore as war indemnity. He also had to surrender 2 of his sons as surety to the British till he paid his due.

BRITISH COLONIAL ECONOMY

DATA: Historical (1664-1950) & 2025 (Oxfam Report)

ECONOMIC DRAIN BY BRITISH

Scholars:

- **Romesh Chandra Dutt**: In early **20th century** ≈ £**20 million** flew out of India.
- **MG Ranade**: In his book "Essay on Indian Economics," he claimed that Britishers drained more than one-third of India's wealth into England.
- **Dadabhai Naoroji**: India's tax burden in 1886 was **14.3% of total** revenue, significantly higher than England's **6.93%**.
- **Angus Maddison** (British economist): India's share of the world income went from **27%** in 1700 AD (compared to Europe's share of **23%**) to **3%** in 1950.

Reports:

- **'Takers Not Makers: The Unjust Poverty and Unearned Wealth of Colonial Inheritance' report, 2025** (Oxfam):
  - Wealth Drain during Colonial Period -> Between 1765 and 1900, UK drained $**64.82 trillion** from India, with $**33.8 trillion** going to the top **10%**.

India and its Contradictions: In the **18th century**, India became a land of contrasts because extreme poverty and extreme luxury existed side by side.

FAMINES

- Between 1730 to 1947 → 31 famines, loss of life of **8.5 cr.** Indians
- In 1770, there was a terrible Famine in Bengal which killed about 1 Crore people.

BRITISH COLONIAL ECONOMY CONTINUED

LAND REVENUE SYSTEMS

Permanent Settlement:

- Covered **20%** of British India
- The state received 10/**11th** of the rent the zamindars received from the peasantry, with only 1/**11th going to the** zamindars themselves.
- Between 1794 and 1819, **68%** of zamindari land was sold in Bengal.

Ryotwari System:

- Covered **51%** area of British India.
- Revenue was fixed at very high rate (**45-50%**)

STATE OF INDUSTRY

Up until 1750, India produced about **25%** of the world's industrial output.

India had a **25%** share of the global textile trade in the early **18th** century.

By 1664, the English East India Company imported more than 750,000 pieces of cotton goods from India, which accounted for **73 per cent** of the Company's total trade.

INFRASTRUCTURE

On April 16, 1853 -> first railway line in India spanning upto 34 kilometers between Boribandar (Bombay) to Thane.

Built **6000 kms** of track by 1869 and **45,000 km** of track by 1905 with the help of private enterprises.

Railway length = ~69,439 route km (~**1.32 lakh** track km) today (Economic Survey 2025-26) --> ~**53,000–54,000 km** built during British rule before 1947 (Ministry of Railways).

COLONIAL POLICIES & DEVELOPMENT

DATA: Historical (1773-1947)

ADMINISTRATIVE REFORMS

Cornawallis Reforms:

- all higher posts in administration worth **more than 500 pounds a year** in salary could be held by Englishmen only.
- Charter Act of 1793 had reserved all posts worth 500 pounds per annum for the covenant servants of the Company.
- Salary of the Collector of a district was raised to Rs. 1500 a month and **1 per cent** commission on the revenue collected from his district.

Viscount Lee Commission recommendations (1924): Parity between Indians and Europeans: To be achieved **50:50 parity** in **15 years**.

Morley-Minto Reforms: number of members in the Central Legislative Council was raised from 16 to 60.

Provinces: 3 provinces in 1773 to 17 provinces in 1947.

SOCIAL DEVELOPMENT

Status of illiteracy: ~**94%** in 1911 (~**6%** literacy) and ~**92%** in 1921 (~**8%** literacy; ~**84%** illiteracy at Independence in 1947) (Census of British India / NCERT)

Number of Universities:

- **1857:** 3 (Calcutta, Bombay, Madras)
- **1947:** 19 universities, ~500 colleges

Age of Consent Act(1891): Raised age of consent for girls from 10 to **12 years**.

Child Marriage Restraint Act (1929): Minimum marriage age: 14 (girls) and 18 (boys).

Gandhi ji campaign for untouchability: Gandhi's campaign against untouchability which covered 12,500 miles and lasted for nine months.

Poona Pact: Number of seats reserved for the depressed classes in provincial legislatures would be increased from 71 in the Award to 147; and to **18%** of the total in central legislature.

Rabindranath Tagore wrote around 2230 songs.

Various stages of Freedom struggle

FREEDOM STRUGGLE & MOVEMENTS

DATA: Historical (1857-1937)

REVOLT OF 1857

European Soldier to Indian soldier ratio: 1:2

Revolt of 1857 -> Proportion of Europeans to Indians was carefully fixed at 1:2 in the Bengal Army and 2:5 in the Madras and Bombay Armies to avoid another revolt (Peel Commission, 1859 / NCERT).

In Awadh, more **than 20,000 taluqdars had their estates confiscated**

BENGAL PARTITION (1905)

Reason given for Partition: Population of **78 million** Bengal had become too big to be administered.

JALLIANWALA BAGH

House of Lords endorsed Reginald Dyer's action and the British public showed solidarity with him by helping collect **30,000 pounds** for him for his atrocities in Jallianwala Bagh.

NON-COOPERATION MOVEMENT (1920 TO 1922)

1st nationwide movement launched by Gandhiji in 1920 during British rule.

During Non-cooperation Movement:

Thousands of students left schools and colleges and joined only 800 national schools and colleges.

Rs 1 crore were raised for Tilak Swaraj Fund by August 1921, and **1 crore/50 lakhs** members got enrolled in Congress.

Consequence of Non-Cooperation Movement: The import of foreign goods halved between 1921 and 1922.

HOME RULE LEAGUE MOVEMENT

Tilak's Home Rule League had 6 Branches while Annie Besant's Home rule League had 200+ Branches.

CIVIL DISOBEDIENCE MOVEMENT (1930)

Gandhi along with a band of 78 members of Sabarmati Ashram, marched from his headquarters in Ahmedabad for 240 miles.

On April 23, 1930, the arrest of Congress leaders in the NWFP led to the participation of a **92%** Muslim population.

Gandhi's Eleven demands -> Reduce Rupee-Sterling Exchange Ratio to 1s 4d: Called for a change in the exchange rate between the Indian rupee and the British pound to benefit Indian traders and businesses.

1937 ELECTIONS

1937 elections were held in 11 provinces- Madras, United Provinces, Central Provinces, Bihar, Orissa, Assam, NWFP, Bengal, Punjab, Bombay and Sindh

In 1937 elections, An estimated **30.1 million** persons, including **4.25 million** women, had acquired the right to vote (**12% of the total population**), and **15.5 millions** of these, including 917,000 women, participated to exercise their franchise.

In 1937 elections, Among the 864 seats assigned "general" constituencies, Congress **contested 739** and won 617.

GS PAPER I · SECTION

Post Independence

Consolidation after Independence

POST INDEPENDENCE

DATA: 1947–2025

POST INDEPENDENCE

Women (Political Participation):

Independence: 4%

Now: 13.6% (74 women MPs) in 18th Lok Sabha (2024) and 14.4% (78 women MPs) in 17th Lok Sabha (ECI / PRS)

Poverty:

Independence: 80% -> 25 yr.

Now: 21.9% (2011-12 Tendulkar Committee)

Multidimensional Poverty declined to 11.28% in 2022-23 (NITI Aayog / Economic Survey 2025-26) and extreme poverty ($3.00/day 2021 PPP) to 5.3% in 2022-23 (World Bank).

Population:

Independence: 34 cr.

Doubled till 1981

Surpassed 1 billion in 2000 (typo fixed: 1 trillion 2005 -> 1 billion in 2000)

Now ~146.39 crore in 2025 (UNFPA State of World Population 2025).

Princely states at the time of Independence: There were 565 self-governing princely states that were released by Indian Independence act of 1947 (in 1920, 60% of total area was British territory & 40% were Indian states).

GS PAPER I

Society

FACT SHEETS IN THIS SUBJECT — TAP ANY TITLE TO JUMP TO IT

General
INDIAN SOCIETY
POPULATION
WOMEN
URBANIZATION

GS PAPER I · SECTION

Foundations & Diversity

Uniqueness of Indian society

General

> * You can Quote source as Economic Survey OR NITI Aayog at maximum places

SOCIETY & SOCIAL JUSTICE

SOURCES

NITI Aayog / Ministry of Finance · Economic Survey 2025-26 & NITI Aayog Social Sector Reports (Meta-Reference Card) (2026) GoI

Diversity and pluralism

INDIAN SOCIETY

DATA: 2011 (Census) / 2024 (CSSS)

DIVERSITY

CASTE SYSTEM

Jatis: More than 30000 Jatis

Inter-faith and Intercaste marriages: around **6%**

- **61%** of respondents opposed interfaith marriages
- **56%** were against inter-caste unions [India Today's Gross Domestic Behaviour survey]
- **Rural Vs Urban:** Inter-caste marriages are more frequent in Rural areas (**5.2%**) than Urban areas (**4.9%**) [Indian Statistical Institute study]
- **Rich and poor:** Inter-caste marriages are more common among poor people (**5.9%**) than rich people (**4.0%**).

DIVERSITY

Tribes: 705+ notified Scheduled Tribes (Census 2011 / Ministry of Tribal Affairs)

Languages: 121 languages spoken by >10,000 people (including 22 Scheduled Languages) | 1,369 rationalised mother tongues (Census 2011)

Dialects: 20,000 languages or dialects.

Hindi Speakers: only **26%** speak Hindi as mother tongue

COMMUNALISM

No. of Communal Riots: India witnessed **84%** rise in communal violence in 2024 [Centre for Study of Society and Secularism (CSSS) report]

States

Maharashtra emerged-> 12 riots.

Uttar Pradesh and Bihar-> 7 riots

GS PAPER I · SECTION

Gender & Demographics

Population and associated issues

POPULATION

DATA: 2024-2025 (UNFPA 2025 & SRS 2024)

POPULATION STATS

World – **8.23 billion (8,232 million)** in 2025 (UNFPA State of World Population 2025)

India - **146.39 crores** (UNFPA) {Census **2011 – 121 cr**}

World Bank: projected increase of **18%** to **1.67 billion by 2050**

Annual growth rate – 0.8 %

Census 2011

Rural - 68.84%

Urban - 31.16%

Diaspora: 3.5 Crore [Ministry of External Affairs]

Remittances = $135.4 billion in FY 2024-25 ($129.1–$129.4 billion in CY 2024; ~3.3–3.5% of India's GDP) (RBI / Economic Survey 2025-26)

US (**5.4 million**), UAE (**3.6 million**), and Malaysia (**2.9 million**).

Land %: 2.4% of the world's land area and **18 %** of the world's population.

DEMOGRAPHY

Demographic Advantage: ≈ **65%** of Population ≈ is below **35 yrs**.

Medium Age: 28 yrs (China - **39 yrs**.)

Large Share in World's Working Population: By 2030, 1/3rd of world working population could be from India

Elderly (60+): 8.6% in Census 2011 -> **9.7% in 2024** (SRS Statistical Report 2024) -> ~**10.1–11%** in 2025 -> projected ~**20%** by 2050 (ORGI SRS 2024 / UNFPA)

10.1% or **13.8 cr** (Male: Female:: **8%**:: **9%**) {UN}

Working-Age Population: 66.4% in 15–59 age group in 2024 (ORGI SRS Statistical Report 2024) and ~**68%** in 15–64 age group (UNFPA 2025).

NFHS – 5

Younger Population: More than **60%** of Population is below 35

Over-60 population: increased from **10%** to **12%**

Avg. household size: decreased between 2015-16 and 2019-21 (from 4.6 persons to 4.4)

Female Heads: 18% of households (**18%**)

LITERACY RATE

Census 2011

74.04 per cent

82.14 for males and 65.46 for females.

Full Literacy (to be considered equivalent to 100% literacy): Achieving **95%** literacy in a State/UT that may be considered as equivalent to fully literate.

Ministry of Education, 2023

Total ~ 75%

Male (**82.14%**) v/s **Female** (**65.46%**)

Urban (**84.11%**) v/s **Rural** (**67.77%**)

Maximum - Kerala > **90%**

Minimum - Bihar ~ **60 %**

SEX RATIO

Sex Ratio

Census 2011 – 943

Rural: Urban:: 949: 929

Child Sex Ratio: 918 (**Rural: Urban::** 923: 905

POPULATION CONTINUED

NFHS – 5

Sex Ratio: 1020

Rural: Urban:: 1037: 985

RELIGION

Religion wise - Country

Hinduism - **80 %**

Islam – **14.2%**

Christianity – **2.3%** {2.5%}

Sikkim: **1.72%** {1.75%}

Buddhism - **0.7 %**

Jainism: **0.3%** **Parliament**

90.4% Hindu

5% Muslims

Other: **4%** **Bureaucracy**

2.5 % Muslims (Sanchar Committee/ Rangnath Mishra Committee)

LIFE EXPECTANCY

India's life expectancy **stands at 73.4 years,** the healthy life expectancy is almost a decade shorter [Public Health Foundation of India (PHFI)]

World Avg - **73.5 yrs.**

Women and Associated concerns

WOMEN

DATA: 2024-2026 (WEF GGGR 2026, SRS 2024, Eco Sur…

ECONOMIC EMPOWERMENT

WAGE GAP

Indian women earn Rs 40 for every Rs 100 men earn (WEF)

India rank: **131st out of 145 countries in Global Gender Gap Index 2026** (parity score **64.5%**; was **131st** out of 148 countries with **64.1–64.4%** score in GGGI 2025) (WEF Global Gender Gap Report 2026)

LABOR FORCE PARTICIPATION

India: The female LFPR has risen from **23.3 %**(2017-18) to **41.7%**(2023-24). (Eco survey 2024-25).

Global: Women's global labour force participation rate stood at **48.7 per cent in 2023** (ILO).

WOMEN IN INFORMAL SECTOR

More than **95%** women working in Informal sector (ILO)

FINANCE AVAILABILITY TO WOMEN

80% of women run enterprises are self-financed

< **5%** borrowed money from some financial institutions.

GLOBAL GENDER GAP REPORT 2025 & 2026 (WEF)

India's Gender Parity Score: **64.5% in 2026** (vs global average of **69.2%**; India scored **96.6%** in Educational Attainment, **95.6%** in Health & Survival, **41.2%** in Economic Participation, and **24.5%** in Political Empowerment) [**64.1–64.4%** in 2025] (WEF GGGR 2026)

India rank: **131/145 in GGGR 2026** (131/148 in GGGR 2025) (WEF GGGR 2026)

South Asia: Bhutan (119), Nepal (125), and Sri Lanka (130) ranked better than India.

WOMEN CONTINUED

Gender Parity Timeline: At the current pace, it will take **~120 years** globally to achieve full gender parity in GGGR 2026 (down from **134 years** earlier) (WEF GGGR 2026).

SOCIAL ISSUES

EDUCATION

Literary Rate: **65.46%** (2011 Census)

Worldwide: **12.2 crore** girls remain out of school globally [UNICEF]

Gender Parity in Secondary Education: India showed the best gender parity in terms of enrolment in secondary education [Global Gender Gap report, 2024]

HEALTH (NFHS-5)

TFR: **2.0 in NFHS-5 (2019-21)** and declined further to **1.9 in SRS Statistical Report 2024** (below replacement level of 2.1) (NFHS-5 / ORGI SRS 2024)

Anaemia: **57% of women aged 15–49 years** are anaemic in India (NFHS-5) [~1 in 3 globally]

CRIMES

India records **51 cases** of crime against women every hour (NCRB)

1/3rd crimes by husband/relative (MoSPI)

Cybercrime: reporting surged by **25%**

Suicides: **4.2%** Increase (NCRB, 2022)

Rape

4th most common crime against women

India lodged average 86 rapes daily: NCRB data

OTHERS (DEMOGRAPHIC)

Median age: **28.2 years** (China -> **38 yrs**)

Sex Ratio: 1020 (NFHS -5)

CSR: 929 (from 919) (NFHS - 5)

POLITICAL REPRESENTATION

18th L.S -> **13.6%** (**17th** LS -> **14.4%**)

World Average (**25%**)

Rwanda: **61%**

SA: **43%**

UK: **32%**

USA: **24%**

Women as MLAs: **9%**

Women in Local Bodies: **33%** reservation but more than **40%** representation

Women in legislative bodies [Since Independence]

Lok Sabha: 22 (**5%**) in 1951 -> 74 (**13.6%**) in 2024.

Rajya Sabha: **7%** in 1952 -> **13%** in 2023.

POLITICAL PARTICIPATION

Women voters -> **50%**

Female Voter turnout

65.8% during the **18th** Lok Sabha Elections.

WOMEN & STEM

India: **43%** of STEM graduates are women but only **14%** stem jobs are with women.

Women currently represent only **26%** of the workforce in data science and artificial intelligence (AI).

Global: Women make for **35%** STEM graduates globally [UNESCO]

OTHERS

Women & Unpaid work: 2/**3rd** {Men: 1/**4th**)

Women & GDP

Indian women: contribute only **18%** to GDP [National Family Health Survey] vs **Global Avg.** = **45%**

WOMEN CONTINUED

Advancing women's equality

Boost global GDP by $**28 trillion** and add $**770 billion** to India's GDP by 2025.

Women @ Board Level: **28.7%** share in board of directors in FY25.

Women & Assets: Own **2% of total** assets

Women led Startup: > 7,000 active women-led startups, making up **7.5%** of all active startups in the country [Tracxn report].

Women & SHGs: Over **10.05 crore** rural women households mobilized into 90.90+ lakh SHGs under DAY-NRLM; additionally, **over 31 crore unorganised workers are registered on e-Shram (54% women)** as of Jan 2026, and **55.02 crore PMJDY accounts (~56% women)** as of Mar 2025 [MoRD / Economic Survey 2025-26]

Women and Financial Inclusion[MoSPI].

- **Bank accounts**: Women own **39.2%** of all bank accounts in India, with rural areas seeing an even higher participation rate at **42.2%**.
- **Bank deposits**: Women contribute **39.7%** to total bank deposits.

GS PAPER I · SECTION

Urbanisation

Emerging Urbanisation Trends

URBANIZATION

DATA: 2011–2025 (Projections to 2036)

POPULATION

World population: ~**57% of global** population lives in urban areas (UN World Urbanization Prospects / World Bank)

Population (India Urban Share): **31.16%** (**37.7 crore**) in Census 2011 -> ~**36.4%** (~52+ crore) in 2024–2025 -> projected to reach ~**40%** (~**60 crore**) by 2036 (Census 2011 / World Bank / MoHUA)

- Increase of **40%** by 2036 – World Bank

GDP contribution = **63%**

- Increase to **70%** by 2036 – World Bank

Growth Rate: India urban population for 2022 was 50.8 Cr, a **2.05%** increase from 2021 (World Bank).

SLUMS

Census 2011 - Total Population in Slums: **6.55 cr** Indians live in Slums (around **5%**)

- Maharashtra (**1.18 cr**) > Andhra Pradesh (**1.02 cr**)

Cities with >10 Lakh Population: over **29%** population living in slums (EPW).

- Bombay (over **34%**, Calcutta **32%**, Madras **32%** and Delhi **31%**).
- **65%** of Indian cities have adjoining slums.

HOMELESS

Census 2011 - **0.15% of population** (17-18 lac)

Commissioners of SC - **1%** of the urban population is homeless (~**37 lakhs**).

Ministry of Housing and Urban Affairs: approx **23.93 lakh** people are homeless.

MIGRATION

Total Migration Rate = **28.9%** (Migration in India report, 2020-21)

- **Rural Areas** - **26.5 %**
- **Urban Areas** - **34.9%**
- **Employment: 10.8%** persons were migrated for employment related reasons

URBANIZATION CONTINUED

- **Females:** 47.9% - (48% in rural and 47.8% in urban areas)
  - **Main reason – Marriage:** 86.8% females migrated for marriage
- **Males:** 10.7% - (5.9% in rural and 22.5% in urban areas)
  - **Main reason – Employment:** 49.6% of males migrated for employment

Domestic migrants: ↓ 12% to 40.20 crore between 2011 and 2023 [EAC-PM].

MISCELLANEOUS

Open Defecation: Over 25% rural households defecate in the open in contrast to Swachh Bharat data (NFHS-5)

Electricity:

Households: 97% of households have electricity

World Bank – 100% of Urban Population has access to electricity.

GS PAPER II

Governance, Constitution, Polity, Social Justice and International Relations

Paper II — Governance, Constitution, Polity, Social Justice and International Relations.

> **Governance answers score when they carry scheme numbers and years.**

SUBJECTS IN THIS PAPER — TAP TO OPEN

Governance | International Relations | Polity | Social Justice

GS PAPER II

Governance

FACT SHEETS IN THIS SUBJECT — TAP ANY TITLE TO JUMP TO IT

Aadhar
General
Citizen Participation
Corruption
Criminal Justice
Custodial Violence
Grievance Redressal
Police
Prison Reforms
RTI & OSA
Social Audit
Social Sector
Civil Services
Micro Credit
SHGs
NGOs
Sports Ecosystem

GS PAPER II · SECTION

Accountability & Civil Services

E-governance

Aadhar

DATA: 2026 (Enrollment) / 2022 (CAG Audit)

COVERAGE

Coverage: >92.5% overall penetration (CAG Report on UIDAI), with **over 144 crore Aadhaar IDs generated** as of July 2026 (MeitY / UIDAI)

Adults: Nearly **100%**

Children (5-18): 92.5%

States: Some states in India have Aadhaar enrollment rates that exceed **100%**

AUTHENTICATION FAILURE

Iris: 8.5%

Finger: 6%

Invalid mobile number: ≈ 7,50,000 beneficiaries linked with invalid mobile no

EXCLUSIONS

Around **0.6 %**

27% transgender

30% homeless

Govt Savings: Government saved **₹3.48 lakh crore** cumulatively through Aadhaar-enabled Direct Benefit Transfer (DBT) by curbing welfare delivery leakages (up from **₹2.22 lakh crore** earlier) (Ministry of Finance / UIDAI)

General

DATA: 2025-2026 (up to July/Aug 2026)

E-GOVERNANCE

Active internet users -> **886 million in 2024.**

Projection: 900 million active internet users by 2025

JAM trinity: 1.21 billion Indians enlisted in the government's biometric digital identity initiative.

Jan Dhan Yojana (PMJDY): 55.02 crore accounts as of March 2025 (**36.63 crore** in rural/semi-urban areas; deposit balance >**₹2.39 lakh crore**) (Economic Survey 2025-26).

Rupay cards: 37.02 crore RuPay cards have been issued to PMJDY account holders

UPI: Serves **55.49 crore users** and **6.5 crore** merchants across 731 banks (powers **85%** of India's digital payments and ~**50% of global** real-time payments); processed **2,365.8 crore (23.66 billion) monthly transactions worth ₹29.87 lakh crore** by mid-2026 (**106.36 billion** transactions in 2025, up from **16.58 billion** in Oct 2024) (NPCI / PIB 2026).

NATIONAL LEVEL INITIATIVES

BharatNet Project (Status as of June 2026 - MeitY / PIB)

2.21 lakh Gram Panchayats (GPs) have been made service-ready as of June 2026 (up from 2,18,347 in March 2025) (MeitY / PIB July 2026)

Optical Fiber Cable (OFC) length has increased to **42.13 lakh** route km.

Aadhaar:

Enrollment: Over **144 crore Aadhaar IDs** generated as of July 2026 (up from **138 crore in 2023**) (MeitY / UIDAI July 2026).

General CONTINUED

Usage: Aadhaar e-KYC transactions has crossed **2,393 crore** (April 2025)

Direct Benefit Transfer (DBT):

Savings: DBT saved **Rs 3.48 lakh crore** by curbing welfare delivery leakages (Ministry of Finance)

Subsidy allocations: ↓ from **16%** to **9% of total** government expenditure post-DBT implementation.

Total Transfers: Total debit was **₹6.91 lakh crore in FY24**

Beneficiaries: **1.85 billion** beneficiaries for different schemes are registered under various DBT schemes (March 2025)

GOVERNANCE PROJECTS AND PORTALS

e-NAM:

Mandi Integration: **1,522 mandis** integrated across 23 States and 4 UTs, onboarding **1.79 crore** farmers, **2.72 crore** traders, and 4,698 FPOs as of 31 December 2025 (up from 1,300+ mandis) (Economic Survey 2025-26).

Transactions: eNAM witnessed total trade of **Rs 78,424 crore** (2023-24)

GSTN (Goods and Services Tax Network):

Registrations: **1.65 crore (16.5 million)** active GST taxpayers registered as of May 2026 (up from **13 million**) (Ministry of Finance / PIB June 2026).

Transactions: collection had touched a record high of **Rs 2.37 trillion** in April 2025.

GeM (Government e-Marketplace):

Vendors: Over **5 million** sellers and service providers registered.

Transactions: Crossed **₹5 lakh crore annual GMV in both FY 2024-25 (₹5.42L cr) and FY 2025-26**, reaching a cumulative GMV of **₹18.4 lakh crore** by April 2026 (PIB Aug 2026)

DigiLocker:

Users: Over **71.66 crore (716.6 million) registered users** as of July 2026 (up from **150 million**) (MeitY / PIB July 2026).

Documents Issued: More than **936.03 crore (9.36 billion) documents issued** across 2,822 onboarded issuers as of July 2026 (up from **5 billion**) (MeitY / PIB July 2026).

e-Courts:

Virtual Courts: Over 3,000 virtual courts operational.

Case Information: Over **6.66 crore** cases handled

Transparency and Accountability

Citizen Participation

DATA: 2025

CITIZEN PARTICIPATION

Since 2014, MyGov platform has evolved into a robust citizen engagement platform with over **4.72 crore** registered users, known as MyGov Saathis (MeitY / MyGov).

Corruption

DATA: 2025 (CPI 2025 released Feb 2026)

Corruption Perceptions Index (CPI) 2025: India ranks **91st out of 182 countries** (score 39), improving from **96th** out of 180 countries in CPI 2024 (Transparency International 2026)

TRANSPARENCY INTERNATIONAL SURVEY (GLOBAL CORRUPTION BAROMETER - ASIA)

89% of Indians: Think government corruption is a big problem

71% of Indians: Think corruption levels have increased and/or stayed the same in the previous **12 months**

46% of Indians: Think that police and local government officials are corrupt

18% of Indians: Were offered bribes in exchange for votes

Criminal Justice

DATA: 2024-2025

UNDERTRIALS IN INDIA

Undertrials: **~73% (72.6%)** of total prisoners are undertrials in 2024 (NCRB Prison Statistics India 2024) ~75-76% in [India Justice Report 2025]

- Out of these about **68%** were either illiterate (**27%**) or school dropouts (**41%**)
- The number of under-trials doubled between 2010 (**2.4 lakh**) and 2021 (**4.3 lakh**). [India Justice Report 2022]

Time Spent in Prisons: Nationally, **69.9%** of undertrials were confined for up to 1 year, while **2.4%** (9,028 individuals) were confined for more than **5 years in 2024** [**20.8%** for **1-3 yrs**, **5.6%** for **3-5 yrs**, **2.7%** for >**5 yrs** in earlier PSI] (NCRB Prison Statistics India 2024).

Vulnerable section: Near about **55%** undertrials are SC, ST and Muslims.

Conviction rate: Nationwide in 2022, **23.3%** of the total prisoners were proven guilty and convicted for their crimes

Custodial Violence

DATA: 2017-2022 (NCRB) / 2025 (CSDS SPIR)

NCRB DATA

Custodial deaths: >660 police custodial deaths in the country from 2017 to 2022 (MHA / NCRB).

State-wise: Guj(80) has reported highest number followed by Maharashtra.

Conviction Rate: 1,888 custodial deaths in the last **20 years** but only 26 policemen convicted.

Lack of Inquiry: in **30% of cases**.

COMMON CAUSE-LOKNITI (CSDS) STUDY

Tough methods: **55%** of police personnel consider it important (**20%** "very important" and **35%** "somewhat important") to use "tough methods" to instill fear among the public (Common Cause-Lokniti CSDS Status of Policing in India Report 2025).

Killings: **22%** of police personnel believe that killing “dangerous criminals” is better than a legal trial.

Arrest Procedures: **41%** of police personnel say arrest procedures are “always” followed. **24%** admit that procedures are “rarely or never” followed.

Third degree methods: **30%** of police personnel justify the use of third- degree methods in serious criminal cases.

Grievance Redressal

DATA: 2022-2025 (CPGRAMS) / 2020 (TI Survey)

Centralized Public Grievance Redress and Monitoring System

Resolved over **70 lakh** grievances during 2022–24 (and over **26 lakh** grievances redressed in 2024-25 alone, reducing average disposal time to <**13 days**) (DARPG / CPGRAMS)

Redressed over **1.5–2.0 lakh** grievances per month (DARPG)

Other

Rate of bribing ≈ **40%**

Personal connection for grievance redressal: India has highest rate of people using personal connections to access public services (**46 per cent**) [Transparency international]

Police

DATA: FY 2026-27 (Budget) / 2024-25 (BPR&D / IJR)

BUDGET

Budget: Only **3%** of State and central budgets are allotted for policing.

VACANCIES

Vacancies: State police forces had ~**21–24%** vacancies (~5.3+ lakh vacant posts against sanctioned strength) (BPR&D / India Justice Report 2025)

Women in police = ~**11.75–12%** nationally (less than **8%** at officer level; Ladakh = **28%**) (BPR&D / India Justice Report 2025)

Police: Public Ratio = ~152–155 per lakh population (sanctioned ~197/lakh; UN recommended -> 222/lakh) (BPR&D / IJR 2025)

Constabulary Constitutes: ~**86%** of the state police forces.

WEAPONRY SHORTAGE

Weaponry Shortage (according to CAG audit report)

Rajasthan: **75%** shortage

West Bengal- **71%** shortage

Surveillance Vehicle Shortage: **30.5%** deficiency according to BPRD.

Union Budget 2026-27 -> allocated **₹2,55,234 crore (₹2.55 lakh crore)** to the Ministry of Home Affairs (up **9.44%** from **₹2.33 lakh crore in 2025**-26), with major funds directed towards central police forces (CAPFs) (Union Budget 2026-27).

Trust: Less than **25%** of Indians expressed trust in the police.

Prison Reforms

DATA: 2024-2025 (NCRB PSI 2024 & IJR 2025)

FUNCTIONAL JAILS

Functional Jails: 1,333 jails | Sanctioned Capacity of Prisons: 4.53 lakh inmates (actual inmate population exceeded **5.11 lakh** at the end of 2024, up from **4.25 lakh** capacity in 2021) [NCRB Prison Statistics India 2024]

Occupancy Rate [Overcrowding]: 112.7% nationally in 2024 (Delhi highest at **194.6%**, Meghalaya **163.5%**, J&K **148.3%**) [NCRB Prison Statistics India 2024] (>**130%** in earlier PSI / IJR 2025)

Undertrial: ~73% (72.6%) in 2024 (down from **77%** peak in 2021; Delhi and Bihar >**87%**) (NCRB Prison Statistics India 2024) 76% in [India Justice Report 2025]

Prison Reforms CONTINUED

Funding for Prisons: avg daily spend per inmate is mere Rs 121 (IJR 2025)

COMPOSITION OF PRISONS [NCRB'S PRISON STATISTICS INDIA - 2021]

Composition of Prisons [NCRB's Prison Statistics India – 2021]

Gender-wise: 4.3% are women prisoners.

Vulnerable Sections: Over 85% of prisoners are SC/ST/OBC/Muslims.

Psychologists: Only 25 psychologists for the entire prison population—an average of 1 for every 22,928 prisoners (Recommended: 1:500)

Doctors Availability: 1: 775 Prisoners vs 1:300 (Recommended) [IJR 2025]

Shortage of Staff: ~30–33% overall staff vacancy, with a 46.4% vacancy rate in sanctioned medical staff in 2024 (NCRB PSI 2024 / IJR 2025)

Lack of Child Centers: Nearly 18000 children are living in jails only because their parents are in jails.

RTI & OSA

DATA: 2023-2024

RTI

RTI Applications: 5000 application/day

Pending Cases: >4.05 lakh appeals and complaints pending across 29 Information Commissions (Satark Nagrik Sangathan Report 2023-24).

Rejection ratio: ~4–5% overall (CIC Annual Report) (typo fixed: Resection -> Rejection)

Awareness: only 15%

RTI rejection rate: the Home Ministry had the highest rate of rejections - >rejected 20% of all RTIs received.

SATARK NAGRIK SANGATHAN REPORT (2023-24)

7 out of 29 information commissions were defunct between July 2023 to June 2024.

> 9 commissions were without a chief information commissioner.

14 commissions would take 1 year or more to dispose a matter

Merely 9% of all information commissioners have been women

Social Audit

DATA: 2019-2026

SOCIAL AUDIT IN MGNREGA

Coverage: In 2019-20, social audits were carried out at least once in 63% of the total GPs (47% in 2018-19) (Ministry of Rural Development / Parliamentary Standing Committee).

Out of the 34 States and UTs only six have completed social audit of works done under MGNREGA in more than 50% of gram panchayats.

Over 5.8+ crore assets have been geo-tagged under MGNREGA GeoMGNREGA (up from 5.17 crore in Dec 2022; Economic Survey 2025-26 also highlights Viksit Bharat-GRAMG statutory overhaul aligning rural employment with Viksit Bharat 2047) (MoRD / Economic Survey 2025-26)

Social Sector

DATA: FY 2025-26 / Aug 2026

Social services expenditure (SSE): General government SSE rose to **7.9% of GDP in FY 2025-26 (BE)**, up from **7.7%** in FY25 (RE) and **7.0%** in FY24 (SSE as % of total expenditure rose from **23.3%** in FY21 to **26.2%** in FY25 BE) (Economic Survey 2025-26).

PUBLIC SERVICE DELIVERY

HEALTHCARE

Healthcare Spending: India spent **Rs 9.04 lakh crore** on health in FY 2022 -> **3.8% of GDP** or Rs 6,602/person at current prices (Eco. Survey)

National Health Mission (NHM): **5.23 lakh** workers, including **1.38 lakh** Community Health Officers. Certification of 7,998 public health facilities under National Quality Assurance Standards (NQAS).

Ayushman Bharat Digital Mission: > **42 crore** health records have been linked to ABHA.

EDUCATION

Literacy Rate: **74.04%** (2011 census)

77% (National Statistical Office (NSO)) -> nearly 8 out of 10 people can read and write.

Mid-Day Meal Scheme: covers about **11.80 crore** children studying in **11.20 lakh** schools across the country.

SANITATION

Swachh Bharat Mission (SBM): Declared rural India Open Defecation Free (ODF) in October 2019.

Swachh Bharat Mission Phase II – Grameen (SBM-G): During April- Nov 2024, **1.92 lakh** villages were incrementally declared ODF+ under model category, taking the total number of ODF+ villages to **3.64 lakh.**

Cleanliness Ranking: Indore has distinguished itself by winning the overall cleanest city award for seven consecutive years

SOCIAL WELFARE

Direct Benefit Transfer (DBT): total DBT was **₹6.91 lakh crore in FY24**

Public Distribution System (PDS): Covering around **800 million** beneficiaries under the NFSA.

ELECTRICITY

Saubhagya Scheme: Achieved **100%** village electrification in 2018, and near-universal household electrification.

Renewable energy: total non-fossil fuel installed electricity capacity reached **283.46 GW** (including **274.68 GW Renewable Energy**: **150.26 GW** Solar, **56.09 GW** Wind, **51.41 GW** Large Hydro) as of 31 March 2026, up from **203.18 GW** (MNRE / CEA 2026)

Power consumption rises **7%** to **148.48 bn** units in March 2025

Solar-plus-storage systems in India can now deliver round-the-clock electricity at under ₹6/kWh, cheaper than coal.

WATER SUPPLY

Jal Jeevan Mission

Addition of **75.89%** connections since the launch of the mission.

Households with tap water connections increased from **3.23 crore** (**17%**) of rural households in 2019 to **15.91 crore (>81% of rural households) as of August 2026** (up from **15.44 crore** in Feb 2025; JJM 2.0 extended to Dec 2028 with **₹8.69 lakh crore** outlay) (Ministry of Jal Shakti / PIB Aug 2026).

URBAN DEVELOPMENT

Smart Cities Mission: As of March 2026, **7,790 projects worth ₹1,56,257 crore (₹1.56 lakh crore)** have been completed out of ~8,058 projects (up from 7,479 projects worth **₹1.50 lakh crore** in Jan 2025) (MoHUA / PIB Aug 2026)

Civil Services

Civil Services

DATA: 2024-25

CIVIL SERVICES

Total: ~6,800+ sanctioned IAS strength (~5,500+ in position; only ~7% serving on central deputation) (DoPT)

Shortage of nearly 1,300–1,600 IAS officers against sanctioned strength (DoPT / Parliamentary Standing Committee) (typo fixed: nearby -> nearly)

Efficiency: 25% IAS officers corrupt, incompetent, or inefficient; middle 50% complacent: D Subbarao

GS PAPER II · SECTION

Development Processes & Policies

SHGs

Micro Credit

DATA: FY24-FY25

Contribution: 2.03% to the country's GDP

Growth rate: Indian micro finance sector soared 2,100% in past 12 years

Employment: 13 million jobs

Distribution of loans: 76% of portfolio is in rural areas, & 24% is in urban areas.

SHG-Bank Linkage Programme: empowers 17.8 crore households through more than 144 lakh credit-linked SHGs (NABARD Status of Microfinance in India Report).

Entrepreneurship: 46% of such loans are provided to families having monthly income < Rs. 20,000, for working capital for their income generating activities

Pain point -> Crisis: Gross NPAs / PAR in microfinance stress segments reached up to ~11–16% in FY25 amid borrower over-leveraging (MFIN / Sa-Dhan / RBI FSR).

SHGs

DATA: FY24-FY26 (Jan 2025–2026)

SBI STUDY

Incomes of female members of SHGs have more than tripled in last five years.

~97.5% of the SHGs have bank accounts.

~65% of rural SHG members have moved upwards in terms of relative income in FY24 as compared to FY19.

Over 10.05 crore rural women households have been mobilized into 90.90+ lakh Self Help Groups (SHGs) under DAY-NRLM (with 3 crore 'Lakhpati Didis' target; >1.15 crore already achieved) (MoRD / Economic Survey 2025-26)

Civil Society

NGOs

DATA: 2023-2025

Number of NGOs: Approximately **3.1–3.3 million** NGOs (1 NGO per ~400 people) (CBI / Central Statistical Institute submission to Supreme Court; >**2.4 lakh** registered on NITI Aayog NGO Darpan portal)

Total Donations Received: **Rs 55,741.51 crore** (foreign contribution) (From FY 2019-20 to 2021-22)

FCRA licenses: ~16,000+ NGOs with active/valid FCRA licences (16,301 as on July 17, 2023) (Ministry of Home Affairs FCRA Dashboard).

REGISTRATION AND COMPLIANCE

Only **2%** of NGOs are registered

More than **90%** of these registered NGOs do not submit their balance sheets

NGO: People - 1 NGO for 400 people

IB report: Working of few NGOs in the name of protests against the government activities led to a loss of **2-3%** of the country's GDP.

Government Schemes and Policies

Sports Ecosystem

DATA: 2024-2026

SPORTS ECOSYSTEM

Olympic 2036: India has submitted a formal Letter of Intent to the IOC to **host the 2036 Olympics**

Union Budget 2026-27 also announced the **Khelo India Mission** to transform the sports sector over the next decade (Ministry of Youth Affairs & Sports / Union Budget 2026-27)

Sports participation: Only around **6%** of India's population participates in sports (**20%** in countries like the US, Australia and as high as **60%** in Japan)

Paris Olympics 2024: India sent 117 athletes (winning 6 medals: 1 silver, 5 bronze; alongside a record 29 medals at the Paris Paralympics 2024) [594 athletes from the U.S., 572 from France, and 460 from Australia] (IOA / MYAS).

Aspiration: top ten sports nation by 2036 and a top 5 by 2047.

Khelo India scheme spent only **Rs 318 crore** out of **Rs 500 crore** allocated in 2019-20 (Parliamentary Standing Committee on Human Resource Development).

GS PAPER II

International Relations

FACT SHEETS IN THIS SUBJECT — TAP ANY TITLE TO JUMP TO IT

INDIA'S NEIGHBOURHOOD
INDIA'S MAJOR BILATERAL RELATIONS
INDIA-EUROPE
Central Asia
INDIA-ASIA PACIFIC
Africa
INDIA AND WEST ASIA
INDIAN DIASPORA
MULTILATERAL

GS PAPER II · SECTION

Neighborhood & Bilateral Engagements

Neighbourhood

INDIA'S NEIGHBOURHOOD

DATA: FY 2023-24 to FY 2025-26

NEPAL

Bilateral Trade: $**8.66 billion in FY 2022**-23

India's merchandise exports to Nepal stood at **$7.45 billion ($7,447.11 million) in FY 2025-26** (MoC&I / PIB July 2026)

- **Trade Relations**:
  - India is Nepal's largest trade partner -> **64.1%** of Nepal's total trade
  - Bilateral Free trade agreement (2009): between India and Nepal
- **Hydropower**: Investments from Indian companies, around **USD 2.48 billion.** In 2023, India approved the first Nepal-Bangladesh power trade via its territory for up to **40 MW**.
- **MOUs**: India, Nepal ink 10 MoUs worth Nepalese **Rs.625 million** for community development projects (April 2025)
- **Line of Credit**: Line of credit of $**680 million** by India to fund three major transmission corridors in Nepal - Bheri Corridor, Nijgadh-Inaruwa Corridor and Gandak-Nepalgunj Corridor.

BHUTAN

Bilateral trade: $**1.34 billion in FY 2022**-23

India's merchandise exports to Bhutan reached **$1.25 billion ($1,252.86 million) in FY 2025-26** (MoC&I / PIB July 2026)

- **Trading Partner**: India is the largest trading partner (Bhutan imports **88%** from India)

Development assistance: India doubled assistance to **₹10,000 crore for Bhutan's 13th Five-Year Plan (2024-2029)**, up from **₹4,500-5,000 crore** in the **12th** Plan (MEA)

- **Foreign direct investments**: India contributes to **50%** of the Bhutan's total foreign direct investment (FDI)

PAKISTAN

Bilateral Trade: From 2018 to 2024, bilateral trade fell from $**2.41bn** to $**1.2bn.**

Trade Relations:

- India withdrew MFN status (after Pulwama)
- Pakistan suspended Bilateral Trade (After the August 370 decision)
- India consists of **3%** of Pakistan's total trade.
- Pakistani exports to India plummeted from $547.5m in 2019 to just $480,000 in 2024. India Exports to Pakistan was US$1.18 Billion during 2024

MYANMAR

Bilateral Trade: $**1.33 billion in FY23**-24

Development assistance: India has already extended **$2 billion** in soft loans

Indian companies: Essar, GAIL, and ONGC Videsh Ltd. have invested in Myanmar's energy sector.

Exports: India Exports: **US$609.18 million during 2024**

Imports: Imports from Myanmar: US$1.52 Billion during 2024

SRI LANKA

Bilateral trade: India is Sri Lanka's largest trading partner ($**5.5 billion in FY 2023**-24; India's merchandise exports to Sri Lanka reached **$5.52 billion ($5,516.83 million) in FY 2025-26**) (MoC&I / PIB July 2026).

- **Trade Partner**: India is Sri Lanka's largest trade partner

INDIA'S NEIGHBOURHOOD CONTINUED

Exports: US$4.72 Billion in 2024

Imports: **US$967.76 million in 2024**

FDI: investments of **USD 2.25 billion** till 2023.

Development assistance:

- Assistance of **USD 14.9 million** by India to undertake a Signaling System in the Maho Anuradhapura segment of Sri Lankan railways.
- India has extended over **USD 7 billion** in credit and **USD 780 million** in grants to Sri Lanka.
- India extended a $**400 million** currency swap post-COVID and has invested over $**2.25 billion** in Sri Lanka
- A **USD 400 million** currency swap through the Reserve Bank of India.

BANGLADESH

Bilateral Trade: **USD 14.01 billion** (2023-24)

Trade Partner: Bangladesh is India's largest trading partner in South Asia.

Exports: India's exports: **USD 11.06 billion**

Imports: India's imports: **USD 1.8 billion.**

Trade Agreements: As SAFTA members, India and Bangladesh receive preferential tariff concessions.

Lines of Credit: In last **8 years**, India has extended ~**US$ 8 billion** of Lines of Credit (LOC)

AFGHANISTAN

Bilateral Trade: **USD 1.5 billion in 2019**-20

Exports: India's exports: **USD 355.45 million in 2023**-24.

Imports: India's imports: **USD 642.29 million in 2023**-24.

Developmental assistance: India has committed over **3 billion** US$ for development efforts in Afghanistan.

GS PAPER II · SECTION

Global Geopolitics & Indian Diaspora

Bilateral Relations

INDIA'S MAJOR BILATERAL RELATIONS

DATA: FY 2024-25 to FY 2025-26

USA

Bilateral trade: $**131.84 billion in FY 2024**-25 ($**129 billion in CY 2024**; India recorded a $**34.4 billion** trade surplus with the US in FY 2025-26 and $**40.89 billion in FY 2024**-25) (MoC&I).

Target: Mission 500-> $**500 billion by 2030**.

Largest trading partner: The U.S. was India's largest trading partner in FY 2024-25, while China surpassed the US to become the largest trading partner in FY 2025-26 (MoC&I 2026).

Investments: Indian companies have invested $**7.35 billion** in the US

Defense Relations: US is India's **4th largest arms** supplier.

Defense agreements: GSOMIA (2002), LEMOA (2016), COMCASA (2018), BECA (2020)

CHINA

Bilateral trade: Surged in FY 2025-26 (imports from China rose **16%** to **$131.63 billion** in FY 2025-26; bilateral trade was $**118.4B**–$**127.7B in FY24**/FY25) (MoC&I 2026)

Trade deficit: Trade deficit with China widened from $**85.1 billion** (FY24) and $**99.2 billion** (FY25) to an all-time high of **$112.6 billion in FY 2025-26** (MoC&I 2026)

INDIA'S MAJOR BILATERAL RELATIONS CONTINUED

Exports: Top Exports to China: Iron ore, refined petroleum, cyclic hydrocarbons and organic chemicals.

Imports: Top Imports from China: Electrical machinery, telecom instruments, mineral fuels including oil, fertilizers, organic chemicals, computer hardware

Bilateral Economic Presence:

Chinese Companies in India: 174 registered companies

Indian companies in China: 54

RUSSIA

Bilateral trade: Reached ~$65.7–$**68.7 billion in FY24**/FY25 (targeting $**100 billion** bilateral trade by 2030) (MEA / MoC&I)

Investment: India's investments in Russia were estimated to be **USD 16 billion.** Russian Investments in India total around **USD 20 billion.**

Energy Security: India's Russian crude oil imports will hit close to **1.8 million** barrels per day in May 2025.

Line of credit: India extended a $**1 billion** credit line for Russia's Far East development.

Historical Ties: Russia historically provided around **47%** of India's arms imports, down from **65%** historically.

CANADA

Bilateral Trade: $**12 billion in 2023**.

Exports: India's exports: $**3.80 billion**

Imports: India's imports: $**5.56 billion.**

Investment: Canadian Pension Funds have cumulatively invested over $ **75 billion** in India

Diaspora: ~**1.8 million**

> **3%** of its total population.

FDI: Canada is the **18th largest foreign investor** in India; invested $**3,306 million** between April 2000 and March 2023.

CEPA: In 2010, Canada and India launched negotiations toward a Comprehensive Economic Partnership Agreement (CEPA).

Top Exports from India: The main items exported by India to Canada are Jewellery, Cotton yarn, Organic chemicals, Coffee, Spices, Iron and steel articles, Textiles, Carpets, Floor spreads, and processed foods.

Top Imports to India: The main products exported from Canada to India were Dried Legumes, Coal Briquettes, and Potassic Fertilizers.

INDIA-EUROPE

DATA: 2024–July 2026

UNITED KINGDOM

Bilateral Trade: $**57 billion in 2024**

Trade Relations:

India was the UK's **11th largest trading partner** in 2024, accounting for **2.4% of total** UK trade.

Exports and Imports: India's exports stood at $**8.5 billion** and imports were $**3.7 billion.**

FDI: India is second-largest investor in terms of the number of FDI projects for the UK for five consecutive years.

Economic asymmetry: India's larger economy ($**4 trillion**) contrasts with UK's higher per capita income ($50,000 vs. $3,000).

India-UK Comprehensive Economic and Trade Agreement (CETA / FTA, effective 15 July 2026 - MoC&I):

It aims to double trade between the world's fifth and sixth-largest economies in goods and services, increasing it from $**60 billion** currently to $**120 billion by 2030**.

Grants zero-duty access for **99%** of Indian exports to the UK (India's merchandise exports to the UK reached **$13.44 billion ($13,444.19 million) in FY 2025-26**; additionally, the **India–EFTA TEPA entered into force in October 2025** offering **99.6%** Indian export coverage) (MoC&I / PIB July 2026).

INDIA-EUROPE CONTINUED

- Tariffs on automobiles will drop significantly, from over **100 percent** to **10 percent** under a special quota system
- Expected outcomes:
  - UK's GDP by £**3.3 billion by 2035** and double bilateral trade from **US$60 billion in 2024** to **US$100 billion by 2030**.
  - bilateral trade, with projected annual growth of around **15 percent** until calendar year 2030 [Care Edge report].

SPAIN

Bilateral trade: $**9.9 billion in 2023**

Trade Partner: Spain is India's **6th largest trade partner** in Europe

Investments: Spain is **16th largest investor** in India, with $**4.2 billion** in FDI (April 2000 – June 2024) with over 280 Spanish companies active in India.

Indian Investments: Indian companies have invested over **US$ 900 million** in Spain predominantly in the IT services, pharmaceuticals, and logistics sectors

GERMANY

Bilateral trade: Germany is India's largest trade partner in Europe, with bilateral trade reaching **US$ 33.33 billion in 2023**.

Trading partner: Germany continued to be the **12th largest trading partner** for India also in 2023-24.

Exports and imports: Indian exports to Germany rose to **US$10.1 billion**, while German imports to India stood at around **US$14.9 billion.**

Foreign Direct Investments: Germany is the **9th largest foreign direct** investor in India, with a cumulative FDI of **US$ 14.5 billion**, with around 1,800 German companies operating in India.

Development cooperation: The total volume of bilateral technical and financial cooperation by the end of 2023 amounted to about Euro **24 billion.**

FRANCE

Bilateral Trade: Trade: **USD 13 billion in FY2022**-23

EU Partner: France is India's **11th largest trading partner** in the European Union, with bilateral trade exceeding $**12 billion in 2023**.

Exports: **US$ 7 billion**

Imports: **US$5.82 billion**

Central Asia

DATA: 2023-24

INDIA CENTRAL ASIA

CENTRAL ASIA

Trade: ~$2–$**3 billion in 2023**-24 (with Kazakhstan accounting for over half of India's trade with Central Asia) (MEA / MoC&I)

- **Exports**: Exports from India to Central Asia: Pharmaceuticals, mechanical equipment, auto parts, textiles, and optical instruments.
- **Imports**: Imports from Central Asia to India: Fruits and vegetables, juice products, lubricants, fertilizers, and raw materials.

Nuclear Fuel: Kazakhstan is the largest supplier, accounting for ~**80%** of India's imported uranium fuel (DAE / MEA)

INDIA-ASIA PACIFIC

DATA: FY 2023-24 to FY 2025-26

ASEAN

Trade: $122.67 billion in FY 2023-24 (~$123 billion in FY25; India's merchandise exports to ASEAN under AIFTA stood at $38.42 billion ($38,416.33 million) in FY 2025-26) (MoC&I / PIB July 2026)

Exports and Imports: Exports at $ 41.2 billion; imports were at $80 billion during 2023-24.

Diaspora: Over 6 million strong Indian diaspora in the region

SOUTH KOREA

Trade Relations: $27.8 billion in FY 2022-23 (India's merchandise exports to South Korea under CEPA stood at $6.01 billion ($6,012.03 million) in FY 2025-26) (MoC&I / PIB July 2026).

Trade Target: India and South Korea aim to reach a bilateral trade volume of USD 50 billion by 2030

Exports and Imports: India's imports were $21.13 billion, while exports were only $6.41 billion.

JAPAN

Bilateral Trade: Stood at $22.85 billion in FY24 (India's merchandise exports to Japan under CEPA reached $6.04 billion ($6,039.50 million) in FY 2025-26) (MoC&I / PIB July 2026).

Exports and Imports: Exports from Japan to India during 2023-24 were US$ 17.69 billion and imports were US$ 5.15 billion.

FDI: Japan is among the top 5 FDI sources

Economic Rank: India surpassed Japan to become the 4th largest economy in the world

Agreement: India-Japan CEPA (2011) covers trade, services, investments, and IPRs.

AUSTRALIA

Bilateral Trade: ~$24.1 billion merchandise trade in FY 2024-25 (~$30 billion total trade; India's merchandise exports to Australia under ECTA stood at $7.28 billion ($7,284.17 million) in FY 2025-26) (MoC&I / PIB July–Aug 2026)

Trade Rank: India is Australia's fifth largest trading partner

Exports and Imports: India's goods exports reaching $7.94 billion and imports at $16.15 billion.

Africa

DATA: 2023-2025

INDIA AFRICA

AFRICA

Trade: USD 83.34 billion in FY 2023-24 (crossed ~$100 billion in FY 2024-25; targeting $200 billion by 2030) (MoC&I / MEA)

Trade Rank: India is Africa's 4th largest trading partner

Exports and Imports: India's exports at $45 billion and imports at $38 billion

Investments: India's cumulative investments in Africa reached ~$75–$98 billion (making India among the top 5 investors in Africa, alongside >$12 billion in Lines of Credit across 42 African countries) (MEA / CII-EXIM Bank)

UN Peacekeepers: 6,000 Indian soldiers in UN peace-keeping missions in five conflict zones in Africa.

Groupings involving Immediate and Extended neighbours

INDIA AND WEST ASIA

DATA: FY 2023-24 to FY 2025-26

IRAN

Bilateral Trade: $2.33 billion (2022-23)

Exports: Exports to Iran: $1.66 billion (14.34% growth YOY)

Imports: Imports from Iran: $672.12 million (45.05% growth YOY).

UAE

Bilateral Trade: Crossed $100 billion in FY 2024-25 (up from $83.7 billion in FY 2023-24; India's merchandise exports to the UAE under CEPA reached $37.36 billion ($37,359.11 million) in FY 2025-26) (MoC&I / PIB July 2026).

Trade Partner: India is the UAE's second-largest trading partner

Crude oil: UAE is India's 4th largest source of crude oil and the 2nd largest source of LNG & LPG.

Strategic Oil Reserves: UAE is the only nation in the region to offer to store strategic oil reserves in India.

Exports: $48 billion in FY2023-24. Non-oil exports reached $27.4 billion.

Imports: USD 50.51 billion

Remittances: About $14 billion a year.

Diaspora: around 30% of the UAE's population

3.5 million (largest ethnic group in the country)

Agreements: India and UAE implemented CEPA (May 2022) and Bilateral Investment Treaty (BIT, 2024)

India also implemented the India–Oman CEPA on 1 June 2026 granting duty-free access to 99.38% of Indian exports by value (MoC&I / PIB July 2026).

SAUDI ARABIA

Bilateral Trade: ~USD 43 billion (2023-24).

Trade Rank: India is Saudi Arabia's 2nd largest trading partner, and Saudi Arabia is India's 5th.

Crude oil imports: India's 3rd largest source of crude oil and petroleum products (2023–24).

Remittances: 6.7% of India's total inward remittances.

Investments: Saudi Arabia has invested around USD 10 billion in India so far and in 2019, it announced plans to invest USD 100 billion more.

Vision 2030 Synergy: Saudi Arabia's Vision 2030 aims to diversify its economy, and India is seen as a key partner in this transformation

ISRAEL PALESTINE

Israel Bilateral Trade: USD 10.1 billion in FY 2022-2023.

Israel Trade Rank: India is Israel's 2nd trading partner in Asia and the 9th largest globally.

Israel Diaspora: Approximately 85,000 Jews of Indian origin live in Israel.

Israel Diamond Trade: Trade in diamonds constitutes about 50% of bilateral trade.

Palestine Bilateral Trade: $67.77 million in 2020

Palestine Aid: India has donated around $141 million in various forms of aid to the Palestinian Authority, including $39 million in administrative support.

QATAR

Bilateral Trade: USD 14.08 billion (2023-24)

Target: Aim to double bilateral trade from $14 billion to $28 billion in the next five years.

LNG: Qatar is India's largest LNG supplier, providing over 40% of imports.

INDIA AND WEST ASIA CONTINUED

Exports and Imports: In 2023-24, the country's imports from Qatar stood at **USD 12.34 billion**, while its exports were only **USD 1.7 billion.**

Exports Detail: India's primary exports to Qatar include Basmati rice (**USD 124 million**), articles of iron and steel (**USD 200 million**), and machinery (**USD 106 million**)

Imports Detail: A large portion (**85 per cent**) of India's imports from Qatar comprises LNG (**USD 6.3 billion**), butane, propane mostly for LPG production (**USD 3.1 billion**), and petroleum crude (**USD 1.1 billion**)

PERSIAN GULF

Trade: **USD 161.59 billion during 2023**-24

Oil and Gas: Around **60%** of India's crude oil imports come from GCC countries.

Indian Diaspora

INDIAN DIASPORA

DATA: 2024 / FY 2024-25

INDIAN DIASPORA

Population: **35.42 million** (**15.85 million** NRIs and **19.57 million** PIOs/OCIs) as of May 2024 [MEA Overseas Indian Population Data]

- **Top overseas populations**: Top three countries with largest Indian overseas populations are the United States (**5.4 million**), the United Arab Emirates (**3.6 million**), and Malaysia (**2.9 million**).
- **Remittance Share**: India got **14.3% of global** remittances in 2024
- **Indian-American contributions**:
  - The US is the top source of remittance ($**26B** out of $**113 billion in 2022**- 2023).
  - ~**20%** of Indian unicorns have cofounders who have leveraged US higher education.
  - **13%** of US scientific publications had Indian American co-author.
  - **1** in 10 Americans practices yoga (2023)

REMITTANCES

Remittances Inflow: Reached a record **USD 135.4 billion in FY 2024-25** (up from **USD 118.7 billion in FY 2023**-24 and **USD 129.4 billion in CY 2024**) (RBI / Economic Survey 2025-26).

- **Top Sources**: Top 5 source countries: US (**27.7%**) followed by the UAE, the UK, Saudi Arabia, and Singapore.
- **Top Recipients**: Top 3 recipient states in India: Maharashtra (**20.5%**), followed by Kerala and Tamil Nadu.
- **GDP contribution**: Economic contribution: **3-3.5%** of India's GDP since 2000
- **Kerala**: Over **36%** of Kerala's state domestic product, boosting per capita income.

GS PAPER II · SECTION

International Organizations

United Nations and its Agencies

MULTILATERAL

DATA: 2023-2026

BRICS

GDP: Expanded BRICS+ accounts for ~**37.3%** of world GDP in PPP terms (compared to EU's **14.5%** and G7's **29.3%**) (IMF / BRICS 2024-25)

Population: BRICS countries collectively account for **46%** of the global population, with significant populations in China and India

Total Intra-BRICS Trade: **US$614.8 billion** as of 2022.

Powerful driver for the global economy:

Over the past decade, the combined BRICS GDP has grown by **179%**.

Total trade of the member nations has expanded by **94%**.

SAARC

Geography: **3%** of the world's land area

Population: **21%** of the world's population

Global GDP: **5.21%** (**US$4.47 trillion**) of the global economy, as of 2021.

Intra SAARC Trade: Their intra-regional trade stands at just **5.8%**.

BIMSTEC

Population: Home to around **1.5 billion** people that constitute around **22%** of the global population

GDP: Combined Gross Domestic Product (GDP) of **USD 3.8 trillion.**

Intra-BIMSTEC trade: Around **7%** of the total trade among member countries as of the latest data.

Trade Volume: The total intra-BIMSTEC trade volume was about $**60 billion in 2023**

Trade potential: The Bay of Bengal is the largest bay in the world and is the route for about **25 percent** of global trade.

G20

Population: Almost two-thirds of the global population

Global GDP: **75% of global** trade, and **85%** of the world's GDP.

CO2 emissions: The G20 countries are responsible for approximately **80% of global** carbon dioxide emissions.

Military spending: The G20 countries account for approximately **85% of global** military spending.

Foreign direct investment: The G20 countries account for approximately **80% of global** foreign direct investment.

QUAD

Combined GDP: The combined GDP of the QUAD countries is approximately **35.08%** of the world GDP.

Combined Population: The combined population of the QUAD countries is approximately **23.78%** of the world population.

Combined Defense Spending: The combined defense spending of the QUAD countries is approximately **46.88%** of the world defense spending.

IPEF

Total GDP: The combined GDP -> **USD 33.99 trillion.**

Total Population: The total population of these countries is around **2.451 billion** people.

MULTILATERAL CONTINUED

Total Trade Volume: The total trade volume of the member countries is about **USD 11.705 trillion.**

SCO

Combined GDP: The combined GDP -> **23%** of the world GDP.

Population: **42%** of the world population.

Defense Spending: The combined defense spending is approximately **20.61%** of the world defense spending.

NATO

Combined GDP: The combined GDP of the major NATO countries is approximately **37.90%** of the world GDP.

Combined Population: The combined population is approximately **7.34%** of the world population.

Combined Defense Spending: The combined defense spending is approximately **48.93%** of the world defense spending.

Combined Budget: Combined total budget: $**1.47 trillion in 2024**

Intra-NATO Trade: Combined intra-NATO trade: Approximately $**3.3 trillion** (2023)

WTO

GDP: Estimates suggest that WTO members contribute approximately **98%** of world GDP.

Population: WTO members represent approximately **96%** of the world population.

Trade: Combined Intra-WTO Trade: Approximately $**33 trillion** (**75% of global** trade)

RCEP

Status: It is the world's largest free trade agreement by members' GDP.

GDP: Combined GDP of RCEP Countries: Approximately $**30.53 trillion** (**29.36%** of world GDP)

Population: Combined Population of RCEP Countries: Approximately **2317 million** (**28.96%** of world population)

Defense: Combined Defense Spending of RCEP Countries: Approximately $**485.3 billion** (**21.67%** of world defense spending)

Trade: Intra-RCEP Trade: Approximately $**13.2 trillion** (**30% of global** trade)

NAM

Population: Combined Population: Approximately **4.8 billion** (2023)

3 Largest Countries by Population:

India: Approximately **1.42 billion**

Indonesia: Approximately **280 million**

Pakistan: Approximately **243 million**\

GDP: Approximate Combined GDP: $**28 trillion** (estimation based on major members)

World Share: Approximately **26.92%** of world GDP

G7

Population: Combined Population: **10%** of world population

Share: Contribution: **40% of global** economy

GDP: Combined GDP: Approximately $**45.62 trillion**

IORA

Population: Approximately **2.7 billion**

3 Largest Countries:

India: **1.42 billion**

Indonesia: **280 million**

Bangladesh: **170 million**

GDP: Combined GDP: Approximately $**10 trillion**

World Share: Approximately **9.62%** of world GDP

INDIA'S CONTRIBUTION TO UNPKF

Troops: Contributed **>2,90,000 troops** cumulatively (up from >2,53,000), the largest cumulative contributor from any country (MEA / UN Peacekeeping 2025-26).

MULTILATERAL CONTINUED

Missions: Participated in **51+ out of 71 UN peacekeeping missions** established since 1948 (MEA / UN).

Deployments: Currently, Indian Armed Forces are deployed across 9 countries in peacekeeping missions like UN Disengagement Observer Force (UNDOF) (Golan), UN Interim Force in Lebanon (UNFIL), etc.

Women Contingent: First country to deploy All Women Contingent in 2007 to United Nations Mission in Liberia (UNMIL).

GS PAPER II

Polity

FACT SHEETS IN THIS SUBJECT — TAP ANY TITLE TO JUMP TO IT

GENERAL
SIGNIFICANT PROVISIONS
CONSTITUTION
PARLIAMENT
JUDICIARY
FEDERALISM
EMERGENCY
LOCAL SELF GOVERNMENT
ELECTIONS

GS PAPER II · SECTION

Constitutional Framework & Evolution

Constitutional Morality

GENERAL

DATA: 2024-2026

DEMOCRACY

V-Dem Democracy Report (2024–2026 - V-Dem Institute)

V-Dem Institute (University of Gothenburg) classifies India as an 'electoral autocracy' (since 2018) in its 2024–2026 Democracy Reports (V-Dem Institute).

SIGNIFICANT PROVISIONS

DATA: 2023-2025

STATUS OF REFUGEES

Recognized Refugees: >2 Lac (UNHCR)

Non Recognized refugees: 20 million, mostly from Bangladesh.

Internally Displaced People: more than 5 lakh

International Scenario: UN - over 100 million migrants living outside their country of birth in 2022.

Rohingyas: 22,500 Rohingya refugees currently reside in India (UNHCR)

Kashmiri pandits: up to 3 lakh

Bru refugees: 30,000 in Tripura - from Mizoram.

RESERVATIONS IN INDIA

OBC/SC/ST: 27% / 15% / 7.5%

Reservation Limit: 50% - Indra Sawhney v Union of India (1992)

EWS reservation is outside this limit.

Miniscule Representation of SC/ST at Higher Levels: SC/ST representation at Secretary, Joint Sec. level in Centre stands at 4% and 4.9% resp. (Rajya Sabha data from 2022)

Prevalence of Untouchability: National Campaign for Dalit Human Rights - 38% of government schools require students to have lunch separately.

OBC RESERVATION

Dominance of Few Section: 24.95% of jobs and seats to just 10 OBC communities.

97% of all jobs and educational seats – to 25% of all sub-castes classified as OBCs.

0 Representation: 983 OBC communities (37%) - zero representation in jobs and educational institutions.

SOCIO-ECONOMIC CASTE CENSUS (SECC)

Households: 24.49 cr - 17.97 cr living in **villages**

Landlessness

56% of rural households do not have access to agricultural land.

5.37cr(29.97%) rural households are "landless" & rely on manual labour.

SC/ST Families: 21.53% of village families (3.86 cr)

Illiteracy: 36% of the rural population (884 million) is illiterate > than the 32% reported in 2011 Census

Poverty: Urban Households vs Rural households:: 35% vs 60%

Manual Scavenging: 1.80 Lakh households

SIGNIFICANT PROVISIONS CONTINUED

SEDITION IN INDIA

No. of cases: 701 cases of sedition and offences against the State from 2018 to 2022

Rate of Conviction: **33.3%** in 2020 (NCRB)

PREVENTIVE DETENTION

Rise in Arrests: **1.1 lakh** people were arrested and detained under preventive detention laws in **2021 - 23.7%** rise over 2020 (NCRB)

INTERNET FREEDOM (FREEDOM ON THE NET REPORT 2024 & 2025 - FREEDOM HOUSE)

Global internet freedom declined for the **15th consecutive year in 2025** (**14th** in 2024) (Freedom House, Freedom on the Net 2025).

Iceland -> 'freest online environment' in the world

India -> classified in the **'partly free'** category (score 50–51 out of 100 in 2024–2025) (Freedom House 2025).

INTERNET SHUTDOWNS

India: 84 shutdowns (Highest in any democracy) affecting 16 states and territories. (Access Now 2024 report)

Economic cost: shutdowns reportedly cost India total $**1.9 billion** and $**118 million** in foreign investment in the first half of 2023 alone.

In 2020, India suffered losses of $**2.8 billion** due to 129 separate instances of internet suspension.

Internet Society's NetLoss Calculator-> a single-day shutdown can push up to 379 people into unemployment in India.

Global: 296 shutdowns were recorded across 54 countries in 2024, an increase from 283 in 2023.

CAPITAL PUNISHMENT

World: More than 2/**3rd countries** - abolished [Amnesty international].

Prevalent in Asia: India, China, Iran etc. where **60%** population of the world lives [Law commission].

India: **561 prisoners on death row** by end of 2023 (up from 544 as of Dec 31, 2022; highest in nearly two decades) (Project 39A, NLU Delhi / NCRB).

CITIZENSHIP AMENDMENT ACT, 2019

Citizenship to 6 non-Muslim communities: Hindus, Sikhs, Buddhists, Jains, Parsis and Christians

Date: who entered India on or before **31st** December, 2014

Making of the Constitution

CONSTITUTION

DATA: As of 2026 (106 Amendments)

TIME TAKEN

11 sessions - **2 years**, **11 months** and **18 days**.

PREAMBLE

November 26, 1949 as the date of enactment of the constitution.

CONSTITUTIONS REFERRED

Constitution of about 60 countries.

CONSTITUTION CONTINUED

ARTICLES

448 Articles divided into 25 parts and 12 schedules.

BASIC STRUCTURE

Keshavananda Bharati case - 24th April, 1973.

RIGIDITY VS FLEXIBILITY

US Constitution - amended 27 times in over 230 years vs Indian Constitution - amended 106 times (up to the 106th Constitutional Amendment Act, 2023 – Nari Shakti Vandan Adhiniyam) (Legislative Department, Ministry of Law & Justice).

GS PAPER II · SECTION

Organs of Government & Dispute Redressal

Role of MPs

PARLIAMENT

DATA: 2023-2025 (17th & 18th Lok Sabha)

RAJYA SABHA

Regional Variation: Uttar Pradesh - 31 vs Tripura has 1

PARLIAMENTARY SCRUTINY AND ACCOUNTABILITY

Departmentally Related Standing Committees: Lok Sabha – 16 and Rajya Sabha – 8 **Decreasing Discussion Level**

Decrease in the Sitting Days: Reduced from an annual avg of 121 days (1952-70) to only annual 55 days in 17th LS.

Lack of Scrutiny: Just 16% of the Bills were referred to standing committees for further scrutiny, declining from 28% in the previous Lok Sabha (It was 71% in 15th LS)

Suspensions of MPs: A record 146 MPs (100 from Lok Sabha and 46 from Rajya Sabha) were suspended during the Winter Session of Parliament in December 2023 (17th Lok Sabha) (PRS Legislative Research).

LOW WOMEN REPRESENTATION

18th Lok Sabha (2024): 13.6% (74 women MPs out of 543) (ECI / PRS)

17th Lok Sabha: 14.3% (78)

Judiciary

JUDICIARY

DATA: 2025-2026

JUDGES TO POPULATION RATIO

~15–21 judges per million population (15 working judges per million in India Justice Report 2025; ~21 sanctioned judges per million in Department of Justice data)

150 per million – USA

Law Commission (India) -> 50 per million

JUDICIARY CONTINUED

LOW FEMALE REPRESENTATION

Supreme Court: Till date, only 11 female judges in Supreme Court

High Court: 11.5% Judges are female

Subordinate courts: 30% Judges are women

Female Advocates: Out of 1.7 million registered, only 15% are women

HUGE PENDENCY

Supreme Court: 82,445 pending cases (Jan 2025)

High Courts and Subordinate courts: >5.1 crore pending cases across District/Subordinate Courts (~4.5+ crore) and High Courts (~62.98 lakh as of April 2025), plus ~82,000+ in Supreme Court (NJDG / India Justice Report 2025)

Extent of Problem

1,514 cases in High Courts and 1,390 in subordinate and district courts have been pending for over 50 years.

In subordinate courts, more than 50 per cent of cases have been pending for over three years.

Government the Largest Litigant: involvement of the Indian government as the largest litigant, contributing to 50% of pending cases.

Justice Delayed: At the current disposal rate if no new cases added

Supreme Court - 1.3 years and High Courts and Subordinate Courts – 3 years.

HC - 21% cases pending for over 10 years

Subordinate Courts - 23% cases for over five years

INFRASTRUCTURE DEFICIENCY

Lack of Courtrooms: shortage of 4,200 courtrooms for judges across the country (Centre for Research and Planning of Supreme Court of India report)

District courts: ~37.7% of Judicial Officers (JOs) have reported lack of adequate space in courtrooms.

Low Spending: 0.09% of GDP to maintain the judicial infrastructure.

No Power Backup: 59% of courtrooms

Toilets: 26% of court complexes do not have separate ladies toilets and 16% do not have gents' toilets.

Drinking water facility: Only 54% of court complexes have purified drinking water facilities.

Record room: Only 32% of courtrooms have separate Record Rooms.

Library: Only 51% of court complexes have a library.

Video-conference Facility: Only 27% of courtrooms have computers placed on the Judge's dais with video-conferencing facilities.

50% of lawyers, particularly in district courts, do not have any laptop or computer facility

LOK ADALAT

National Lok Adalat settles 1.45 crore cases, prevents 1.22 crore new cases (2024)

GRAM NYAYALAYAS

Target: 2500

Limited implementation: only 476 notified by just 15 states

Operational: 314

No GN in North East

FAST TRACK SPECIAL COURTS

745+ Fast Track Special Courts (FTSCs), including 404+ exclusive e-POCSO Courts, operational across 30 States/UTs (disposing >3.06 lakh cases) (Department of Justice, Ministry of Law & Justice)

collectively disposed of over 3,06,604 cases to date.

1800 FTCs recommended by 14th Fin Commission

JUDICIARY CONTINUED

TRANSPARENCY ISSUES - JUDGES ASSET DISCLOSURE

Out of 769 High Court judges, only 95 (**12.35%**) have publicly disclosed their assets.

Kerala High Court leads with **18%** of its judges disclosing assets (41 out of 44), followed closely by Himachal Pradesh at **91.66%** (11 out of 12).

Chhattisgarh HC (1/16) and Madras HC (5/65) report some of the lowest disclosures.

As of April 2025, 30 of 33 SC judges have declared their assets, and a Full Court resolution ensures all 33 will publish their declarations soon.

GS PAPER II · SECTION

Federal Structure & Local Governance

Federalism

FEDERALISM

DATA: FY25–FY27 (15th & 16th FC / State Finances)

FINANCES

Tax Devolution: **15th Finance Commission (2021-26)** recommended **41%** vertical share for states in the divisible pool; in Union Budget 2026-27, the Government provided **₹1.4 lakh crore to States as Finance Commission Grants** for FY 2026-27 based on **16th Finance Commission** recommendations (Union Budget 2026-27).

Borrowing Limit: Central Government enhanced the borrowing limit of state governments from **3%** to **5%** of their GSDP.

GST compensation cess: might have a **₹1.37 lakh crore** shortfall by March 31 due to **₹50,000 crore** interest on Covid loans

STATE FINANCES (RBI STATE FINANCES REPORT 2024-25 & ECONOMIC SURVEY 2025-26)

Consolidated Gross Fiscal Deficit (GFD) of States: Contained around ~**2.8% of GDP** during FY22–FY24, and edged up to **3.2% of GDP in FY25** (with State capital outlay maintained around ~**2.4–2.6% of GDP** supported by SASCI) (RBI State Finances Report / Economic Survey 2025-26).

Revenue Deficit: States maintained the revenue deficit at **0.2% of GDP** during 2021-22 to 2023-24.

Expenditure quality improved: Capital outlay, expenditure that leads to creation of physical/financial assets, increased to **2.6% of GDP** in 2023-24 from **2.2%** in 2022-23.

LANGUAGE IN INDIA

2011 Census: listed 1,369 ‘mother tongues’ in the country. Hindi is only one among them (mother tongue of only **26%** population)

121 languages (22 scheduled languages) spoken by 10,000 or more people in India

People’s Linguistic Survey of India - **220 Indian languages have** disappeared in the last **50 years**, and that another 150 could vanish in the next half century

Emergency

EMERGENCY

DATA: 1950-2025

NATIONAL EMERGENCY

TIME PERIOD	REASON	REMARKS
26 Oct 1962 – 10 Jan 1968	India-China war Security of India threatened	By external aggression
3 Dec 1971 – 21 March 1977	Indo-Pakistan war; and later extended	Security of India threatened by external aggression
25 June 1975 – 21 March 1977	Political instability	Security of India threatened by internal disturbances

PRESIDENT RULE

Since 1950, President's Rule (Article 356) has been imposed **134+ times** across 29 States and UTs (including Manipur in Feb 2025) (Ministry of Home Affairs / PRS).

Since 1950, President's Rule has been imposed at least once a year in 53 out of **74 years**.

The 1960s and 1970s saw the most frequent use of President's Rule.

Local Self Government

LOCAL SELF GOVERNMENT

DATA: 2023-24 to FY 2026-27

MUNICIPALITIES (RBI REPORT)

Revenue generation: generate only **0.6% of GDP** in 2023-24, much lower than the central government's **9.2%** and state governments' **14.6%**.

Sources of revenue: Tax revenues (**30%**), grants, contributions, and subsidies (**24.9%**), and fees and user charges (**20.2%**).

MCs in 18 states collect only **56%** of their property tax demand.

Transfers: In 2022-23, grants from the Central and State governments to municipalities ↑ **24.9%** and **20.4%**, respectively.

Municipal Borrowing: ↑ from **₹2,886 crore in 2019**-20 to **₹13,364 crore in 2023**- 24.

Municipal bond market: **₹4,204 crore** (**0.09%** of corporate bonds) in RBI's 2024 report; to boost issuance, **Union Budget 2026-27 announced a ₹100 crore incentive for a single municipal bond issuance exceeding ₹1,000 crore** by large cities (RBI / Union Budget 2026-27)

Fund utilization: 11 out of 18 states have utilized only **61%** of the funds allocated to them (CAG report)

DEVOLUTION INDEX 2024 (MINISTRY OF PANCHAYATI RAJ / IIPA REPORT)

Top 3 States in devolution are Karnataka, Kerala, and Tamil Nadu.

Lowest 3 states/UTs are Dadra & Nagar Haveli and Daman & Diu, Puducherry, and Ladakh.

Devolution has ↑ from **39.9%** to **43.9%** during 2013-14 to 2021-22.

GS PAPER II · SECTION

Elections & Political Dynamics

Electoral reforms

ELECTIONS

DATA: 2024-2025

CRIMINALISATION OF POLITICS (ADR REPORT 2025)

Member of Parliament: 251 (46%) of the 543 elected MPs in 2024, have criminal cases against them.

171 (31%) face serious criminal charges including rape, murder, kidnapping etc.

MEMBER OF LEGISLATIVE ASSEMBLY

Declaration: 45% (1,861 MLAs) have declared criminal cases

Criminal charges: 29% (1,205 MLAs) face serious criminal charges, including murder, attempted murder and kidnapping

Henious charges: 54 MLAs face murder charges, 226 face attempted murder charges, and 127 face crimes against women, including 13 charged with rape.

Gender-wise: 23% of women MLAs (out of 282 analyzed) have declared criminal cases.

State-wise: Andhra Pradesh leads with 79% MLAs having criminal cases, followed by Kerala and Telangana at 69% each.

REGISTERED UNRECOGNIZED POLITICAL PARTIES

Misuse of electoral funding-> Over 3260 unrecognised political parties received ₹10000 crore in donations.

EXPENDITURE

18th LS elections (2024) – estimated ₹1.35 lakh crore total campaign/election expenditure (~₹1,400/voter, up from ₹60,000 crore in 2019) (Centre for Media Studies - CMS)

Black Money: Over 55% of the donations received by regional parties in FY 2019-20 came from "unknown" sources (ADR)

WOMEN IN POLITICS

Participation in Legislature

Globe: Highest in Nordic nations(42.5%), followed by USA(22%), Europe(19.5%), Asia(18%).

India: India ranks 5th in women's political representation in parliament behind Afghanistan, Bangladesh, Pakistan and Nepal.

13.6% (74 women MPs) in 18th Lok Sabha (14.4% in 17th LS) and ~13–14% in Rajya Sabha (ECI / PRS)

For All state assemblies- 9% of MLAs are women

No state has > 20% women MLAs

Highest – Chhattisgarh (18%)

Himachal Pradesh (1) MLA

Nagaland and Mizoram – 0

GS PAPER II

Social Justice

FACT SHEETS IN THIS SUBJECT — TAP ANY TITLE TO JUMP TO IT

SOCIAL JUSTICE
CURRENT AFFAIRS
EDUCATION
HEALTH
VULNERABLE SECTIONS

GS PAPER II · SECTION

Poverty & Hunger

Poverty

SOCIAL JUSTICE

DATA: 2022-23 to 2025-26

HUNGER, POVERTY & INEQUALITY

POVERTY

INDIA - POVERTY

Percentage: 21.9% {2011, Tendulkar Report}

Extreme poverty: Under the World Bank's revised International Poverty Line ($3.00/day at 2021 PPP, up from $2.15/day), India's extreme poverty rate stood at 5.3% in 2022-23 (and 23.9% at the lower-middle-income line) [World Bank / Economic Survey 2025-26]

Decrease in Poverty [World Bank]

Extreme Poverty Lift: 171 Million lifted from Extreme Poverty in last decade.

India's Poverty Rate (at the 3.65 dollars per day line)-> Fell from 61.8 percent in 2011-12 to 28.1 percent in 2022-23.

Rural poverty declined from 69 percent to 32.5 percent

Urban poverty dropped from 43.5 percent to 17.2 percent.

Non-monetary poverty (Multidimensional Poverty Index - MPI) -> declined from 55.3% in 2005-06 to 11.28% in 2022-23 (24.82 crore people escaped multidimensional poverty in 9 years) (NITI Aayog / Economic Survey 2025-26) [UNDP MPI: 53.8% in 2005-06 to 16.4% in 2019-21].

GLOBAL - POVERTY

Incidence: 8.5% of total population i.e. 75 cr live in extreme poverty - on less than $2.15 per day [World Bank]

Deprived Regions: 5 out of 6 poor are in Sub-Saharan or South Asia

Rural > Urban – over 75% of all poor live in rural areas.

High Prevalence among Children (< 18): 50% of total poor

INEQUALITY

Oxfam Report - Global

The richest 1% control 45% of global wealth.

Oxfam Report - India

Richest 1% control more than 40% of total wealth

Bottom 50% own merely 3%

Gini Coefficient

The Gini coefficient improved for rural areas (declined to 0.237 in 2023-24 from 0.266 in 2022-23) and urban areas (declined to 0.284 in 2023-24 from 0.314 in 2022- 23).

Rural-Urban Divide: Average Monthly Per Capita Expenditure (MPCE) -> Rs. 4, 122 (Rural) and Rs. 6,996 (Urban) (Household Consumption Expenditure Survey 2023-24).

HUNGER

Status of Hunger [Global Hunger Index 2024]

Global

2.8 billion people cannot afford a healthy diet.

SOCIAL JUSTICE CONTINUED

India Specific

India's Rank: Improved to **102nd out of 123 countries in Global Hunger Index 2025** (up from **105th** out of 127 in GHI 2024; remains in the "serious" category) [GHI 2025]

Child Wasting Rate: **18.7%** [Highest in World]

Stunted Children: **32.9% in GHI 2025** (**29.3%** in UN SDR 2026; down from >**35%** earlier; Child Wasting at **18.7%**) [GHI 2025]

Under-5 mortality: **2.9%**

Status of Food Security [State of Food Security and Nutrition Report (2024)]

India Specific

Undernourished: **13%** from Chronic Undernourishment

Anemic: **53%** of Women

UN-FAO Report

Hunger in India came down to **13.7%** during 2021-23 period

GS PAPER II · SECTION

Social Sector & Human Development

Miscellaneous (Social Sector)

CURRENT AFFAIRS

DATA: 2021–2026

HEALTH

MENTAL HEALTH

India

Lifetime prevalence of mental disorders in India is **13.7%**.

10.6% of adults in India suffer from mental disorders (National Mental Health Survey (NMHS) 2015-16)

Mental Health in Students

23% of school children have mental health problems (NIMHANS study)

27.8% of undergraduate students had mentalhealth conditions and **31.3 per cent** of postgraduate students had suicidal thoughts.

Self-reporting rate: <**1%** (IIT Jodhpur study)

Treatment gap: **70-92%**

Economic Loss: B/w 2012-2030, is estimated at **USD 1.03 trillion** (WHO)

Mental health professionals

Only 0.75 psychiatrists, 0.07 psychologists and 0.07 social workers per **1 lakh** people.

India short of 27,000 psychiatrists to reach the recommended ratio of 3 per **1 lakh** people.

Mental healthcare budget & initiatives: Govt spends ~**0.05% of GDP** (~**1.1%** of health budget) on mental health; **Union Budget 2026-27 announced setting up NIMHANS-2 in North India** and upgrading National Mental Health Institutes in Ranchi and Tezpur as Regional Apex Institutions (Union Budget 2026-27).

Global

13.9% of population experience mental disorders

India (0.75 psychiatrists per lakh people) vs Developed countries (6.6 psychiatrists per 100,000 people).

CURRENT AFFAIRS CONTINUED

TRADITIONAL MEDICINES

India

Medicinal plants market-> **Rs. 4.2 billion in 2019**; expected to increase at CAGR of **38.5%** to **Rs. 14 billion by 2030**.

8,000 herbal remedies codified in AYUSH systems; **Union Budget 2026-27 announced 3 new All India Institutes of Ayurveda** (Ministry of AYUSH / Union Budget 2026-27).

Ayush exports: $**18 billion**

Global

80% of the population use traditional medicine.

Global herbal medicine market is projected to grow from $**153.5 billion in 2022** to $**279.8 billion in 2028**.

TOBACCO CONSUMPTION

India

2nd largest consumer and producer of tobacco

Usage: **42% of men** and **14% of women** in India use tobacco (GATS2 data)

Deaths: In India, nearly 3600 people die every day due to tobacco use.

Economic loss

India loses **1%** of its GDP to diseases and early deaths from tobacco use (WHO)

For every Rs 100 received as excise taxes from tobacco products, the economy loses Rs 816.

Wastage: **1.7 lakh tonnes** of waste every year.

Global

1 in every 10 cigarettes and tobacco products consumed globally is illicit.

22.3% of the world's population used tobacco (WHO)

RURAL HEALTH

There is shortage of **83.2%** of surgeons, **74.2%** of obstetricians and gynaecologists, **79.1%** of physicians, **81.6%** of paediatricians in rural areas.

Only **45.1%** PHCs function on a 24×7 basis.

Of the 5,480 functioning CHCs, only 541 have all four specialists.

EDUCATION

BRAIN DRAIN

B/w 2015 and 2022, **1.3 million** Indians left.

Citizenship renounced: 225,000 Indians renounced their citizenship (2022).

Economic loss: India's IT industry could have added $**15-20 billion** more annually had the talent stayed.

75% of emigrating Indians choose to stay back after studies completion.

EXAM LEAKS

70 exam leaks in the last **7 years** across 15 states.

WOMEN

SOCIAL ISSUES

CRIMES (MARITAL RAPE)

2% of married women face physical, sexual or emotional violence by their husbands.

India is one of only 36 countries where marital rape is not criminalized.

CURRENT AFFAIRS CONTINUED

VULNERABLE SECTIONS

CHILD MARRIAGE

23.3% of women aged **20-24 years** were married before age 18 in NFHS-5 (2019-21); as per **SRS Statistical Report 2024**, the mean age at effective marriage for females rose to **23.1 years**, with only **2.1% of females marrying before age 18** in 2024 (ORGI SRS 2024).

17.7% of men aged **25-29 years** were married before age **21 years**.

Prevalence reduced by half from **47%** (2006) to **23.3%** (2019-21).

Total cases registered under Child Marriage Act -> 1050 (2021) (NCRB).

Every minute, three girls are forced into child marriage ['India Child Protection' research team study].

CHILD ARTIST

B/w 6,059 and 12,334 child artists [Study by Child Rights and You].

Child artists in films and TV work for over 12 hours a day.

Education

EDUCATION

DATA: 2024-25 to FY 2026-27

SCHOOL ENROLLMENT

AT SCHOOL LEVEL

Children in Schools: **24.69 crore students across 14.71 lakh schools**, supported by **>1.01 crore teachers** (with GER at 90.9 in Primary, 90.3 in Upper Primary, 78.7 in Secondary, and 58.4 in Higher Secondary) [UDISE+ 2024-25 / Economic Survey 2025-26] (**24.80 crore** in UDISE+ 2023-24)

Private Schools Enrollment: 36% (**9 crore**) of total school enrolment [UDISE+ 2023-24 data]

Schools

Government Schools: 38.11% (**27.8 lakh**)

Unaided Schools: 60.75% (**44.31 lakh**)

School Enrolment:↓ 37 lakh in 2023-24 compared to previous year [UDISE data].

HIGHER EDUCATION LEVEL

Gross Enrollment Ratio (GER) -> 0.4 in 1950-51 to 28.4 in 2021-22.

Student Enrolment: Over **4 crore** students, making India the second- largest after China.

Target for GER: National Education Policy (NEP) 2020 aims for **50%** by 2035

World **2nd Largest** Higher Education system

Girls with Higher Education: Enrolment of women in Indian universities grew **26%** in 2024.

Vulnerable Sections: Enrollment among OBCs increased by **80.9%**, SC enrollment grew by **76.3%**.

Stream wise Ratio:

Humanities (**33%**), Science (**15%**), Commerce (**14%**), English (**12%**)

Pupil-Teacher Ratio (PTR): Steady at 23:1 for the last five years.

University Density (per 1 lakh eligible students): Highest in Sikkim (10.3), Arunachal Pradesh (5.6), Ladakh (5.2), etc. In Bihar (0.2), UP (0.3), West Bengal & Maharashtra (0.6) the density is below national average.

EDUCATION CONTINUED

EXPENDITURE

Government Spending:

Expenditure: 2.9% of GDP

Target under NEP 2020: 6% of GDP

Budgetary allocation (2026-27): ₹1.39 lakh crore (₹1,39,289.48 crore) allocated to the Ministry of Education in Union Budget 2026-27 (including ₹83,562 crore for School Education and ₹55,727 crore for Higher Education), an 8.27% hike over ₹1.28 lakh crore in 2025-26 (Union Budget 2026-27).

INFRASTRUCTURE

Inefficient Infrastructure [UDISE+ 2023-24 Report]

Computers: The percentage of schools having computers ↑ from 38.5 % in 2019-20 to 57.2 % in 2023-2024.

Internet: Percentage of schools having internet facility increased from 22.3 % in 2019-20 to 53.9 % in 2023-2024.

Electricity: Of the over 14.71 lakh schools in India, up to 1.52 lakh schools have no functional electricity.

Drinking Water: While 14.47 lakh schools claim to have drinking water facilities, only 14.11 lakh have them functional.

Toilets: Government schools constitute the majority of the 67,000 schools operating without functional toilets.

Differently-Abled Students: Only 33.2% of government schools have disabled-friendly toilets.

Digital Education: 46 % schools have functional computers (Ministry of Education)

INSTITUTIONS

Universities and Colleges:

Institutions: Total Higher Education Institutions (HEIs) increased from 51,534 in 2014-15 to 70,018 as of June 2025 (with 23 IITs, 21 IIMs, and 20 AIIMS, plus 2 international IIT campuses in Zanzibar and Abu Dhabi) (Economic Survey 2025-26) [1,168 universities, 45,473 colleges, and 12,002 stand-alone institutions in AISHE 2021-22].

Accreditation: Only 37% of universities are accredited

Growth: In last 10 years, number of universities has increased by 60%, colleges up 21% [Ministry of Education]

Increased Penetration in Rural Areas: 43% Universities and 61.4% colleges are located in Rural Areas.

Institutes of National Importance (INIs): 171 [June 2024]

Medical Colleges: 102% increase-> rising from 387 before 2014 to 780 in 2024

Increase in MBBS seats: 130% rise in MBBS seats

IIMs: 21

IITs: 23

STARTUP

Definition: An entity, HQ in India, opened less than 10 years ago, and annual turnover < ₹100 crore.

Recognized startups: DPIIT-recognized startups increased from ~500 (2016) to over 2.23 lakh as of 31 March 2026 (up from 1.59 lakh in early 2025) (DPIIT / PIB April 2026).

Positive Ecosystem: 3rd largest startup ecosystem in India

High Failure Rate: 90% fail within 5 years.

Employment Generation: Recognized startups have created over 23.36 lakh direct jobs as of 31 March 2026 (up from 16.6 lakh in Oct 2024) (DPIIT / PIB April 2026).

Women Entrepreneurship: Over 1.07 lakh recognized startups have at least one woman director/partner as of 31 March 2026 (~48% of total recognized startups, up from 73,151) (DPIIT / PIB April 2026).

EDUCATION CONTINUED

HIGHER EDUCATION: PAIN POINTS

Only **42.6%** of Indian graduates are employable [India's Graduate Skill Index 2025]

QS World Rankings 2025: Top Indian Institutes

No Institute in TOP 100

IIT Bombay: Leading in India, IIT Bombay climbed from **149th** in 2024 to **118th** in 2025.

IIT Delhi: Achieved the second position in India, moving up 47 ranks from **197th** to **150th**.

Schools:

ASER 2024

Reading skill: **76.6%** of Class 3 students still cannot read Class 2 text.

Foundational Numeracy Skills

Over **50% of students** (14-18 age) face difficulties with elementary division problems.

Arithmetic

66.3% of Class 3 students and **70%** of Class 5 students cannot perform simple arithmetic calculations.

Class 3 students able to do subtraction is just **33.7%** in 2024.

Vocational Training

Only about **2%** have received formal vocational training [Ministry of Skill Development]

Problem in Basic Skills:

NCERT **Report 2022**

11% of Class 3 students in India lack basic skills in Mathematics.

SKILLING

Level of Skill Training: <**5%** of people are formally skilled (> **20%** is china, > **50%** in USA, **95%** is South Korea)

Low Formal Training: only **2.7%** of India's workforce has received formal skill training, compared to **52%** in US, **80%** in Japan, and **96%** in South Korea.

Health

HEALTH

DATA: 2024–FY 2026-27 (SRS 2024 & Budget 2026-27)

HEALTH GDP%

Government Spending:

~**1.84–1.9% of GDP** (Union Budget 2026-27 increased allocation for Ministry of Health & Family Welfare by **10%** to **₹1,06,530.42 crore** for FY 2026-27) (Economic Survey / Union Budget 2026-27)

World Average = **6%**

Target = **2.5%** [National Health Policy, 2017]

Economic Survey (2024-25)

Share of government health spending in total health expenditure increased to **48 per cent in 2022** from **29 per cent in 2015**.

In FY 2022, India spent **₹9.04 lakh crore** on health– **3.8% of GDP**-> ₹6,602 per person.

HEALTH OF POVERTY

Out of Pocket Expenditure (OoPE):

Decrease in OoPE: OOPE as a percentage of total health expenditure (THE) declined from **62.6%** in 2014-15 to **39.4%** in 2021-22 [National Health Accounts (NHA) Estimates]

HEALTH CONTINUED

People Pushed into Poverty: 6 crore people pushed into poverty every year, due to OoPE [NITI Aayog]

HUMAN RESOURCE

Availability of Doctors and Nurse:

Public Sector: Only 10% of doctors are in the Public Sector.

Doctor/Population: 1: 834 v/s 1: 1000 (WHO recommended)

- 112% increase in MBBS seats (since 2014)
- Allopathic doctors to population – 1 doctor/1,194 people.

Nurse/Population Ratio: 1.96 per 1,000 [WHO recommended 3 per 1,000]

INFRA/INPUTS

Bed: Patient: 1.3/1000 v/s 3: 1000

- Delhi: 2.7/1000

Increase in Colleges: 82% increase in Medical Colleges (since 2014)

Institutional deliveries [MoHFW]

↑ from 79% (NFHS-4, 2015-16) to 88.6% (~89%) in NFHS-5 (2019-21), and further to 95.4% of deliveries receiving medical attention in 2024 [MoHFW / ORGI SRS Statistical Report 2024].

100% in Kerala, Goa, Lakshadweep, Puducherry and Tamil Nadu and more than 90% in eighteen other States/UTs.

Import Dependency:

Active Pharma Ingredients (API)

- 70-80% imported from China
- Indian API market projected to reach $21.2 billion by 2033.

Medical Equipments: ~ 75% are imported

INSURANCE

INSURANCE PENETRATION

Low Insurance Penetration: 3.7% in FY24 [Global average: 7%]

- **Life Insurance penetration:** dropped marginally from 3 % in FY23 to 2.8 % in FY24 [Economic Survey 2024–25]
- **Non-life insurance** remained at 1%.

India ranks 10th in the global life insurance market.

INSURANCE COVERAGE

Health Insurance: 37% covered under Health Insurance Schemes.

Without Health Insurance: 90 crore Indians lack access to health Insurance [IRDAI data]

HEALTH INSURANCE SECTOR

Market size: 6th largest insurance market by 2032 (Swiss Re report)

Density: $91 insurance density (global avg $874)

Insurance Premium: Total insurance premium grew from ₹8.3 lakh crore in FY21 and ₹11.2 lakh crore in FY24 to ₹11.9 lakh crore in FY25 (Economic Survey 2025-26)

RURAL AREAS VARIATIONS

Rural Areas: ≈ 20% of Total Hospital

Shortage of Manpower in Rural Areas [Union Ministry of Health data]

- **Doctors:** 70% shortage of specialist doctors
- **Primary Health Centres:** Shortfall of 3.1% of allopathic doctors (Rural Health Statistics 2021-2022)
- **Rural Community Health Centres:** maximum for surgeons (73 per cent) followed by physicians (69 per cent), paediatricians (68 per cent) and Obs & Gyn specialists (61 per cent)

HEALTH CONTINUED

DISEASE BURDEN

Non communicable disease: 2/3rd of total deaths

5.8 million Indians die from NCDs each year

1 in 4 Indians faces the risk of dying from NCD before reaching age of 70.

TB: 26.07 lakh TB cases in 2024, marking highest notified cases ever.

India among 10 countries that make up 60 % of global maternal deaths, still births, new born deaths (UN)

Mortality Rate [Sample Registration System (SRS) Statistical Report 2024 (released May 2026) & 2021-23 Bulletin]

MMR: 88–93 per lakh live births (reduced by 86% since 1990, outpacing the global 48% reduction; 93 in SRS 2019-21) (ORGI SRS / Economic Survey 2025-26)

NMR: 18–19 per 1,000 live births (70% decline during 1990–2023 vs 54% globally) (ORGI SRS / Economic Survey 2025-26)

IMR: Declined to 24 per 1,000 live births in 2024 (down from 25 in 2023, 27 in 2021, and 40 in 2013; lowest in Kerala at 8) (ORGI SRS Statistical Report 2024)

U5MR: Declined to 28 per 1,000 live births in 2024 (down from 29 in 2023 and 31 in 2021; 78% reduction since 1990 vs 61% globally) (ORGI SRS Statistical Report 2024)

Anaemia (NFHS 5):

2/3 or 67% of children

1/2 or 57% of women

1/4 or 25% of Men

3 in 4 Indian women have low dietary iron intake.

OBESITY

India: 3rd most obese country

Urban – 70% of Obese people

1/4 Indian is Obese (NFHS 5)

22.9% of men and 24% of women are obese.

% of overweight children under five increased to 3.4% from 2.1% in NFHS-4 (2015-16) at the all-India level.

Definition: WHO defines it as abnormal fat accumulation with:

BMI > 30 -> Obese

BMI 25-30 -> Overweight

Economic cost: USD 28.95 billion (Rs 1,800 per capita)

By 2030 ↑ to Rs 4,700 per capita or 1.57% of GDP.

Global

One-third of children worldwide will be obese by 2050 [Lancet Study]

211 crore obese individuals in 2021 (45% of the world's population).

OPEN DEFECATION

Lack of Toilet Access: 20% do not have access to toilet {1 in 5 household practice open deficiency} – NFHS 5

World Bank – 11 % of India's Population practice open defecation.

GS PAPER II · SECTION

Vulnerable Sections & Welfare

Efficacy of Welfare and Development Schemes

VULNERABLE SECTIONS

DATA: 2011–2025 (Census 2011, SRS 2024, NCRB 2024)

CHILD {0-18 YRS.}

Population:

- 1/3rd of country population
- 40-45 Cr
- 19% of the World's children

Crimes against Children: Rose by 5.9% in 2024 (crime rate rose from 39.9 in 2023 to 42.3 per lakh child population in 2024, up from 1.49 lakh cases in 2021) (NCRB Crime in India 2024)

Child beggars: 3 lac

Missing: 1 child is missing every 8 mins

Child labour

10.1 million children, or 3.9% of the total child population, are "main workers" or "marginal workers" (Census 2011)

In rural areas, 13.9% of children are involved in child labor, compared to 4.7% in urban areas.

70% of child laborers are in agriculture, 20% in services, and 10% in industry.

Cybercrime: Child cyber crimes surges 32% compared to previous year (NCRB)

Malnutrition

Child Wasting Rate: 18.7% [Highest in World]

Stunted Children: 32.9% in GHI 2025 (down from 35.5% in NFHS-5) (GHI 2025 / NFHS-5)

Under-5 mortality: 2.9%

Undernourished: 13% from Chronic Undernourishment

Anemic: 1 in every 3

ELDERLY

Population (Elderly 60+): 10.38 cr (8.6% in Census 2011) -> rose to 9.7% of total population in 2024 (SRS Statistical Report 2024) and ~10.1–11% (~14+ cr) in 2025, projected to reach ~20% by 2050 (UNFPA India Ageing Report)

Growth: Expected to rise to 20% in 2050

Sex ratio: 1033 {2011} -> Feminisation of Ageing

Growth Rate ≈ 3%

DISABLED

Population: 2.68 crore (Census 2011)

- 2.3% of India's population was reported as having some form of disability.
  - 2.3% in rural areas
  - 2% in urban areas.

Reservation:

- 4% Reservation is Government Jobs
- 5% is higher education.

Economic Cost: India loses approximately Rs 4.5 lakh crore annually - about 4% of its GDP - due to the exclusion of disabled (Economic Survey 2023)

TRANS GENDERS

Population: 4.88 lakh (Census 2011)

Mental health issues: 31% attempted suicide.

Gender Discrimination: 27% were denied care due to gender identity (NALSA)

MINORITIES

18% of the population

VULNERABLE SECTIONS CONTINUED

SC

Population: 16.6%

Literacy Rate: 66%

Reservation: 15%

ST

Population: 8.6%

Literary Rate: 59%

Reservation: 7.5%

705 notified tribes | Meghalaya (Lowest)

Atrocities: ~67,000+ cases of atrocities against SCs and STs in 2022–2023; in 2024, crimes against SCs decreased by 3.6% and crimes against STs declined by 23.1% over 2023, while crimes against Senior Citizens rose by 16.9% (NCRB Crime in India 2024)

OBC

Population: 52%

Reservation: 27%

MISCELLANEOUS

Gen Z population - India

Largest Gen Z population in the world (377 million individuals)

Workforce: By 2025, Gen Z is projected to comprise 27.3% of India's workforce.

Collective spending is at $860 billion (43% of total consumption in country).

Projected to hit $2 trillion by 2035

Loneliness: 61% Gen Z believe people are more lonely today than they were 10 years ago, (Spotify Culture Next Report 2024).

GS PAPER III

Technology, Economic Development, Environment, Security and Disaster Management

Paper III — Technology, Economic Development, Bio-diversity, Environment, Security and Disaster Management.

> **GS-3 rewards data — budgets, indices, targets — more than any other paper.**

SUBJECTS IN THIS PAPER — TAP TO OPEN

Disaster Management | Indian Economy | Agriculture | Environment | Internal Security | Science & Technology

GS PAPER III

Disaster Management

FACT SHEETS IN THIS SUBJECT — TAP ANY TITLE TO JUMP TO IT

Climate Risk Index 2025

Disaster Stats

Economic cost of disasters

GS PAPER III · SECTION

Frameworks & Preparedness

Vulnerability and Risk Assessment

Climate Risk Index 2025

DATA: 1995-2024 (CRI 2026) / 1993-2022 (CRI 2025)

India ranked **9th most affected country** (1995-2024) (Germanwatch CRI 2026); earlier **6th most affected** (1993-2022) (Germanwatch CRI 2025)

80,000 fatalities (nearly **10% of global** 8,32,000 deaths across ~430 extreme weather events) (Germanwatch CRI 2026)

Nearly USD 170 billion in inflation-adjusted economic losses (1995-2024) (Germanwatch CRI 2026) USD 180 billion / 4.3% of global losses in 1993-2022 ([Germanwatch CRI 2025)].

Disaster Stats

DATA: 2024-2025 (IDMC) & NDMA baseline

Internal displacements due to natural disasters: 5.4 million displacements in India in 2024, the highest in **12 years** (IDMC GRID 2025)

South Asia recorded over **4.6 million** disaster displacements in 2025 out of **29.9 million** globally (IDMC GRID 2026)

DROUGHTS

Impact: 40% land area and **70 % of cultivable area** prone to droughts

Vulnerability: Affect **40% of population**

60% increase in droughts in last **25 years**

EARTHQUAKES

[Data by NDMA]

Vulnerability: ~59-60% of landmass is prone to earthquakes (**80% of population**) (NDMA)

Unsustainable infra: 90% casualties due to collapse of houses & structures

LANDSLIDE

12.6% of land area is prone to landslides (NDMA / GSI).

FLOODS

Area: 12% of land area (over **40 million hectares**) prone to floods and river erosion (NDMA)

Vulnerable sections: Children and women, constitute **85% of death**.

Economic Losses: average annual loss is estimated to be **US$ 7.4 billion**

URBAN FIRE

Hotspots: Maha & Guj accounts **30%** of India's fire accident deaths

Reasons: 60% of Fire related deaths occur in Residential buildings.

Shortcomings: 65% shortage of fire stations.

Impact: 4th biggest risk to business continuity (India Risk Survey 2021)

Loss of life: 35 people killed every day due to fire related incidents

Vulnerable section: 60% of those killed are women

HEATWAVE

Coverage: 90% of India is in a "danger zone" from it (PLOS Climate).

Financial loss: $2,500 billion by 2030 (Globally)

Disaster Stats CONTINUED

Heat stress loss in India: 6% of its working hours equivalent to 35 Million fulltime jobs (ILO)

Loss of life: 155,937 heat-related deaths in India in 2021 (Global Burden of Disease study)

FOREST FIRE

Causes: Only 4% natural causes globally (MoEFCC)

Vulnerability: >35% (~36%) of India's forest cover is prone to frequent forest fires (FSI / ISFR 2023).

Carbon emission: 2.5 billion to 4.0 billion tons annually (IPCC)

Global: Amazon forest – 8000 incidents in 2019

CYCLONES

Exposure: India exposed to 10% of world's tropical cyclones.

Extent: ~75% (5,700 km) of India's 7,516.6 km coastline (revised to 11,098.8 km in Dec 2024) prone to cyclones and tsunamis (NDMA).

Vulnerability: 8% of area and 1/3rd of Indians are vulnerable to cyclone

Economic cost of disasters

DATA: 2023-2025

Natural catastrophes -> economic losses of $12 billion (over ₹1 lakh crore) in India in 2023 (Swiss Re); global economic losses from natural catastrophes stood at $220 billion (insured losses $107 billion) in 2025 (Swiss Re sigma 1/2026)

GS PAPER III

Indian Economy

FACT SHEETS IN THIS SUBJECT — TAP ANY TITLE TO JUMP TO IT

GENERAL STATE OF ECONOMY (ECONOMIC SURVEY 2024-25)
TERTIARY SECTOR
SECONDARY SECTOR
INCLUSIVE GROWTH & DEVELOPMENT
BANKING & MONEY MARKET
NATIONAL INCOME & ACCOUNTING
TAXATION
OTHERS
INFRASTRUCTURE

GS PAPER III · SECTION

Macroeconomics & Fiscal Policy

Economic Growth

GENERAL STATE OF ECONOMY (ECONOMIC SURVEY 2024-25)

DATA: FY25-FY26 (Economic Survey 2025-26)

GLOBAL GROWTH

IMF Projections -> **3.2%** and **3.3%** for 2024 and 2025, respectively (IMF WEO / Economic Survey 2024-25).

Over the next **5 years** → average **3.2%**.

RESILIENT DOMESTIC ECONOMY

GDP Growth: Real GDP grew by **6.5%** in FY25 (**6.7%** in Q1, **5.4%** in Q2 FY25) and is estimated to grow by **7.4%** in FY26 (FAE), with FY27 projected at **6.8–7.2%** (Economic Survey 2025-26).

GVA Growth: Real Gross Value Added (GVA) is estimated to grow by **7.3%** in FY26 (FAE), up from **6.4%** in FY25 (Economic Survey 2025-26).

Primary Sector: Agricultural growth rebounded to **3.8%** in FY25 (**4.4%** 5-year average; **3.5%** in Q2 FY26) (Economic Survey 2025-26).

Secondary Sector: Industry GVA grew by **7.0%** in H1 FY26 (Manufacturing GVA grew **7.72%** in Q1 and **9.13%** in Q2 FY26), up from **6.2%** in FY25 (Economic Survey 2025-26).

Tertiary Sector: Services GVA is estimated to grow by **9.1%** in FY26 (**9.3%** in H1 FY26; **56.4%** share in GVA), up from **7.2%** in FY25 (Economic Survey 2025-26).

TERTIARY SECTOR

DATA: FY 2025-26 (as on March 2026)

SERVICE SECTOR

Economic contribution: **56.4%** of GVA in FY26 FAE (highest ever; **53.6% of GDP** in H1 FY26, **~55% of GDP** overall) (Economic Survey 2025-26)

Potential: By 2047, the services sector is expected to contribute **60 per cent** of India's GDP.

30% of the Workforce (Eco survey 24-25)

Growth Rate: Estimated at **9.1%** in FY26 (**9.3%** in H1 FY26), after **>6%** annual growth over the past decade (Economic Survey 2025-26).

Exports: India ranked **7th worldwide** in global services exports

India's share in Global Services Exports: **4.3%** in CY 2024 (more than doubled from **2%** in 2005; services exports hit record **USD 387.6 billion in FY25** and **USD 421.3 billion in FY26**) (Economic Survey 2025-26 / MoC&I)

IT, Computer services and Business Services Exports: **~70%** of India's services exports.

IT SECTOR

India is **2nd largest** Exporter of Software, after USA (typo fixed: **2nd** -> **2nd**)

Contribution: **7.5%** of India's GDP (as of FY23)

Projected to hit **10%** by FY25

Outsourcing market: India is a leading exporter of IT and BPM services, holding about **56%** of the global outsourcing market.

Market potential: Domestic software market is projected to hit **$100 billion by 2035** [SaaS Boomi report]

TOURISM

5% of GDP

TERTIARY SECTOR CONTINUED

Employment: 7.6 crore jobs in FY23 | 7% of Employment

Travel & Tourism Development Index (TTDI) 2024: 39/119

Inbound visitor markets for India in 2023: Bangladesh (9%), the United States (9%), and the United Kingdom (6%).

E-COMMERCE

Share: Around 8% of total Retail market [2023-24]

up from 4–5% in 2018–19

Growth Rate: More than 20% [That is a CAGR of 27%]

Potential: India's E-commerce market is expected to grow to $325 billion by 2030 [Invest India]

FINTECH

India ranks as 3rd largest and fastest-growing fintech market globally.

India's fintech adoption rate: 87%

Account for 70% of digital payment transactions.

Growth Rate: More than 30% [That is a CAGR of 30.26%]

TELECOMMUNICATION

India is the world's 2nd largest telecommunications market.

Telephone Subscriber Base: 133.06 crore (1,330.58 million) as of March 2026 (up from 120.08 crore in March 2025) [TRAI Yearly Performance Indicators 2025-26]

Overall Tele-Density: 93.26% as of March 2026 (86.76% in late 2025; 84.57% excluding M2M) [TRAI 2025-26]

Urban tele-density: 151.47% as of March 2026 (up from 131.45% in March 2025) [TRAI 2025-26]

Rural tele-density: 60.46% as of March 2026 (up from 59.06% in March 2025) [TRAI 2025-26]

Delhi Service area has maximum tele-density of 274.59%

Bihar service area has minimum tele-density of 56.90%

FDI: 4th largest sector in terms of FDI inflows, contributing 6% of total FDI inflow.

Manufacturing Sector

SECONDARY SECTOR

DATA: FY25-FY26

MANUFACTURING

Current: ~17% of GVA (Manufacturing GVA grew by 7.72% in Q1 and 9.13% in Q2 of FY26; Industry GVA grew 7.0% in H1 FY26) (Economic Survey 2025-26)

Potential: 27% by 2047.

Employment: 11% [6.5 cr people]

Targets as per National Manufacturing Policy (NMP), 2011

GDP Share of Manufacturing: 25% of GDP by 2025

Employment in Manufacturing: ~10 crore jobs by 2025

India Vs China: India holds 2.8% of the global manufacturing share, compared to China's 28.8%.

INDUSTRY SECTOR

27 - 29% of GDP

25% of workforce is employed (ILO 2023)

MSME

2nd Largest employer after Agriculture

SECONDARY SECTOR CONTINUED

29% to India's GDP [Potential: 40% to GDP by 2030]

40% of Exports

Employing 7.5 crore people

62% to employment in India (McKinsey Global Institute)

95% firms → Unorganised

Registered MSMEs: >5.93 crore registered on Udyam portal (Ministry of MSME 2025)

MSMEs on e-Commerce Platforms: Only 6% of MSMEs actively use e- commerce platforms for sales.

PM Mudra Yojana: MSMEs

Accounts: 55.45 crore loan accounts sanctioned as of October 2025 (up from ~35 crore) (Economic Survey 2025-26)

Credit support: disbursed over ₹36.18 lakh crore as of October 2025 (up from ₹18.39 lakh crore) (Economic Survey 2025-26).

Women entrepreneurs: 71.4 % of total no. of accounts (FY 2022).

Categories: Majority loan accounts (~80%) are in the Shishu category (FY 2021), followed by Kishore at 18.70 %.

SPECIAL ECONOMIC ZONE (SEZ)

India has 280 Operational SEZs (Nov 2024)

Employment: 2.8 million jobs.

Exports: $163.69 billion in 2023-24

ELECTRONICS SECTOR

India's share in Global Electronics Market: only 4%

Electronics Production: ₹9.52 lakh crore in FY24 (crossed ₹11.5 lakh crore in FY25; PLI schemes across 14 sectors attracted >₹2.0 lakh crore investment, generating >₹18.7 lakh crore production and >12.6 lakh jobs as of Sep 2025) (Economic Survey 2025-26).

Mobile phones: India is 2nd largest mobile phone producer in World.

325 million+ mobile phones manufactured in India every year.

99% of smartphones sold in India are now made domestically.

Exports: Expected to reach $120 Bn by FY26.

CAGR of around 25% through 2028.

Semiconductor Market: Projected to grow at 13% reaching ₹8.9 lakh crore by 2030

India Semiconductor Mission approved 10 projects across 6 states worth ₹1.60 lakh crore (ISM 2.0 announced in Budget 2026-27) (Economic Survey 2025-26 / Union Budget 2026-27).

PHARMACEUTICAL

3rd Largest by volume, 14th Largest by value

Generic Medicines: India is the largest manufacturer of generic medicines globally.

Economic Contribution: 1.72% to the GDP [Projected to reach USD 130 billion by 2030]

Market Value: $50 billion.

Vaccines: India supplies over 50% of global vaccine demand

Exports: India ranks 12th globally in medical goods exports

US Imports: US imports USD 9 billion worth of pharma formulations from India annually.

TOY INDUSTRY

Market value: 1.5 Billion USD in 2023

Projected to increase to $3 billion by 2028

Exports: USD 326 million to USD 348 million for the last three years.

India's Share: 0.3% in 2022; **China:** 80%

TEXTILE INDUSTRY

GDP: 2.3% to India's Gross Domestic Product (GDP) [Projected to reach 5% by 2030].

Employs 4.5 crore workers [After agriculture, textiles and apparel form the second-largest employer in India]

Exports: 8.21% of India's total merchandise exports

SECONDARY SECTOR CONTINUED

- India is the **6th largest exporter** of textiles and apparel globally (Eco Survey 2024-25)
- **India's global trade share: 4%** in textiles and apparel

Capacity: 2nd largest textile manufacturing capacity globally

FDI: 100% FDI allowed in textiles under the automatic route.

Fabric Production [India]

Silk → **2nd largest producer**

Cotton → **2nd largest producer**

Jute → largest producer

Man-Made fibres (MMF) → largest producer

SUGAR INDUSTRY

India as Consumer: Largest in World

India as Producer: 2nd Largest in World

India as Exporter: 3rd largest in World (typos fixed: **3rd** -> **3rd**)

- **India's Share in Global Sugar Production: 19%**
- **Employment:** Livelihood for **5 crore** farmers and their families.

STEEL INDUSTRY

India as Consumer: 3rd Largest in World after China and USA.

India as Producer: 2nd Largest in World of crude steel

FDI: 100% FDI allowed under the automatic route.

Finished steel consumption (Per capita): 97.7 kgs (2023-24)

Capital-Intensive Sector: INR **7,000 crore** is required to set up 1 tonne of steel- making capacity through the greenfield route.

MAKE IN INDIA PROGRESS

Toy: India produces **400 million** Toys annually

Mobiles: India is the second-largest mobile manufacturer in the world

Ease of Doing Business

India climbed from **142nd** in 2014 to **63rd** in the World Bank's Doing Business Report (DBR), 2020 before its discontinuation.

Over 40000 compliances have been reduced and 3,800 provisions decriminalized.

Inclusive Growth

INCLUSIVE GROWTH & DEVELOPMENT

DATA: FY25-FY26 / 2025-2026

INCLUSIVE GROWTH

India ranks **62nd** out of 74 emerging countries [Inclusive Development Index, WEF].

EMPLOYMENT & UNEMPLOYMENT

Total Workforce: 56.2–56.5 crore employed (aged 15+ years in Q2 FY26; over **31 crore** unorganised workers registered on e-Shram portal as of Jan 2026, **54%** women) (Economic Survey 2025-26)

- **Need of Jobs:** Indian Economy needs to generate nearly **78.5 lakh** jobs annually(non-farm sector) until 2030 to cater need of rising workforce.

Unemployment Rate: 5.1% in monthly PLFS (April 2025); annual usual status (ps+ss) UR stood at **3.2%** (female UR at **2.1%**) (MoSPI PLFS Annual Report 2025)

- **Self-Employed Workers:** It has grown from **52.2%** in 2017-18 to **58.4%** in 2023-24.
- **Govt Jobs: 7%** of Total employment

INCLUSIVE GROWTH & DEVELOPMENT CONTINUED

Informal Sector: 90%

Net EPFO Subscriptions: more than doubling from 61 lakh in FY19 to 131 lakhs in FY24.

GIG ECONOMY

Total: Employ over 12 million workers [1.5% of total Workforce]

Projected to reach 23.5 million by 2029–30 [NITI Aayog]

Job creation: Out of 100 New Jobs, 56 are being created in Gig sector.

EDUCATION & SKILLS

Stream wise Ratio:

Humanities (33%), Science (15%), Commerce (14%), English (12%)

Pupil-Teacher Ratio (PTR): Steady at 23:1 for the last five years.

University Density (per 1 lakh eligible students): Highest in Sikkim (10.3), Arunachal Pradesh (5.6), Ladakh (5.2), etc. In Bihar (0.2), UP (0.3), West Bengal & Maharashtra (0.6) the density is below national average.

Government Spending:

Expenditure: 2.9% of GDP

Target under NEP 2020: 6% of GDP

Budgetary allocation: ₹1.39 lakh crore (₹1,39,289 crore) allocated to the Ministry of Education in Union Budget 2026-27 (up 8.27% from ₹1.28 lakh crore in 2025-26) (Union Budget 2026-27).

Inefficient Infrastructure [UDISE+ 2023-24 Report]

Computers: The percentage of schools having computers ↑ from 38.5 % in 2019-20 to 57.2 % in 2023-2024.

Internet: Percentage of schools having internet facility increased from 22.3 % in 2019-20 to 53.9 % in 2023-2024.

Electricity: Of the over 14.71 lakh schools in India, up to 1.52 lakh schools have no functional electricity.

Drinking Water: While 14.47 lakh schools claim to have drinking water facilities, only 14.11 lakh have them functional.

Toilets: Government schools constitute the majority of the 67,000 schools operating without functional toilets.

Differently-Abled Students: Only 33.2% of government schools have disabled-friendly toilets.

Digital Education: 46 % schools have functional computers (Ministry of Education)

Universities and Colleges:

Institutions: Total Higher Education Institutions (HEIs) increased from 51,534 in 2014-15 to 70,018 as of June 2025 (Economic Survey 2025-26) [1,168 universities, 45,473 colleges and 12,002 stand-alone institutions in AISHE 2021-22].

Accreditation: Only 37% of universities are accredited

Growth: In last 10 years, number of universities has increased by 60%, colleges up 21% [Ministry of Education]

Increased Penetration in Rural Areas: 43% Universities and 61.4% colleges are located in Rural Areas.

Institutes of National Importance (INIs): 171 [June 2024]

Medical Colleges: 102% increase-> rising from 387 before 2014 to 780 in 2024

Increase in MBBS seats: 130% rise in MBBS seats

IIMs: 21

IITs: 23

Startup:

Definition: An entity, HQ in India, opened less than 10 years ago, and annual turnover < ₹100 crore.

Recognized startups: DPIIT-recognized startups increased from ~500 (2016) to over 2.23 lakh as of March 31, 2026 (up from 1.59 lakh in early 2025) (DPIIT / PIB 2026).

Positive Ecosystem: 3rd largest startup ecosystem in India

INCLUSIVE GROWTH & DEVELOPMENT CONTINUED

High Failure Rate: 90% fail within 5 years.

Employment Generation: Recognized startups have created over 23.36 lakh direct jobs as of March 31, 2026 (up from 16.6 lakh in Oct 2024) (DPIIT / PIB 2026)

Women Entrepreneurship: Over 1.07 lakh recognized startups have at least one woman director/partner as of March 31, 2026 (~48% of DPIIT-recognised startups, up from 73,151) (DPIIT / PIB 2026).

Pain Points:

Higher Education:

Only 42.6% of Indian graduates are employable [India's Graduate Skill Index 2025]

QS World Rankings 2025: Top Indian Institutes

No Institute in TOP 100

IIT Bombay: Leading in India, IIT Bombay climbed from 149th in 2024 to 118th in 2025.

IIT Delhi: Achieved the second position in India, moving up 47 ranks from 197th to 150th.

Schools:

ASER 2024

Reading skill: 76.6% of Class 3 students still cannot read Class 2 text.

Foundational Numeracy Skills: Over 50% of students (14-18 age) face difficulties with elementary division problems.

Arithmetic: 66.3% of Class 3 students and 70% of Class 5 students cannot perform simple arithmetic calculations.

Class 3 students able to do subtraction is just 33.7% in 2024.

Vocational Training: Only about 2% have received formal vocational training [Ministry of Skill Development]

Problem in Basic Skills:

NCERT Report 2022: 11% of Class 3 students in India lack basic skills in Mathematics.

SKILL (GENERAL STATE)

Formally Skilled Workforce: < 5%

South Korea: 95%

Japan: 80%

Germany: 75%

USA: 50%

Employability of Graduates: Only 51% graduates employable [Economic Survey 2024-25]

Vocational Training to Workforce: 65.3% has received no form of vocational training [Economic Survey 2024-25]

Low Formal Training: only 2.7% of India's workforce has received formal skill training, compared to 52% in US, 80% in Japan, and 96% in South Korea.

DEEPTECH STARTUP ECOSYSTEM

Global Standing: Despite having the 3rd largest pool of DeepTech startups, India ranked 6th among the top 9 DeepTech ecosystems in the world in 2023 (Nasscom).

INSURANCE

Insurance Penetration: 3.7% of GDP in FY24 [Global average: 7%]

Life Insurance penetration: 2.8%

Non-Life insurance remained at 1%.

India ranks 10th in the global life insurance market.

PENSION SECTOR

Participation: Only about 12% of the Indian workforce participates in any formal pension scheme.

NPS & APY Coverage: Combined National Pension System (NPS) and Atal Pension Yojana (APY) subscribers cover approximately 5.3% of India's population as of early 2025.

INCLUSIVE GROWTH & DEVELOPMENT CONTINUED

POVERTY

India – Poverty

Percentage: 21.9% {2011, Tendulkar Report}

Extreme poverty: Under the World Bank's revised International Poverty Line ($3.00/day at 2021 PPP, up from $2.15/day), India's extreme poverty rate stood at 5.3% in 2022-23 (and 23.9% at the lower-middle-income line) [World Bank / Economic Survey 2025-26]

Decrease in Poverty [World Bank]

Extreme Poverty Lift: 171 Million lifted from Extreme Poverty in last decade.

India's Poverty Rate (at the 3.65 dollars per day line) -> Fell from **61.8 percent in 2011**-12 to **28.1 percent in 2022**-23.

Rural poverty declined from **69 percent** to **32.5 percent**

Urban poverty dropped from **43.5 percent** to **17.2 percent**.

Non-monetary poverty (Multidimensional Poverty Index (MPI)) -> declined from **55.3%** in 2005-06 to **11.28%** in 2022-23 (NITI Aayog / Economic Survey 2025-26) [UNDP MPI: **53.8%** in 2005-06 to **16.4%** in 2019-21].

Global – Poverty

Incidence: **8.5% of total** population i.e. **75 cr** live in extreme poverty - on less than $2.15 per day [World Bank]

Deprived Regions: 5 out of 6 poor are in Sub-Saharan or South Asia

Rural > Urban – over **75%** of all poor live in rural areas.

High Prevalence among Children (< 18): **50% of total** poor

Global Inequality (Oxfam):

The richest **1%** control **45% of global** wealth.

44% of the world's population lives below the World Bank's poverty line of $6.85 (PPP).

India Inequality (Oxfam):

Richest **1%** control more than **40% of total** wealth

Bottom **50%** own merely **3%** 3. Gini Index

Gini Coefficient:

The Gini coefficient improved for rural areas (declined to 0.237 in 2023-24 from 0.266 in 2022-23) and urban areas (declined to 0.284 in 2023-24 from 0.314 in 2022-23).

HUNGER

Status of Hunger [Global Hunger Index 2024]

Global:

2.8 billion people cannot afford a healthy diet.

India Specific:

India's Rank: Improved to **102nd** out of 123 countries in Global Hunger Index 2025 (up from **105th** out of 127 in GHI 2024; remains in the "serious" category) [GHI 2025]

Child Wasting Rate: **18.7%** [Highest in World]

Stunted Children: **32.9%** in GHI 2025 (down from >**35%** earlier;Child Wasting remains **18.7%**) [GHI 2025]

Under-5 mortality: **2.9%**

Status of Food Security [State of Food Security and Nutrition Report (2024)]

India Specific:

Undernourished: **13%** from Chronic Undernourishment

Anemic: **53%** of Women

UN-FAO Report:

Hunger in India came down to **13.7%** during 2021-23 period

INCLUSIVE GROWTH & DEVELOPMENT CONTINUED

REGIONAL DISPARITY

Delhi's per capita Income = **2.5 times** of national average [EAC-PM]

Rural-Urban Inequality [Household Consumption Expenditure Survey 2023-24]

Rural Area: ₹4,122 MPCE

Urban Area: ₹6,996 MPCE [Higher by around **70%**]

OoPE (Health):

Decrease in OoPE: OOPE as a percentage of total health expenditure (THE) declined from **62.6%** in 2014-15 to **39.4%** in 2021-22 [National Health Accounts (NHA) Estimates]

People Pushed into Poverty: **6 crore** people pushed into poverty every year, due to OoPE [NITI Aayog]

DIVERSITY

Caste System:

Jatis: More than 30000 Jatis

Inter-faith and Intercaste marriages: around **6%**

61% of respondents opposed interfaith marriages

56% were against inter-caste unions [India Today's Gross Domestic Behaviour survey]

Rural Vs Urban: Inter-caste marriages are more frequent in Rural areas (**5.2%**) than Urban areas (**4.9%**) [Indian Statistical Institute study]

Rich and poor: Inter-caste marriages are more common among poor people (**5.9%**) than rich people (**4.0%**).

Diversity:

Tribes: 705

Languages: 121 (> 10 K) | 1500 spoken

Dialects: 20,000 languages or dialects.

Hindi Speakers: only **26%** speak Hindi as mother tongue

Communalism:

No. of Communal Riots: India witnessed **84%** rise in communal violence in 2024 [Centre for Study of Society and Secularism (CSSS) report]

States:

Maharashtra emerged → 12 riots.

Uttar Pradesh and Bihar → 7 riots

Monetary policy

BANKING & MONEY MARKET

DATA: FY25-FY26 (Sep 2025)

BANKING - NPA

Gross NPAs: Multi-decadal low of **2.2%** in September 2025 (and Net NPA at record low of **0.5%**), down from **2.6%** in September 2024 [RBI / Economic Survey 2025-26]

Bad Loans: Banks have written off NPAs worth about **Rs 16.35 trillion** in last 10 financial years

Credit card NPAs spiked **500%** in past four years [RBI data]

BANKS

Bank Accounts (PMJDY): increased from 14.72 Cr in March 2015 to 55.02 Cr as of March 2025 (with 36.63 Cr in rural/semi-urban areas and ~**56%** owned by women) [Economic Survey 2025-26].

Credit-Deposit Ratio (RBI's Financial Stability Report):

CD ratio has been rising since September 2021 and peaked at **78.8%** in December 2023.

BANKING & MONEY MARKET CONTINUED

Over **75% of banks** with CD ratios > **75%** are private sector banks.

Capital-to-risk-weighted assets ratio (CRAR) for SCBs stands at ~**16.7–17.2%** in FY25/FY26, well above the **11.5%** regulatory norm (RBI FSR / Economic Survey 2025-26)

Profits:

Public sector banks record cumulative net profit of **Rs 1.78 lakh crore** for FY25.

All 12 PSBs reported profits, marking a significant turnaround from losses in FY18.

HDFC Bank remains the most profitable private bank in India, with a net profit of **Rs 73,440 crore in FY25**.

REGIONAL RURAL BANKS (RRBS)

92% branches in Rural/Semi-Urban areas

Around **90% of loans** goes to Priority sector lending, with around **70% of loans** to the Agriculture Sector.

GDP

NATIONAL INCOME & ACCOUNTING

DATA: FY25-FY26 (up to Oct 2026)

GDP

GDP Estimates (FY25 Provisional & FY26 First Advance Estimates - MoSPI / Economic Survey 2025-26):

Real GDP grew by **7.4%** in FY26 (FAE) after **6.5%** growth in FY25 (**₹187.97 lakh crore**) (MoSPI / Economic Survey 2025-26)

Nominal GDP rose by **9.8%** to **₹330.68 lakh crore.**

INFLATION

India's Retail Inflation (CPI): Dropped sharply to a series-low average of **1.7%** in FY26 (April–December 2025), down from **4.9%** in Apr–Dec 2024 and **5.4%** in FY24 (Economic Survey 2025-26).

Projections: IMF has projected an inflation rate of **4.4%** in FY25 and **4.1%** in FY26 for India.

Food inflation increased from **7.5 %** in FY24 to **8.4 %** in FY25 (April - December).

Headline Inflation: RBI expects headline inflation to be **4.2%** in FY26, if there is normal monsoon and no further external or policy shocks.

SAVINGS RATE

India Gross Savings Rate: **30.7%** in Mar 2024

Household Financial Savings to reach **6.5%** of Gross national disposable income (GNDI) in FY25 [SBI report]

FISCAL POLICY & GOVERNMENT BUDGET

Debt Profile

Government Debt to GDP (Centre and states) - **around 83.1%** (by 2024 end)

Central Government [Debt to GDP] – Estimated at **56.1%** in RE 2025-26 and **55.6%** in BE 2026-27 (down from **57.1%** in 2024-25) (Union Budget 2026-27)

Government aims to bring it down to 50 ± **1%** by 2030–31

State Government [Debt to GDP] – **26%**

Debt of the Central Government:

Internal debt: **94%**

Public Debt: **89.9%**

External Debt: **6%**

NATIONAL INCOME & ACCOUNTING CONTINUED

External Debt to GDP Ratio: In India, external debt constituted **19.4%** of the total GDP at the end of September 2024.

- Across currencies, the external debt remained primarily denominated in the US Dollar (**53.4 %**), followed by the INR (**31.2 %**), SDR (**5 %**), and the Euro (**3 %**).

FOREIGN TRADE

India's Total Exports: Scaled an all-time high of **$863.1 billion in FY 2025-26** ($**441.8B** merchandise + $**421.3B** services), up from $**825.3 billion in FY 2024**-25 (MoC&I / Economic Survey 2025-26)

- **Exports in 2016:** It was around **USD 435 billion in FY 2016**.
- **India's target** for export is USD 2 Trillion by 2030.

Trade

Deficit: Overall trade deficit -> **USD 78.1 billion in FY24** (Eco Survey 2023-24).

Largest Trade Deficit: China [$**112.6 billion in FY 2025**-26, up from $**99.2 billion in FY 2024**-25] (MoC&I)

Largest Trading Partner: China surpassed the USA in FY 2025-26 (in FY 2024-25, USA was **1st** with $**131.84 billion** bilateral trade and $**40.89B** surplus; in FY26, India-US trade surplus was $**34.4B**) (MoC&I)

- **India's Top Export Destinations:** USA (**17.90%**) > UAE (**8.23%**) > Netherlands (**5.16%**) > China (**3.85%**) > Singapore (**3.33%**).
- **India's Top Import Source Nations:** China > UAE > USA > Russia.

Remittances:

India is the **largest recipient** of remittances globally

Remittances Received: Record **$135.4 billion in FY25** ($**129.4 billion in CY 2024**) (RBI / Economic Survey 2025-26)

- The U.S. accounts for **27.7%** of India's inward remittances

CURRENT ACCOUNT DEFICIT (CAD)

CAD: Moderated to **0.8% of GDP** in H1 FY26 (from **1.3%** in H1 FY25; ~**1.3%** in Q2 FY26) (Economic Survey 2025-26)

FOREX RESERVES

US $701.4 billion as of 16 January 2026 (Economic Survey 2025-26) and **US $734.6 billion** as of 2 October 2026 (RBI), providing ~**11 months** of import cover and **94.4%** external debt cover.

- **Import Cover:** It is sufficient to provide an import cover of more than **11 months**.

INVESTMENT

FDI

Total FDI inflows -> $**81.04 billion in FY 2024**-25 ($**64.7 billion** in Apr–Nov 2025; total FDI inflows touched $**94.53 billion** / equity $**58.85 billion in FY 2025**-26) (DPIIT / Economic Survey 2025-26).

- India's FDI inflows have increased ~**20 times** from 2000-01 to 2023-24.
- **Highest FDI Inflow:** Computer software and hardware.
- **FDI Source:** Mauritius(**25%**) > Singapore (**23%**) > USA (**9%**)
- **FDI Top Destinations [FY 2024–25]:** Maharashtra (**39%**) > Karnataka (**13%**) > Delhi (**12%**)

FPI

FPI Outflows: FPIs have pulled out a massive ₹**1.16 lakh crore** from Indian equities so far in 2025.

Fiscal Policy

TAXATION

DATA: FY 2025-26 / BE 2026-27

TAX COLLECTION

For 2025-26, Projected Expenditure for every 1 Rs, would come from:

- Taxes: **66 paise**
  - Direct Tax: **39 paise**
  - Indirect Tax: **18 paise**
- Borrowings: **24 paise**

For 2025-26, Projected Expenditure for every 1 Rs, would be upon:

- Interest Payments: **20 paise**
- States share of Taxes: **22 paise**
- Central Sector Schemes: **16 paise**

TAX-GDP RATIO

Tax-GDP Ratio: **11.7%** (FY24)

- China: **20%**
- Brazil: **34%**

Direct Tax to GDP Ratio: **6.64%** in FY24 [24-year High]

Direct Tax Buoyancy: 1.57 during the 2024-25

DIRECT TAX COLLECTION

Net Direct Tax Collections: **₹23.40 lakh crore** (**₹23,40,406 crore**) in FY 2025-26 as on 31.03.2026, up **5.12%** from **₹22.26 lakh crore in FY 2024**-25 (Centre's net tax receipts budgeted at **₹28.7 lakh crore** in BE 2026-27 and **₹26.7 lakh crore** in RE 2025-26) (CBDT / Union Budget 2026-27)

- Growth Rate: around **14%** since last year

Contribution of Direct taxes to Total Tax revenue = **56.72%** (FY24)

Income Tax Payers: **9.2 crore** income tax returns filed in FY25, up from **6.9 crore in FY22** and **5.26 crore in FY14** (Economic Survey 2025-26)

Income Tax Returns [ITRs]

Only **6.68%** of the population filed IT returns (FY 2023-24).

Over 43,000 taxpayers filed tax returns for more than **₹10 crore** (FY 2024-25).

State Wise Collection: Maharashtra (**1st**) > Karnataka (**2nd**)

Corporate Income Tax: Effective corporate tax rate in India just **22%** after surcharge and cess to be **25.17 percent**.

INDIRECT TAX COLLECTION

GST collections: Gross GST collection reached **₹22.27 lakh crore in FY 2025-26** (up from **₹22.08 lakh crore in FY 2024**-25 and **₹20.18 lakh crore in FY 2023**-24; active GST taxpayers reached **1.65 crore** in May 2026; Next-Gen GST 2.0 rationalised slabs to **5%**, **18%**, and **40%** sin/luxury rate w.e.f. Sep 2025) (PIB / Ministry of Finance 2026)

Projection: GST collection set to grow by **8.3%** in FY26.

State Wise Collection [Rank] (FY 2024-25): Maharashtra > Gujarat > Karnataka

Miscellaneous

OTHERS

DATA: 2025-2026

OTHERS CONTINUED

CIRCULAR ECONOMY

India:

Market value: $45 billion by 2030.

Employment: 10 million jobs by 2050.

Global: Its transition could add $4.5 trillion to global output by 2030.

CREATIVE ECONOMY [ORANGE ECONOMY]

Size: $30 bn industry and 8% of India's working population

Eco contribution: 20% contribution by creative occupation to nation overall GVA.

Employment: Young people (15–29) make up 23% of creative industry jobs—highest across sectors; women hold 45% of creative roles globally.

Exports: 1.5 times increase in export of creative goods from 2010 to 2019.

Urban areas: A sizeable 67.07% of all creative workers in India are in the urban areas.

GAS BASED ECONOMY

Aim: PM aims to raise India's natural gas share from 6.2% to 15% by 2030 (World Avg: 24.42%)

Import dependence: around 50% of our requirement of Natural gas.

Import bill: $15.2 billion in FY25.

Importance: A 10% replacement of liquid fuel into gas will reduce import bill by nearly $3 billion every year.

CNG stations and PNG Connections: On Dec 2024, India has 7,395 CNG stations and around ~1.47 crore PNG domestic connections.

SDGS

UN Sustainable Development Report 2026: India achieved its highest-ever rank of 94th out of 167 countries (score 68.3), improving from 99th in SDR 2025 and 109th in SDR 2024 [UN SDSN Sustainable Development Report 2026]

SDG India Index (2023-24):

Composite score improved from 57 in 2018 to 66 in 2020-21 to further to 71 in 2023-24

Advancements in Goals 1 (No Poverty), 8 (Decent Work and Economic Growth), 13 (Climate Action).

CRITICAL MINERALS

Global:

Top Producers: China > Congo > Chile > Indonesia > South Africa

China Dominance: China controls 60% of rare earth production, 60% of critical minerals production & 80% of processing worldwide.

India:

List: Released list of 30 critical minerals including Bismuth, Cobalt, Copper, Phosphorous, Potash, Rare Earth Elements (REE) etc.

Vulnerability: 54% of critical materials lie near indigenous people's land. (International Renewable Energy Agency (IRENA))

Current update: Presence of 5.9 million tonnes of lithium in J&K.

STOCK MARKET

Position: 4th largest equity market

Market Value: $4.33 trillion (India in 2024 surpassed Hong Kong's market capitalization of $4.29 trillion)

Expectation: Likely to hit $10 trillion by 2030 ('Recap 2024. Crystal Gaze 2025' Report)

Indian Investors in Capital Markets: Unique investors crossed the 12-crore mark in September 2025 (~25% women), total demat accounts crossed 21.6 crore (Dec 2025), and mutual fund unique investors reached 5.9 crore [Economic Survey 2025-26].

OTHERS CONTINUED

BOND MARKET

Size of the Indian Bond Market: US$2.69 trillion [Dec 2024]

Government Securities Market: $1.3 trillion

GS PAPER III · SECTION

Physical Infrastructure & Capital

Transport

INFRASTRUCTURE

DATA: FY 2025-26 / July 2026

LOGISTICS SECTOR

Logistics Performance Index (LPI 2023): 38/139

GDP Contribution: 13-14% to the GDP (NCAER, 2021-22).

Impact on Trade: Improved logistics can boost trade by 15% in developing economies.

Impact on Exports: 10% decrease in logistics cost can increase 5-8% of exports.

Carbon Emissions: India's logistics sector emits 13.5% of nation's GH gases, with road transport—mainly trucks—driving 88% of emissions.

MODES OF LOGISTIC MOVEMENT

Modes of Logistic Movement [Both Freight & Passengers]:

MODE	SHARE
Roads	65% share
Rail	31% share
Waterways	3% share
Air	1% share

PAIN POINTS IN LOGISTICS

India's Logistics Cost: 14–18% of GDP (Global: 8%)

Logistics Cost Reduction: Declined by 0.8-0.9 percentage points of GDP between FY14-FY22

Unorganized: Only 5.5–6% of logistics market was held by organised, tech-driven players (EY).

Freight Cost Comparison (NITI Aayog):

Jamshedpur to Mumbai -> USD 50/tonne

Rotterdam to Mumbai-> USD 34/tonne

INFRASTRUCTURE - GENERAL

Current Investment: Public capital expenditure increased to ₹12.2 lakh crore in FY 2026-27 BE (up from ₹11.21 lakh crore in FY 2025-26 BE; effective capex ₹15.48 lakh crore in FY26 BE) (Union Budget 2026-27 / Economic Survey 2025-26)

Investment Required: India will need to spend around ₹143 trillion by 2030 on infrastructure.

INFRASTRUCTURE CONTINUED

National Infrastructure Pipeline: The projected infrastructure investment is **₹111 trillion** for 2021-25 (over **5 yrs**).

Status of NIP [As of March 2025]:

Planned investments rose from **₹111 trillion** to **₹168.93 trillion.**

Completed investments are **₹31.1 trillion**, achieving **28%** of original target.

TRANSPORT SECTOR

Contribution to GDP: ≈ **5%**

Share by Different Mode:

SHARE OF TRANSPORT TYPES	COST PER TONNE/KM
Road	66% (WB) | Rs 2.5
Rail	31% | Rs 1.3
Waterways	10% | Rs 1
Inland waterways	0.15%
Coastal Shipping	7%

ROAD

2nd largest road network in the world (after the USA).

87% of passengers and **60%** of freight traffic annually.

Road density: 1,926.02 (2018-19)

Length of various categories of roads:

National Highways: **1,46,572 km** as of March 2026 (up from **91,287 km in FY14** and **1,46,145 km in 2024**; total road network **63.73 lakh km**) (MoRTH / PIB Aug 2026)

State Highways: **1,86,908 km**;

Other Roads: **59,02,539 km**

National Highway: **2% of total** road network, **40% of total** traffic

5853 km of NH was constructed in FY25..

Expansion: 65, **569 km in 2004** to **1,46,145 kms in 2024**.

Road Accidents: 172000 lives in 2023 - averaging 474 deaths daily, or one every three minutes.

India loses **3% of GDP** in road accidents annually (UN Report)

FDI: **100%** FDI in roads and highways is allowed under automatic route.

Bharatmala Pariyojana -> aims to develop **34,800 km** of National Highways.

National High-Speed Corridors (HSCs): Length of HSCs expanded from **93 km in 2014** to **2,474 km in 2024**.

Multi-Modal Logistics Parks (MMLP): Till December 2024, Six MMLPs in Chennai, Indore, Nagpur, Jalna, Jogighopa and Bangalore have been awarded.

RAILWAY

4th largest network in the world - **69,439 route km** as of March 2025 (with **99.6%** rail electrification achieved by July 2026) (Economic Survey 2025-26 / PIB Aug 2026)

Freight:

In Freight traffic: **12 times** more efficient than roadways

Target freight share: From current **35%** to **45%** by 2030 (India's NDCs).

Average Freight Speed: **23.6km**/h (*USA: **50 km**/h)

Over Utilisation: **150%** above capacity

Railway Penetration: **0.057 km** per 1000 persons (USA 0.752 per 1000 persons)

INFRASTRUCTURE CONTINUED

Railway Safety:

200 major railway accidents in the past five years, 351 people killed.

75% of derailments due to `railway staff failure'

10 % derailments are caused by `equipment failures'.

Passengers: 715 crore passengers travelled by the Indian Railways between April 1, 2024 and March 31, 2025.

Net zero targets: Indian Railways targets net zero emissions with 30 GW of renewable energy by 2029-30.

Vande Bharat trains: 162 Vande Bharat train services (plus 2 Vande Bharat Sleeper and 72 Amrit Bharat services) operational as of July 2026 (up from 136) (Ministry of Railways / PIB Aug 2026).

Kavach: Automated Train Protection system (Kavach Version 4.0) commissioned on 2,633 route km as of July 2026 (₹1,547 crore invested till Nov 2024) (Ministry of Railways / PIB Aug 2026).

AIRWAYS

Market size: 3rd largest in the world, behind the US and China. (Trade Promotion Council of India)

Domestic Passenger traffic: 165.7 million

8th biggest passenger traffic.

Airport's cargo handling capacity: 8.0 million MT in FY24 (Eco survey)

Airline capacity: doubled from 7.9 million seats in April 2014 to 15.5 million in April 2024.

Operational Airports: 165 operational airports as of July 2026 (164 in 2025, up from 74 in 2014) (MoCA / PIB Aug 2026).

CAGR: 14.5% in no. of domestic passengers during FY14 and FY20

Profit making Airports: Only 22 out of 148 operational airports making profit (Parliamentary committee). The Kolkata airport was the most profitable, followed by the Chennai airport.

UDAN scheme: 679 routes connecting 95 airports, heliports, and water aerodromes operationalised, benefiting >1.68 crore passengers as of July 2026 (Modified UDAN approved in March 2026 with ₹28,840 crore outlay for FY27–FY36) (MoCA / PIB Aug 2026).

Women pilots: 15% women pilots (almost 3 times the global average)

WATERWAY

Coastline: 7516.6 km

Navigable Inland Waterways - 14,500 kms

In December 2024, the Union Home Ministry revised India's coastline length from 7,516.6 km to 11,098.8 km, citing ongoing review due to the coastline paradox. [Read about coastline paradox]

Major ports: 13, Non-major ports: 200+

Trade through marine transport: By Volume: 95%; by Value: 70%

Ships (ownership):

90% are Foreign owned ships

10(departure)

2.73 days (behind Global average)

Average Fleet age: > 19 years

Inland Waterways: 2% (China 10%, Bangladesh 32%); **Coastal Shipping:** 6%

Average turnaround time for Indian ports improved from 94 hours (~3.9 days in 2014) to 48.8 hours (~2.03 days) in 2025-26, with major ports' cargo capacity reaching 1,728 MMTPA and handling 915.17 MT in FY26 (MoPSW / PIB Aug 2026).

POWER

3rd largest producer and consumer of electricity worldwide.

Installed power capacity: 509.74 GW as of November 2025 (up 11.6% YoY from 466.24 GW in Jan 2025; total non-fossil installed capacity reached 283.46 GW as of 31 March 2026, crossing 50% share) (Economic Survey 2025-26 / MNRE)

INFRASTRUCTURE CONTINUED

Installed Capacity:

Fossil Fuel Based Thermal Power: **248.62 GW**

Non Fossil Fuel Based Renewable Energy Sources: **217.62 GW**

Power AT&C / T&D Losses: AT&C losses reduced from **22.62%** (FY14) to **15.04% in FY25**, with DISCOMs recording a positive PAT of **₹2,701 crore in FY25** for the first time (Economic Survey 2025-26).

DIGITAL ECONOMY

Household Digital Literacy: < **38%** [NASSCOM]

- Urban Areas: **61%**
- Rural Areas: **25%**

Individual Digital Literacy: Only **26.8%** of Indian youth in the academic age group have internet browsing skills (NSO survey)

Digital consumers: **3rd largest** in world after China and USA

Internet Subscribers: **109.28 crore (1,092.79 million)** as of March 2026 (including **106.59 crore** broadband subscribers), up from **96.91 crore** in March 2025 [TRAI Yearly Performance Indicators 2025-26].

- Rural Internet Penetration: ~**53%** of rural population
- Urban Internet Penetration: ~**77%** of urban population

Digital Payment: GDP = **86%** (**100 billion** $)

GS PAPER III

Agriculture

FACT SHEETS IN THIS SUBJECT — TAP ANY TITLE TO JUMP TO IT

PRIMARY SECTOR

LAND REFORMS

GS PAPER III · SECTION

Agriculture & Farm Dynamics

Cropping pattern

PRIMARY SECTOR

DATA: AY 2024-25 / FY26

AGRICULTURE

Eco Parameters

Share in GDP: ~16% of GDP (17.7% of GVA) (Economic Survey 2025-26)

Growth Rate (Recent): Agricultural growth rebounded from 1.4% in 2023-24 to 3.8% in 2024-25, and registered 3.5% in Q2 FY26 (Economic Survey 2025-26)

Growth Rate (Cumulative): 4.4% average annual growth over the past 5 years, and 4.45% decadal growth during FY16 to FY25 (highest across decades) (Economic Survey 2025-26)

Agri income: ↑ 5.23% annually over the past decade.

People Employed: employs ~46.1% of the workforce (PLFS 2023-24 / Economic Survey 2025-26).

Agri market: ₹38 lakh crore by 2030.

India is 1st in: Pulses, Milk

India is 2nd in: Rice, Wheat, Fruits & Vegetation, arable land.

LAND

Area under Cultivation

51% of total land area is under cultivation.

About 60% of India's total land area is classified as agricultural land. [World Bank]

Small & Marginal farmers

89.4% (<2 hectares) [Economic Survey]

Cultivate nearly 45% of net sown area (Agri Census 2015-16).

SEED

Saved Seeds ↠ 85%

Seed Replacement Rate: 15 – 20%; it's 100% for hybrid seeds.

Production: Private firms -> 71% of seed production (ICAR)

Role of Seeds: Impacts 25% of productivity

IRRIGATION

Rainfed Agriculture: 50% of total

Role of Irrigation: 70% of total input cost

Irrigation coverage: ↑ from 49.3% to 55% of gross cropped area b/w FY16 and FY21 [Eco Survey]

CREDIT

Informal Sector: around 40%

Debt: More than 50% farmers under debt

BPL: 22% of farmers are BPL

Corporate Investment ↠ < 2%

Kisan Credit Card scheme: 7.72–7.75 crore operational accounts (₹10+ lakh crore in KCC credit; total ground-level agricultural credit reached ₹28.67 lakh crore in FY25) (Economic Survey 2025-26).

PESTICIDES

4th largest producer of pesticides

Importance: 25% crop losses due to pests

Concern: 0.1% is used of applied reach their intended pest

PRIMARY SECTOR CONTINUED

FERTILIZERS [4:2:1]

Consumption: 655 lakh tonnes fertilizers in FY25

Use vs Productivity: Fertilizers usage increased 25 times since 1960 but food production increased by only 3 times.

Fiscal Burden: Fertilizer accounts for large fiscal subsidies

- ₹1.75 lakh crore spent on fertilizer subsidies (2023-24).
- 2nd highest fiscal expense after food

Imports: $8.29 billion in 2024-25

Targeting: Only 35% reach beneficiaries

Urea:

In India, urea is the most produced, imported, consumed and physically regulated fertilizer of all.

Govt spending: Govt spends ₹1,500 per bag of Urea, making it unsustainably cheap for farmers.

India is the 2nd largest consumer of urea after China.

DAP:

Import cost is $636 (₹55,150) per tonne, while production costs exceed ₹65,000 per tonne.

Subsidy Burden: Govt caps DAP price at ₹27,000 per tonne, but the subsidy needed to cover costs is high.

STORAGE

Short of 30-40 lakh tones (Ashok Dalwai)

POST HARVEST LOSSES

12% of total agricultural GDP

10% of total food grain production (ICAR)

EXPORTS

Just 2.4% of world's share [8th rank]

FARMER SUICIDES

At least one farmer died by suicide every hour in India [NCRB]

EXPENSE IN R&D

India spends about 0.7% of its agri -GDP on agri - research and Education (R&E)

₹1 investment in agri R&D can fetch ₹13 return [Economic Survey].

MACHINES

Only 40-45% levels of mechanization

India ↠ 1/3rd of global tractors

CROPS AND YIELD

Total kharif food grain production -> 1647.05 lakh metric tonnes (LMT) in 2024-25.

India's rice yield -> 2,191 kg per hectare (global average 3,026 kg per hectare).

Wheat yield -> 2,750 kg/hectare (global avg 3,289 kg/hectare).

COTTON

Yield: 435kg/hectare; similar to 2024-25's yield of 447kg/hectare.

Rainfed crop: 67% of India's cotton is produced on rain-fed areas and 33% on irrigated lands

Acreage: India ranks 1st in cotton acreage with around 40% of the world area under cotton

Production: India ranks 2nd in cotton production with estimated production of 343.47 lakh bales (5.84 MMT) in 2022-23 i.e. 23.83% of world cotton production.

Productivity: 39th rank in overall cotton yield -> lower than countries like USA, China, Brazil etc.

Consumption: 2nd largest consumer of cotton -> 22.24% of world cotton consumption (2023).

PRIMARY SECTOR CONTINUED

Exports: 30 lakh bales i.e. 6% of world export in 2022-23.

OILSEEDS

Contribution: India contributes about 5-6% of world production.

Area: India accounts for 15-20% of global oilseed area

Rainfed: 76% of oilseed cultivation is rainfed.

National Mission on Edible oils- Targets for 2030-31:

Increase primary oilseed production to 69.7 million tonnes (from 39 million tonnes in 2022-23).

Expand oilseed cultivation by an additional 40 lakh hectares by targeting rice and potato fallow lands, promoting intercropping.

ALLIED SECTOR: FISHERIES

Production: India is 2nd largest fish producer

Global: 8% share in global fish production

India ranks 2nd in aquaculture production, leads in shrimp production and 3rd in capture fisheries production.

Inland fisheries: 75% of total fisheries output.

Growth Rate: > 10% annually

Contribution:

1.25 % of India GDP

5% of Agriculture's GDP (FAO)

ALLIED SECTOR: LIVESTOCK

India has the world's largest livestock population

Largest milk producer (23% of global milk production).

2nd in egg production, 5th in meat production (FAO)

Economic contribution: 5.50% of India's Gross Value Added (GVA) in 2022-23.

Employment: 8.8 % of the population; livelihood for 70% of rural households

Insurance: Only 15.47% of animals are under insurance cover.

Productivity: Average annual productivity of cattle in India is 1777 kg/animal/year (world average of 2699 kg/animal/year (2019-20)).

Methane emissions: Enteric methane emission -> 15.1% total global enteric methane emission.

ALLIED SECTOR: HORTICULTURE

Contribution: Contributes about 33% to the agriculture GVA

Production: 362.08 million tonnes (Final Est. 2024-25; revised up to 367.72 MT as of Aug 2025, comprising 114.51 MT fruits and 219.67 MT vegetables) -> ~90% of total horticulture production (DAC&FW / Economic Survey 2025-26).

India is the 2nd largest producer of fruits and vegetables

Share in Global market Exports: mere 1%

Exports: India ranked 14th in vegetables and 23rd in fruits

India is the largest producer of Onions, ginger and okra among vegetables and ranks 2nd in production of Potatoes, Cauliflowers, Brinjal, Cabbages, etc (FAO)

ORGANIC FARMING

No. of farmers: India ranks 1st in terms of number of farmers -> Home to 30% of total organic producers

Area under Cultivation: 1.76 million hectares

Certified area: India ranks at 4th place in terms of certified area globally [International Federation of Organic Agriculture Movements]

Sikkim: 1st State in the world -> fully organic

Lakshadweep is the only UT declared 100% organic.

PRIMARY SECTOR CONTINUED

FOOD PROCESSING

India's FPI is **6th largest** in the world.

Contribution:

7.7% to manufacturing GVA

Valued at **USD 160 billion**

22.6% in agri food exports

Growth Rate: > **10%**

75% of industry is unorganized

FDI: **100%** FDI in food processing under automatic route and **100%** FDI in trading, including e-commerce.

Potential: Indian food processing industry to reach $**700 billion by 2030**.

PUBLIC DISTRIBUTION SYSTEM

NFSA 2013: Covers **67% of population**

Rural Area: **75%**

Urban Area: **50%**

Beneficiaries of NFSA (PMGKAY): **80.56 crore** beneficiaries identified out of targeted **81.35 crore** (free foodgrains extended for **5 years** from Jan 2024 to Dec 2028) (DFPD).

80.56 cr people have been identified, out of the targeted **81.35 cr**

Food Subsidy Expense: **50%** of India's total subsidy spending in FY 2024-25

Fair Price Shops: > 5 Lac shops are there with almost **100%** automation.

MINING

Contribution: B/w **2.2%** and **2.5%** of India's GDP

Employment: approximately **1.3 million** people

Mine closure: An average of 100 mine workers per day face potential unemployment by 2035 due to mine closure (Global Energy Monitor)

GS PAPER III · SECTION

Land Reforms

Land Reforms

LAND REFORMS

DATA: Dec 2025 (SVAMITVA) & ISRO/SECC baseline

Total Land Area of world with India: **2.4%**

FARMERS & LAND REFORMS

Uneven Distribution: **5%** farmer control **30%** agricultural land

No Land: More than **50%** rural household has no agricultural land (SECC)

Computerization of Land Records (DILRMP & SVAMITVA): >**95%** of Record of Rights computerized covering >**6.26 lakh** villages; under SVAMITVA, drone survey completed in **3.28 lakh** villages and **2.76 crore** property cards prepared for **1.82 lakh** villages as of Dec 2025 (Economic Survey 2025-26).

LAND WASTE

Desertification: ~**25%** of India's land is undergoing desertification (ISRO Desertification and Land Degradation Atlas)

Degradation: ~**29.77%** (almost **30%**) of India's geographical area is undergoing land degradation (ISRO SAC Atlas).

LAND REFORMS CONTINUED

LAND DISPUTE

Cases: 25% of Supreme Court cases are land disputes.

Resolution time: disputes on land or real estate take an average time of 20 years in the courts to be resolved (NITI Aayog)

Area: Conflicts involve 2.5 million hectares of land.

GS PAPER III

Environment

FACT SHEETS IN THIS SUBJECT — TAP ANY TITLE TO JUMP TO IT

Climate Change
Biodiversity
Energy
Pollution and Waste Management
Water and its Conservation

GS PAPER III · SECTION

Climate Change

Climate Change

Climate Change

DATA: 2024-2025

Temperature Rise

Planet already warmed at least 1.1 degrees Celsius

77% of climate experts expect temperature rise > 2.5° by 2100

Rising sea levels

Risen by over **10 cm** between 1993 and 2024 (NASA)

Projection: Global mean SLR of 1.3-1.6 m by 2100 in high-emission scenario (IPCC).

Carbon emissions

Global average CO2 emissions-> 419.3 parts per million in 2023.

India (per capita): 1.9 ton v/s **4.7 ton** (World avg)

World 3rd largest emitter (after China, USA)

Greenhouse Gas Emissions [UNEP Emissions Gap Report 2024 & 2025]

Ranking: India ranks **3rd** in total GHG emissions (4,140 MtCO2e) [China (**1st**) & US (**2nd**)].

Meeting climate ambition: To limit global warming to 1.5°C (UNEP Emissions Gap Report 2025 'Off Target' puts cuts needed from 2019 levels at **55%** by 2035 for 1.5°C and **35%** by 2035 for 2°C; EGR 2024 cited **42%** by 2030 and **57%** by 2035):

Nations must cut **42 %** off annual GHG emissions by 2030 and **57 %** by 2035 in the next NDCs. **5. Warmest year on record: 2024** (NOAA) **6. Degradation and Desertification: 32% of land affected by degradation and 25%** by desertification

Impacts of climate change

OCEAN ECOSYSTEM

Coral reefs decline **70-90%** if warming above 1.5°C [IPCC]

Antarctica losing ice mass at an average rate of about **150 billion** tons per year

Greenland losing **270 billion** tons per year, adding to sea level rise

ECONOMIC LOSSES

Decline in labour productivity of up to **40%**.

3.8% of total working hours could be lost by 2030 [World Economic Forum]

AGRICULTURE

↓ kharif maize yields by 18 and **23%** in 2050 and 2080 scenarios, respectively.

For every degree of warming, **10-25%** increase in crops lost to insect attacks.

Exploitable fish biomass show ↓ >**10%** by mid-century for many regions of world [FAO]

Climate Change CONTINUED

WOMEN

158 million more women and girls into poverty by 2050

236 million more women into hunger [UN Women]

EXTREME EVENTS

Heatwave made **45 times** more likely due to climate change

14.83 crore people in India will be living in severe climate hotspots by 2050 (Council on Energy, Environment and water)

> **80%** of Indian population lives in districts highly vulnerable to extreme weather events.

DISPLACEMENT

India may face a migration of **45 million** people by 2050.

600 million people could face food insecurity due to climate change- induced disruptions to agriculture and fisheries.

Tuvalu expected to be one of the first countries to be completely lost to climate change.

Carbon Inequality

Richest **1%** responsible for more carbon emissions than the poorest **66%**.

Half of all emissions are due to **1/10th** of the global population

IPCC AR6 Synthesis Report

> **50%** chance that global temperature rise will reach or surpass 1.5 degrees Celsius between 2021 and 2040.

Per-capita GDP in Sub-Saharan Africa, South Asia, and West Asia remain lower than global average by 2050 [IPCC 6th synthesis report]

Climate finance

GLOBAL

Global climate finance needs are projected to exceed $**10 trillion** annually by 2050 (CAG).

Advanced economies contributed **45%** of climate finance, while **least developed countries (LDCs)** received only **3%** - From 2018 to 2022 (GLCF 2024).

Adaptation funding gap: Developing countries need $**215–387 billion** annually, but receive just $**28 billion in 2022** (Adaptation Gap Report 2024).

Mitigation-adaptation imbalance-> **90%** of climate finance directed toward mitigation (UNDP).

Funding source: > **94%** of current climate investment comes through debt or equity, rather than grants (Climate Policy Initiative).

INDIA'S CLIMATE FINANCE NEEDS

India estimates a $**2.5 trillion** financing need by 2030 for its climate transition to achieve net-zero emissions by 2070.

6–8 trillion USD needed during 2015–2030 to transform current energy systems in India.

Adaptation spending: ↑ from **3.7% of GDP** in FY16 to **5.6%** in FY22 (Eco Survey)

QUANTIFIED GOAL ON CLIMATE FINANCE (NCQG) OR BAKU FINANCE GOAL

Triple finance to **USD 300 billion** annually by 2035 (previous goal of **USD 100 billion** annually).

Secure efforts to mobilize $**1.3 trillion** per year by 2035 from both public and private sources

Climate Change CONTINUED

COP29-> proposed climate finance goal of **USD 300 billion** annually by 2035 is much lower than the estimated **USD 5.1-6.8 trillion** needed by 2030 (Eco Survey) **11. LiFE: By 2030, LiFE could save consumers USD 440 billion globally. 12. Paris agreement status: Current pledges put world on track for a 2.5-2.9°C** temperature rise- far above the 1.5°C limit [UNEP Emission Gap report]

India's Climate Commitments

Panchamrit (COP-26)

Non-fossil fuel energy capacity to 500 gigawatts (GW) by 2030;

50% of its energy needs from renewable sources by 2030;

↓ carbon emissions by **1 billion tonnes** from the present until 2030;

Reduce emissions intensity of its GDP by **45%** by 2030.

Net Zero emissions by 2070. **14. India's demands: India wants to push developed nations to become carbon** negative rather than carbon neutral by 2050.

GS PAPER III · SECTION

Conservation & Ecosystems

Biodiversity

Biodiversity

DATA: 2023-2026

Protected areas

1014 Protected areas-> covers 1,75,169.42 km2 of geographical area -> ≈ **5.32%**.

72% rise in the number and **16%** growth in the total area from 2000 to 2023.

Bid to double global protected areas affect India's tribes

84% of national parks are established in areas inhabited by STs.

Biodiversity hotspots

India lost **90% of area** under its four biodiversity hotspots (CSE Data, 2021)

25 species have gone extinct in these hotspots.

Global: 36 biodiversity hotspots

Represent just **2.5%** of Earth's land surface

Supports > half of the world's plant species as endemics

Supports **43%** of bird, mammal, reptile and amphibian species as endemics.

Illegal wildlife trade

4th most illegal trade after arms, drugs and human trafficking.

Annual value -> $7 - $**23 billion** (2016 UN estimates)

Rhino horn (**29%**), followed by pangolin scales (**28%**) and elephant ivory (**15%**) [World Wildlife Crime report, 2024] **4. Illegally traded plants: Cedars mahogany, holy wood, and Guiacum made up** biggest market at **47%**.

Biodiversity CONTINUED

Human wildlife conflict

Elephant deaths: 94 elephants perished due to electrocution in 2023-24

Tiger deaths: > 600 people were killed in tiger attacks in the country between 2014 and 2024, an average of 60 deaths annually

Agriculture loss: Wild herbivores damage **15-50%** of standing crops in field

Poaching: > 6,900 poachers were arrested for killing and trafficking of 2,869 wildlife animals during the past **10 years**

India is among the top three countries globally for illegal wildlife trade via the airline sector.

Invasive species

India

India tops the list with 185 invasive alien plants in South Asia.

66% of country's natural systems threatened

Economic cost could reach up to **USD 182.6 billion.**

Global

37,000 established alien species

1 in 10 species on IUCN Red List are threatened by invasive alien species.

Annual economic costs exceed **USD 423 billion.**

Coastal areas

33.6% of Indian coastline vulnerable to erosion, **26.9%** was under accretion (growing) and **39.6%** was in stable state.

Forests

India State of Forest Report (2023)

Forest and Tree cover: 25.17 percent of the geographical area and (**21.76%** is forest cover and **3.41%** is tree cover).

- ↑ by 1,445.81 km², with a 156.41 km² rise in forest cover compared to 2021.

State-wise data

Area wise top three states having largest forest cover are Madhya Pradesh > Arunachal Pradesh > Chhattisgarh

Maximum increase (Forest and Tree Cover): Chhattisgarh > Uttar Pradesh > Odisha > Rajasthan

Largest Decrease: MP > Karnataka > Ladakh > Nagaland

19 states/UTs have above **33 percent** of the geographical area under forest cover.

Mangrove cover: 4,992 sq km - 0.15% of the total geographical area, with a net decrease of 7.43 km² since 2021.

Carbon stock: 30.43 billion tonnes of CO2 equivalent.

Mangroves

Total mangrove cover: 4,992 sq km (ISFR 2023)

Vulnerability: By 2070, **50%** of India's mangroves will shift or vanish due to climate change [Birbal Sahni institute Palaeosciences]

Global: Over **50%** of world's mangroves at risk of collapse, climate change leading factor; (IUCN).

Coral reefs

Global

Cover less than **1%** of ocean floor but most productive and diverse ecosystem.

Biodiversity CONTINUED

Bleaching: > 60% of world's coral reefs may have bleached in past year (NOAA)

Effect of Climate change: It could damage half of the world's reefs by 2035

NOAA confirms 4th global coral bleaching event

India

Bleaching: 84.6% of coral reefs in Lakshadweep experienced bleaching during 2023-24 [Ministry of Earth Sciences informed (MoES)]

It takes 6-7 years for Lakshadweep reefs to recover, without further disturbances

Degradation can affect 4.5 million people in southeast Asia and the Indian Ocean.

Wetlands

4.6% of land as wetlands

15.26 million hectares

India now has 101 Ramsar sites (covering 13.88 lakh hectares across 28 states/UTs as of August 2026, up from 89 sites earlier; highest in Asia) (MoEFCC / Ramsar Convention 2026)

National Wetland Atlas (2011): Gujarat (17.5%), lowest in Mizoram (0.66%)

India lost 2 out of 5 wetlands in last 3 decades

Global

35% of the world's wetlands lost b/w 1970-2015

30% of coastal wetlands could be lost by 2100

Beaches

18 Blue Flag Certified beaches in India across 7 coastal states and 2 UTs as of the 2025-26 season (up from 12) (MoEFCC Year-End Review 2025)

89% of shoreline of A&N islands eroded by Bay of Bengal

33.6% of Indian coastline was vulnerable to erosion

Species

Extinct species: Indian Cheetah, pink-headed duck, and the Great Indian Bustard due to desertification.

TIGER

↑ by 30% in the last 20 years.

3,682 tigers (range 3,167–3,925, accounting for ~75% of global wild tiger population) (NTCA All India Tiger Estimation 2022/2023)

- 53.2% of tiger deaths occurred within Tiger Reserves
- 35.22% happened outside boundary of TRs (NTCA)
- Tiger deaths in 2023 is highest (178) since 2012.

ELEPHANTS

India has the largest number of wild Asian Elephants

Decline in India's Elephant Population-> From 19.8K in 2017 to 15.9K in 2023 (WII)

29,964 elephants (2017 census by Project Elephant).

60% of the species' global population in India.

BIRDS POPULATION

State of India's Birds (2023)

60% of bird species declined in India over a period of 30 years

29% are stable, and 11% have shown increases.

Global

48% of 11,000 surviving bird species experiencing decline

Biodiversity CONTINUED

13.5% of bird species face risk of global extinction, with 798 species classified as vulnerable, 460 as endangered, and 223 as critically endangered. **14. Ecosystem services: Total value of global ecosystem services for one year is b/w** 16 to **54 trillion USD**

Sustainable Development

Energy

DATA: FY 2025-26 (as on 31 March 2026)

ENERGY - RENEWABLE & NON-RENEWABLE

India's Energy Mix (Sources and Shares) As per [Energy Statistics India 2025 , MoSPI]

Coal: **48%**

Oil: **28%**

Natural Gas: **8%**

Renewables (Solar, Wind, Hydro, Biomass): **12%**

Nuclear: **4%**

Non-renewable energy

COAL ENERGY

Coal-> **46.88%** of India's total installed capacity for power generation.

Share in total power generation capacity ↓ below **50%** in 2024 (first time since 1960s).

Coal Imports decreased by **8.4%** in April-December 2024 in comparison to the same period of FY 2023-24.

Per capita commercial primary energy consumption: 350 kgoe/year.

5th largest geological reserves of coal

Future of Coal

Expected demand: 1.3-1.5 billion tonnes by 2030 (Eco Survey 2022- 23)

NATURAL GAS

Share in energy basket-> **8%** (Target: **15%** by 2030).

Consumption: 164.3 million metric standard cubic meters per day (mmscmd).

CNG vehicle sales jump **38%** in FY2024

India emerges as key market for LNG, ranks fourth globally in 2024

NUCLEAR ENERGY

5th largest source of electricity

4% of the total electricity generation

25 operable nuclear energy reactors with a total installed capacity of **8.88 GW**

Target: 1 lakh MW by 2047

Renewable energy

SOLAR ENERGY

Potential: 748 GWp (National Institute of Solar Energy)

Installed capacity: 150.26 GW as of 31 March 2026 (including **110.43 GW** utility-scale, **25.73 GW** rooftop solar, and **14.10 GW** PM-KUSUM/off-grid; up from **100.33 GW** in Jan 2025 after a record **44.61 GW** addition in FY26) (MNRE 2026)

Capacity increase: 2.82 GW in 2014 to **100GW in 2025**.

Utility scale installation: **18.5 GW**

Energy CONTINUED

Rooftop solar (RTS)

Market: Surged from **2.5 GW in FY21** to **25.73 GW cumulative rooftop solar capacity as of March 2026** (with **8.71 GW** added in FY26 alone) (MNRE 2026)

Capacity addition: India added **1.2 GW** of rooftop solar capacity in the first quarter (Q1) of 2025, up **232%** year-over-year from **366.5 MW**

Households: Over **42 lakh households** benefited from rooftop solar installations till March 2026 (with PM Surya Ghar touching **18.71 lakh** installations / **22.7 lakh** households in FY26, up from **8.51 lakh** installations in FY25) (MNRE 2026)

New Solar Power Scheme: Electrifies 100,000 households in tribal areas, providing off-grid solar systems for 63,000 villages, 1,500 multi-purpose centers, and 2,000 public institutions under the Pradhan Mantri Janjati Adivasi Nyaya Maha Abhiyan.

PM-Surya Ghar Yojana: Aims for rooftop solar installations in **10 million** households, targeting **40-45 GW** capacity by 2027.

World position

3rd largest solar power producer

5th in solar PV deployment

WIND ENERGY

Potential: **695.5 GW** at 120 meters and **1,164 GW** at 150 meters above ground level

Target: **500 GW** renewable energy by 2030

140 GW from wind power.

Installed capacity: **56.09 GW as of 31 March 2026** (up from **50.04 GW** in April 2025, with a record annual addition of **6.05 GW in FY26**) [MNRE 2026]

Potential states: Gujarat, Karnataka, Tamil Nadu and Andhra Pradesh.

Funding: India may add 25 GB wind energy capacity by 2028 but it need **Rs 2 lakh crore** (CRISIL)

Global position: **4th after** China, United States and Germany.

OFFSHORE WIND ENERGY

Potential: **70GW** across 16 offshore zones of Tamil Nadu and Gujarat coasts.

Current: As of now, India does not have any active offshore wind projects.

Target: **37 GW by 2030**.

HYDRO ENERGY

Potential: **1,45,000 MW**

Installed capacity: Share in total power output record low of **8.3%** IN 2024, compared to an average of **12.3%** over the past decade

Global Scenario

India ranks **4th** by undeveloped hydropower potential

5th by total potential.

India exploited **29%** of its hydropower potential (US-**80%**; EU-**70%**) **Classification of Hydro projects**

Micro: upto 100 KW

Mini: 101KW to **2 MW**

Small: **2 MW** to **25 MW**

Mega: Hydro projects with installed capacity >= **500 MW**

Thermal Projects with installed capacity >=**1500 MW**

5. Small Hydro energy

Potential: **20 GW**

Installed capacity: **5.17 GW as of 31 March 2026** (up from **5.07 GW**; Large Hydro installed capacity stands at **51.41 GW**) [MNRE 2026]

BIOENERGY

Current capacity: **11.75 GW as of 31 March 2026** (up from **11.58 GW** in April 2025; total Non-Fossil installed capacity reached **283.46 GW**, including **274.68 GW Renewable Energy** and **8.78 GW Nuclear**) [MNRE 2026]

Energy CONTINUED

HYDROGEN BASED ENERGY

Current consumption: 6 mmtpa

6% share in total final energy consumption by 2050 (IRENA)

Target: Green hydrogen production capacity of **5 mn tonnes by 2030** (National Green Hydrogen mission). **8. Ammonia based energy: India is among the world's largest ammonia producers,** representing **8% of global** production.

GEOTHERMAL

Potential: 10 GW

Regions: Cambay Graben (Gujarat), Puga (J&K).

OCEAN ENERGY

Potential: 54 GW (Tidal- **12.4 GW**; Wave power- **41300 MW**)

GS PAPER III · SECTION

Pollution & Degradation

Solid wastes

Pollution and Waste Management

DATA: 2024-2025

POLLUTION & WASTE MANAGEMENT

Plastic pollution

INDIA

Annual: Generates **9.3 million tonnes** of plastic pollution annually.

Daily: **26,000 tonnes** of plastic waste – every day -> equivalent of 26,000 small cars!

Per capita plastic waste production (**8 kg** per year)

Plastic recycling: Just **8%**

Single use plastic waste: India ranked **3rd globally**; contributes to **5.5 million tonnes** per year.

GLOBAL

Waste generation: 268 million tonnes in 2022.

Largest consumers: China (**20%**), US (**18%**), EU (**16%**), India (**6%**) and Japan (**4%**)

Per capita consumption ->highest in the US at **216 kg** per person, Japan (**129 kg** per person) and EU (**87 kg** per person).

Air pollution

WORLD AIR QUALITY REPORT (2024 & 2025 - IQAIR)

Rank: India ranked **6th most polluted country** (out of 143) in the 2025 World Air Quality Report [was **5th** in 2024 and **3rd** in 2023] (IQAir 2026)

PM2.5 Reduction: National average PM2.5 concentration declined further to **48.9 µg/m³ in 2025**, down from **50.6 µg/m³ in 2024** and **54.4 µg/m³ in 2023** (IQAir 2026).

WHO safe limit: 5 µg/m³.

Pollution and Waste Management CONTINUED

Delhi & Indian Cities -> New Delhi remained the **most polluted capital city in the world** for the **8th consecutive year** (**91.8 µg/m³ in 2024**)

Loni (UP) was the most polluted city in 2025 at **112.5 µg/m³**, and **66 of the world's 100 most polluted cities** (and 13 of top 20 in 2024) are in India (IQAir 2025/2026).

13 of the 20 most polluted cities in the world are in India.

Global (2025 Report): Top 5 most polluted countries -> Pakistan (**67.3 µg/m³**), Bangladesh (**66.1 µg/m³**), Tajikistan (**57.3 µg/m³**), Chad (**53.6 µg/m³**), and DR Congo (**50.2 µg/m³**) [in 2024: Chad (**91.8 µg/m³**), Bangladesh (**78 µg/m³**), Pakistan (**73.7 µg/m³**), Congo (**58.2 µg/m³**)] (IQAir 2025/2026).

Mercury pollution

India- 2nd largest mercury emitter -> 144.7 tonnes Hg/year

India imports over 250 metric tonnes of mercury each year

India leaks > **220 tonnes** into the environment from known sources (Toxics Link, a NGO)

> **70%** to **80%** of India's mercury emissions due to coal usage.

GLOBAL POSITION

Current levels in the atmosphere are up to **500 %** above natural levels.

In Oceans: 200 % above natural levels. **4. Land pollution: 33% of the country's total geographic area —are affected by soil** degradation, salinity, and vegetation loss.

Noise pollution

Optimum noise level (WHO)

45 dB during the day and 35 dB at night.

Anything above 80 dB is hazardous.

12,000 premature deaths and 48,000 new cases of ischaemic heart disease every year (European Environment agency)

Noise level of >80 decibels for more than 8 hours a day increases changes in breathing patterns (WHO)

Light pollution

Artificial light increasing by around **2%** per year globally.

Biomedical waste

India generates **743 tonnes** of biomedical waste daily and about **640 tonnes** is treated (CPCB report)

Waste to Energy conversion

Total waste: 65 million tonnes of waste every year;

estimated to go up to **165 million tonnes by 2030** and **436 million tonnes by 2050**

Conversion Potential

1700 MW from urban waste (1500 from MSW and **225 MW** from sewage) and about **1300 MW** from industrial waste [Ministry of New and Renewable Energy]

Current status: 75% of municipal waste gets collected; only 22 to **28 percent** is processed

12 operational and eight non-operational waste-to-energy plants in India in 10 states as of November 2022.

Pollution and Waste Management CONTINUED

Solid waste management

India generated **170,000 tonnes** of municipal solid waste per day

Collection and treatment: About **156,000 tonnes** were collected, of which nearly **54 per cent** was treated, and

Deposition in landfills: **24%** was deposited in landfills (CPCB 2024).

Type of waste

50-55% of waste in Indian cities is biodegradable wet waste;

35% is non-biodegradable wet waste

10% is inert.

Per capita waste generation -> B/w 0.2 Kg to 0.6 Kg per day in cities with population ranging from **1.0 lakh** to **50 lakhs.**

Projections: Indian cities will generate approximately **435 million tonnes** of solid waste by 2050 (MoHUA 2021).

E-Waste

INDIA

3rd biggest e-waste generator behind China and the U.S.

67% of India's e-waste remains unprocessed (Ministry of Environment, Forests and Climate Change)

GLOBAL [GLOBAL E-WASTE MONITOR 2024 REPORT]

Increase in global e-waste generation, rising from **34 billion** (bn) kg in 2010 to **62 bn kg in 2022**.

Of this **62 bn kg**, only **13.8 bn kg** is documented as 'formally collected and recycled in an environmentally sound manner'.

62 million tons of "e-waste" was generated in 2022-> enough to fill tractor-trailers that could be lined up bumper to bumper around globe.

Circular economy

India: India's circular economy could touch $**45 billion by 2030**.

Global: Transition to a circular economy could generate $**4.5 trillion** in additional economic output globally by 2030.

Water Pollution and Related Issues

Water and its Conservation

DATA: 2025 (CGWB Assessment)

WATER & ITS CONSERVATION

Water Scarcity

Water Scarcity: As per World Bank, Annual per-capita water availability

⩽ 1700 m^3: Water Stressed condition

⩽ 1000 m^3: Water Scarcity condition (India =: Around 1500 m^3 (CWC))

Global Scenario: Water scarcity affects more than **40%** of the global population

Water and its Conservation CONTINUED

India's Scenario

18% of world population lives in India but it has just **4%** of world's water resources.

India is the second-largest consumer of water, using **20.1 per cent** of global water resources.

It ranks **133rd** in water availability per capita

Per Capita Use (India): Average annual per capita water availability for the year 2021 was 1,486 cubic meters (Ministry of Jal Shakti)

Projected water demand: Per capita water use is projected to increase from 85 litres per capita per day (lpcd) in 2000 to 125 lpcd by 2025 and 170 lpcd by 2050.

Access: **50%** has no access to safe water.

Deaths: Around 2 Lac/year (due to lack of access to safe water)

Economic Burden: Loss of **6% of GDP**

Water Pollution

Surface Water Pollution: **80%** of surface water is polluted

Pollution Levels: **70%** water resources are polluted (Composite Water Management Index)

Source of River Pollution:

80% of river pollution -> untreated waste

20% of river pollution -> Industries

Groundwater Crisis

India is the largest groundwater user globally (**26%** of world).

Annual groundwater extraction: **247.22 BCM in 2025** (245.64 BCM in 2024; 241.34 BCM in 2023), out of 407.75 BCM annual extractable groundwater resources (CGWB Dynamic Ground Water Resource Assessment 2025).

The country's **Stage of Ground Water Extraction (SoE) is 60.63% in 2025** (**60.47%** in 2024; **59.26%** in 2023) (CGWB 2025).

India consumes more groundwater than the US and China combined

Annual groundwater recharge -> **448.52 BCM in 2025** (up from 446.90 BCM in 2024 and 432 BCM in 2017) (Ministry of Jal Shakti / CGWB 2025)

Ground Water Table -> 0.3 ↓/Year

Dependency

62% of irrigation needs are met through groundwater.

85% of rural and **50%** of urban water supply depend on groundwater.

10.8% of groundwater assessment units (730 out of 6,762 units) are over-exploited in 2025 (down from **17.2%** in 2017), while **73.14% (4,946 units) are in the Safe category** (up from **62.6%** in 2017) (CGWB 2025)

GW depletion rate could triple by 2080, if Indian farmers continued to draw groundwater at the current rate.

Annual Groundwater Quality Report 2024

Largest user of groundwater

Largest area under groundwater irrigation in the world.

Uses

87% of extracted groundwater in agriculture and **11%** is used for domestic purposes.

Ocean pollution

As of 2025, 75 to **199 million tonnes** of plastic and waste in our oceans.

171 trillion pieces of plastic estimated to be floating in the world's oceans.

Oil pollution

Ten oil spills of more than seven tonnes were recorded from tanker incidents in 2024

Water and its Conservation CONTINUED

Urban water crisis

48% of India’s urban water supply comes from groundwater (CSE)

40% of people in urban areas in India don't get tap water [National Sample Survey Office]

By 2030 India’s water demand would be double due to rapid urbanization and little infra planning (UN report)

GS PAPER III

Internal Security

FACT SHEETS IN THIS SUBJECT — TAP ANY TITLE TO JUMP TO IT

BORDER MANAGEMENT
MARITIME AND COASTAL SECURITY
ORGANISED CRIME
DEFENSE
TERRORISM
LEFT-WING EXTREMISM (MHA DATA)
INSURGENCY [MHA DATA]
CYBER SECURITY

GS PAPER III · SECTION

Border Management & Organized Crime

Border Area Management

BORDER MANAGEMENT

DATA: 2024-2025

BORDER ISSUES

Ceasefire violations: Reduced to almost zero (from 5000+ in 2020) after ceasefire agreement in 2021.

Cross border infiltration

Indo-Pak: Pahalgam terror attack (April 2025) -> 26 civilians killed, followed by India's precision counter-terror **Operation Sindoor** (7 May 2025) targeting terror infrastructure across the border (MHA / MoD)

India-Bangladesh: 1,956 Bangladeshi nationals were apprehended by BSF troops in 2024.

Illegal Migration (Census 2011): **5.5 million** people (**0.44% of total** population) → of these **42%** from Bangladesh and **13%** from Pakistan.

LAND BORDER

Land border: **15,106.7 km** (MHA Annual Report)

Border countries: 7

Indian border states: 17

NAME OF COUNTRY	LENGTH OF BORDER (IN KMS)
Bangladesh	4096
China	3488
Pakistan	3323
Nepal	1751
Myanmar	1643
Bhutan	699
Afghanistan	106
Total	**15106**

Maritime Security challenges

MARITIME AND COASTAL SECURITY

DATA: 2024-2026

COASTLINE

Length: 7500 Kms (13 coastal states and UT) → **7th longest** in world.

Update: In December 2024, India's official coastline length was revised from **7,516.6 km** to **11,098.8 km** due to higher-resolution measurement (Survey of India / MHA / MoPSW)

Population along coast: 1/**5th** of India's population

Ports: 13 Major Ports (including Vadhavan Port in Maharashtra) and 200+ Non-Major Ports, with major ports' capacity reaching **1,728 MMTPA** in 2026 (MoPSW / PIB Aug 2026).

Coastal monitoring and surveillance: 46 radar stations established

Organized Crime and Terrorism

ORGANISED CRIME

DATA: 2020-2024

DRUG TRAFFICKING

Source of Drugs: Drug trafficking through Arabian Sea & Bay of Bengal, estimated to account for around **70% of total** illegal drugs smuggled into India

Target: MHA aims to make India drug free by 2047.

Seizure: **₹11,311 crore** worth drugs were seized in 19 instances from seaports in the past five years (Ministry of Home Affairs)

Conviction rate: As in 2022, 54 accused were convicted, which almost doubled to 104 in 2023 and increased further to 110 in 2024.

MONEY LAUNDERING

Estimated Value: 2 to **5%** of World GDP (IMF)

Properties attached: **₹1.45 lakh**-crore assets attached under PMLA till 2024 (ED data)

AML Basel Index: India ranked **70th** out of 141 countries in the Anti-Money Laundering (AML) Basel Index, 2020

BLACK MONEY IN INDIA

As per IMF estimates, black money in India is **50% of GDP** and the World Bank estimates it at **20% of GDP**.

India estimates black money in Swiss banks at $**1.4 trillion**, while Swiss authorities report only $**2 billion.**

HUMAN TRAFFICKING

Over 10,000 cases of trafficking with 1,031 convictions between 2018–2022 (MHA); in 2024, over 6,000 human trafficking victims were reported across India (NCRB Crime in India 2024)

GS PAPER III · SECTION

Extremism & External Threats

Threat from External state and Non-state actors

DEFENSE

DATA: 2025 / FY 2025-26 / BE 2026-27

EXPENDITURE

SIPRI Report 'Trends in World Military Expenditure 2025' (Released April 2026)

Rank: **5th largest military spender** globally after the U.S., China, Russia, and Germany (SIPRI 2026).

Total Expenditure: **$92.1 billion in 2025** (up **8.9%** in real terms from $**86.1 billion in 2024**; **2.3% of GDP**, out of $**2.9 trillion** global military spending) (SIPRI April 2026).

Union Budget (2026-27): **₹7.85 lakh crore** allocated to Ministry of Defence in Union Budget 2026-27 (highest among all Ministries, including **₹2.19 lakh crore** capital outlay and **₹29,100 crore** for Defence R&D; up from **₹6.81 lakh crore in 2025**-26) (MoD / PIB Aug 2026)

Projection: Defence budget to rise five-fold to **Rs 31.7 lakh crore by 2047** (CII KPMG Report)

EXPORTS

Total exports: Surged to a record **₹38,424 crore in FY 2025-26** (Private sector: **₹17,353 cr** / **45.16%**; DPSUs: **₹21,071 cr** / **54.84%**), up from **₹23,622 crore in FY 2024**-25; indigenous defence production also hit a record **₹1.78 lakh crore in FY 2025-26** (MoD / PIB Aug 2026).

DPSUs have shown ↑ of **42.85%** in FY 2024-25.

Target: ↑ **₹50,000 crore by 2029**.

Export Destinations: Over 100 countries

USA, France, and Armenia emerging as the top buyers

TERRORISM

DATA: 2025-2026 (GTI 2026)

JAMMU AND KASHMIR

Terrorist Incidents: Over **70%** decline in terror incidents in J&K, with terrorist-initiated incidents falling from 228 (2018) to just 12 (2025) (MHA)

Organized Stone pelting Incidents: Reduced from 1221(2018) to 0 (2023) (related to terrorism and separatism)

RANKING

Global Terrorism Index (2025 & 2026 - IEP)

India ranks **13th** (score 6.428) in the Global Terrorism Index (GTI) 2026 (was **14th** in GTI 2025) (IEP GTI 2026).

Pakistan ranked **1st (most impacted country globally)** in GTI 2026, overtaking Burkina Faso (was **2nd** in GTI 2025) (IEP GTI 2026)

Left-Wing Extremism

LEFT-WING EXTREMISM (MHA DATA)

DATA: July 2026 (MHA Rajya Sabha Data)

DECLINE IN VIOLENCE AND DEATHS

Violence: Maoist-perpetrated violence fell from peak levels to 375 incidents in 2024, **234 in 2025**, and **33 in 2026 (till 21 July 2026)** (**>81%** reduction) (MHA July 2026).

Deaths (civilians + security forces): reduced by **>90%** from 1,005 deaths in 2010 to 151 in 2024 (132 civilians + 19 SFs), **100 in 2025** (64 civilians + 36 SFs), and **11 in 2026 (till 21 July 2026)** (MHA July 2026).

DECLINE IN GEOGRAPHICAL AREA

reduced from 126 districts in 2013 to 90 in April 2018, 70 in July 2021, 38 in April 2024, **08 in December 2025**, and **"zero" LWE-affected districts in March/April 2026** (with 37 'Legacy & Thrust' districts and 1 'District of Concern' under continued support) (MHA July 2026).

SECURITY AND DEVELOPMENTAL MEASURES

Fortified Police stations: **663 Fortified Police Stations (FPS)** constructed across erstwhile LWE-affected States as of July 2026 (up from 400) (MHA July 2026).

Telecom connectivity: **9,497 mobile towers commissioned** in erstwhile LWE-affected areas as of July 2026 (up from 7,768; plus **15,189 km** of roads constructed) (MHA July 2026).

Financial inclusion: **1,804 bank branches, 1,321 ATMs, and 6,025 post offices** opened in areas freed from LWE as of July 2026 (up from 1,007 bank branches, 937 ATMs, and 5,731 post offices) (MHA July 2026).

Skill development & Education: 47 ITIs, 49 SDCs, and **179 Eklavya Model Residential Schools (EMRS)** made functional in erstwhile LWE-affected areas (MHA July 2026).

SURRENDERED CADRES

1,045 surrendered in 2024

N-E Insurgency

INSURGENCY [MHA DATA]

DATA: 2014-2024

INSURGENCY

Insurgency incidents in North-East (NE) states declined by ~**80%** over the past decade, with AFSPA withdrawn from ~**75%**+ of the region (MHA)

Casualties of security forces ↓ by **75%** and civilian deaths by **99%** (MHA)

77% of insurgency incidents in NE from Manipur alone in 2023 (MHA)

GS PAPER III · SECTION

Cyber, Financial & Media Security

Cyber security

CYBER SECURITY

DATA: 2024–2026

CYBER ATTACKS

Cyber attacks: India recorded 79 Million Cyber Attacks in 2023 (cybersecurity firm Zscaler)

Extent: Cybercrime cases registered under NCRB surged **17% (17.9%) in 2024 to cross 1.01 lakh cases** (crime rate rose from 6.2 to 7.3 per lakh population, with fraud accounting for >**70%** and a major spike in 'Digital Arrest' scams) (NCRB Crime in India 2024)

Cost: $4 Bn dollars. Expected to reach $20 Bn in next **10 years**.

Security Breaches: **2nd most targeted nation** for cyber attacks globally (CloudSEK's ThreatLandscape Report 2024).

Phishing attacks: **3rd largest country under** phishing attacks after US and UK.

IoT related attacks: **59%** rise in 2024

CYBER POTENTIAL

India's potential: India is the second-largest online market in the world behind China, with **109.28 crore (1,092.79 million) total internet subscribers** as of March 2026 (TRAI 2025-26 / MHA).

GS PAPER III

Science & Technology

FACT SHEETS IN THIS SUBJECT — TAP ANY TITLE TO JUMP TO IT

Biotechnology And Health Sciences
IT And Communication Technology
Supercomputers
R&D And IPR
Space Technology
Nuclear Technology

GS PAPER III · SECTION

Everyday Science & Innovations

Medical and Health Technologies

Biotechnology And Health Sciences

DATA: 2025-2026 (IBER 2026 & WHO 2024)

BIOTECHNOLOGY

India is emerging as world leader in biotechnology

Over **11,000+ biotech startups** (up from 6,500+) and 75+ bio-incubators supported by DBT/BIRAC

Union Budget 2026-27 also launched **Biopharma SHAKTI** with a **₹10,000 crore** outlay over **5 years** (India BioEconomy Report 2026 / Union Budget 2026-27).

India's **BioEconomy reached USD 195.3 billion in 2025** (up **18%** from **USD 165.7 billion in 2024** and **USD 10 billion in 2014**), contributing **nearly 5% (4.25–5%) to national GDP** and targeting **$300 billion by 2030** (BIRAC India BioEconomy Report 2026)

HUMAN GENOME SEQUENCING

India completed sequencing 10,000 healthy genomes from different regions, representing 99 distinct populations.

IMMUNIZATION (WHO ESTIMATES OF NATIONAL IMMUNIZATION COVERAGE (WUENIC) 2023)

Global:

Childhood immunization coverage stalled in 2023-> **2.7 million** children either unvaccinated or under-vaccinated.

Over **50%** of unvaccinated children live in the 31 conflict-affected countries.

India: In 2023, **1.6 million** children missed crucial Diphtheria, pertussis, and tetanus (together called DPT) and measles vaccinations.

India accounted for **2 million** zero-dose children.

So far **5.46 crore** children and **1.32 crore** pregnant women have been vaccinated under Mission Indradhanush

NEGLECTED TROPICAL DISEASES- GLOBAL REPORT ON NEGLECTED TROPICAL DISEASES 2024 (WHO)

Global Burden: Over **1 billion** people affected by NTDs

1.6 billion need preventive or curative interventions (WHO).

India's Share: accounts for ~**40%** of the global population requiring NTD interventions—the highest worldwide.

2030 Targets (WHO):

90% reduction in the number of people needing NTD interventions.

75% reduction in vector-borne NTD-related deaths.

Mortality Trend: Deaths from vector-borne NTDs increased by **22%** in 2022 compared to 2016.

WASH Access: **85.8%** in NTD-endemic countries have WASH access overall, but only **63%** among those needing NTD interventions.

India's Achievements: Certified free of Guinea Worm (2000) and Yaws (2016) by WHO.

Economic Cost: Eliminating NTDs by 2030 could save over $**342 billion** in healthcare costs and productivity losses (WHO).

RARE DISEASES

In India, a disease is considered rare if it affects fewer than 1 in 2,500 individuals.

Over **70 million** Indians living with rare diseases

6,000-8,000 classified rare diseases, but < **5%** have therapies available.

Biotechnology And Health Sciences CONTINUED

95% rare diseases have no approved treatment & less than 1 in 10 patients receive disease-specific treatment.

NON-COMMUNICABLE DISEASES

NCDs are **number 1 cause of death** and disability worldwide -> **74%** of all deaths

low- and middle-income countries-> **77 percent** of all NCD deaths occurred.

Four top killers -> cardiovascular diseases (**17·9 million**), cancers (**9.3 million**), chronic respiratory diseases (**4.1 million**), and diabetes (**2.0 million**).

GS PAPER III · SECTION

Frontier Technologies & IPR

IT

IT And Communication Technology

DATA: 2024-2026

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE

Economic Impact (India): AI could add $**957 billion** (**15%** of current GVA) to India's economy by 2035 (Accenture)

Global Investment: $**761 billion** invested globally in AI from 2021–2023.

Job Risk: **75 million** jobs globally at complete risk of AI-driven automation (ILO).

India Market Growth: Indian AI market projected to grow at **25–35%** CAGR to reach ~$**17–22 billion by 2027** (NASSCOM-BCG Report; backed by **₹10,372 crore** IndiaAI Mission).

DEEPFAKES

75% Indians have viewed some deepfake content in last **12 months** (McAfee survey)

CRYPTOCURRENCY

India home to the highest number of crypto owners globally -> **10.7 crore** individuals invested in digital currencies.

Projection: By 2025, India's cryptocurrency market generate $**6.4 billion** in revenue, with an estimated **107.3 million** users.

WazirX, India's largest crypto exchange -> $**230 million** security breach (user fund loss)

Supercomputers

DATA: September 2026

SUPERCOMPUTERS

40 supercomputers with a combined computing capacity of 68 Petaflops (PF) deployed as of **September 2026** under the National Supercomputing Mission (up from 37 supercomputers / 40 PF in Dec 2025 and 33 supercomputers / 32 PF in Nov 2024; target is 50 supercomputers exceeding 123 PF) (DST / MeitY / PIB Oct 2026)

Param Pravega-> 3.3 petaflops; largest supercomputer installed in an Indian academic institution.

Intellectual Property Rights

R&D And IPR

DATA: FY 2024-25 to 2026 (GII 2026 & Patents FY26)

GROSS EXPENDITURE ON R&D (GERD)

Gross expenditure on R&D (GERD) ↑ from **₹60,196 crore in FY11** to about **₹1,27,381 crore in FY21**.

Central Government (**43.7%**), State Governments (**6.7%**), Higher Education (**8.8%**) & Public Sector Industry (**4.4%**).

India's Low GERD as percentage of GDP: 0.64% in 2020–21 [Developed countries >**2%** of their GDP on R&D].

Low Private Sector Contribution: 36.4% in 2020-21

Women participation: In extramural R&D projects has increased significantly to **25%** in 2019–20 from **13%** in 2000–01.

RESEARCH OUTPUT

Research output: India is world's **4th** in research output, but ranks **9th** in citations

India strong in chemistry research, with the subject making up almost **60%** of its total Nature Index output.

India aims to overtake US in the number of scientific publications by 2029

PATENT APPLICATIONS

Patent applications: Surged to **1,43,729 patent applications filed in FY 2025-26** (and **1,10,375 in FY 2024-25**, up from 58,503 in FY 2020-21; placing India in the **global Top 6 for patent filings**) (MeitY / CGPDTM / PIB May 2026).

PATENT GRANTS

Patent grants: Over **1,03,057 (one lakh+) patents granted in FY24** (up nearly 17-fold from 5,978 in 2014-15) (DPIIT / CGPDTM)

Term of Patent: Every patent granted is **20 years** from the date of filing of the application.

DISPOSAL OF PATENT APPLICATION

Disposal of patent application: In India, it takes about **58 months** on average to dispose of a patent application (**20 months** in China and **23 months** in US).

GLOBAL RANK

Global rank (GII): India ranks **38th out of 139 economies in the Global Innovation Index (GII) 2025 and GII 2026** (up from **39th** in GII 2024 and **81st** in 2015; ranks **1st among 36 lower-middle-income economies** and **1st globally** in ICT services exports) (WIPO GII 2026)

Global rank (IP Index): India ranked **42nd–43rd** out of 55 economies in the International Intellectual Property Index (US Chamber of Commerce GIPC 2024/2025)

Low student enrollment in advanced programs (total enrolment in Ph.D. stood at **2.12 lakh in 2021**-22- as per All India Survey on Higher Education).

PhDs Produced: India annually awards 40,813 PhDs, ranking third globally, after the United States and China.

Future Prospects: India to spend at least **1%**, but ideally **3%**, of its GDP every year until 2047 on R&D for science to have a meaningful impact on development.

Space Technology

Space Technology

DATA: 2024-2026

SPACE ECONOMY

India: Current size: $**8.4 billion** (around **2-3% of global** space economy); expected to reach $**44 billion by 2033**.

Global: $**570 billion**

Funding: ↓ **55%** to $**59.1 mn in 2024** (Tracxn data)

ISRO

Annual budget: ~**₹13,416 crore** (~$**1.6 billion** in Union Budget 2025-26 / 2026-27, plus **₹1,000 crore** Venture Capital Fund for space startups approved under IN-SPACe) (Department of Space)

- **Low cost:** India spent $74m on the Mars orbiter Mangalyaan and $75m on last year's historic Chandrayaan-3 – less than the $100m spent on the sci-fi thriller Gravity!!

Space docking (SpaDeX, Jan 2025): India became the **4th country** (after the US, Russia, and China) to achieve autonomous satellite space docking via ISRO's SpaDeX mission (ISRO / Economic Survey 2025-26).

PRIVATE SECTOR IN SPACE

Over **250+ space startups** are now active in India, leveraging ISRO and IN-SPACe facilities (Department of Space / IN-SPACe)

- Total funding raised -> fell **35%** YoY to $81 Mn last year (Inc42's Indian Startup Funding Report 2024)

SPACE TOURISM

Global space tourism market size: **USD 851.4 million in 2023** ; projected to reach **USD 8,669.2 million by 2030**

Travel to the International Space Station (ISS) is estimated to cost between 20 to **25 million dollars**.

SPACE DEBRIS

India: By 2030, all Indian satellites will be launched under the zero orbital debris mission.

Global: 40,000 objects larger than **10 cm**, with millions of smaller fragments

GS PAPER III · SECTION

Indigenous Tech & Achievements

Nuclear Technology

Nuclear Technology

DATA: 2025-2026

GLOBAL RANK

India ranks **7th** in terms of the number of nuclear reactors.

5th largest source of electricity for India

25 operable nuclear energy reactors

Total installed capacity of **8.78–8.88 GW (8,780–8,880 MW)** across 25 operable nuclear reactors as of March 2026 (DAE / MNRE 2026)

- target of **100 GW** nuclear power capacity by 2047

Nuclear Technology CONTINUED

Nuclear power generation capacity doubled from **4,780 MW in 2014** to **8,180 MW in 2024**

Union Budget 2025-26 announced **₹20,000 crore for the Nuclear Energy Mission** (targeting 5 indigenous Small Modular Reactors (SMRs) by 2033 and **100 GW by 2047**); **Union Budget 2026-27 extended basic customs duty exemption on imports for Nuclear Power Projects till 2035** (Union Budget 2025-26 & 2026-27).

INDIA'S THREE-STAGE NUCLEAR POWER PROGRAMME

India's three-stage nuclear power programme (by Dr Homi Bhabha in the 1950s):

Stage 1: Natural Uranium Fuelled Pressurized Heavy Water Reactors (PHWRs)

Stage 2: Fast Breeder Reactors (FBRs) Utilizing Plutonium-Based Fuel

Stage 3: Advanced Nuclear Power Systems for Utilization of Thorium

OTHERS

First uranium deposit in India was found in 1951 at Jaduguda, in the Singhbhum Thrust Belt (Jharkhand).

Operational Costing: Estimates show that nuclear plants cost only **33-50%** of a coal plant and **20-25%** of a gas combined-cycle plant.

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